



arnica
butler

GAME FOR MORE

a hotwife erotica novel

Thirteenth Line Publications



GAME FOR MORE

A Hotwife Erotica Novel

By Arnica Butler

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Thank You

I like to precede my stories with a very warm thank-you to my readers and fans, whose support in the form of purchases and reviews (hint, hint) keep indie authors like myself in the job we love the most: writing.

Some fans deserve special mention and my most heartfelt thanks, and those are the beta readers, in particular R. and Watson, who are excellent and incredibly flexible with my schedule.

Thank you all!

Enjoy.

CHAPTER 1

“Jesus,” Dan said, wiping his brow with a white terrycloth towel. “These ladies are going to kill me.”

I wiped my own brow. I was sweating a lot less than Dan, but that had less to do with the fact that I was in good shape and more to do with the fact that my doubles partner was killing it.

The “ladies” - Marie, Dan’s wife, and Scarlett, my own wife, had positioned themselves in the shade. Marie was sitting down, looking as tired as Dan.

Scarlett, on the other hand, looked like she had just gone on a walk. After forty-five minutes of what had been a grueling tennis match for everyone else, her short blue tennis skirt and form-fitting top were not even damp with her sweat. Earlier in the game I had seen a few trickles of her clear, sweet sweat snaking down her neck and into the valley of flesh nestled in her top, along her toned shoulder blades and into the soft, muscled dent surrounding her spine. And one delicious drip on her inner thigh, as she posed in front of me, awaiting a volley from Dan, her round, toned ass pushed out behind her.

Now, one minute into our cool-down, she was relaxed, twirling her racket in one hand like a pro. She looked over at me and smiled coolly, her mascara somehow perfect around her eyes, enhanced to a striking blue by the powdery color of her outfit.

“Who did you say she went to? A guy at the club?” Dan asked me. He hung a towel around his neck. “I may need to get some lessons with this guy.”

At the mention of my wife’s tennis instructor, I bristled, and an electric current traveled straight down my spine to between my legs. Try as I might, I could not push out a series of images from my mind. Some were real, and some imagined: Scarlett with her lips around Alessandro’s cock, Scarlett with her legs spread for his enormous prick, Scarlett tucking her hair behind her ear as she smiled and typed a secret for Alessandro into her phone.

Just like that, my cock was hard as a rock. I positioned the tennis racket hopefully in front of myself, again thankful that I was wearing

compression underwear under loose shorts, and smiled blandly into the sun.”

“He’s a good instructor,” I mumbled.

Really, *really* good.

Dan chuckled. “On the other hand, I think Marie used the same guy. And that didn’t get *her* anywhere.”

I looked over at Marie, who had recommended Alessandro to my wife, and wondered if Dan had any inkling of exactly what we were talking about, here. I wondered if Alessandro had screwed Marie, too, or if my wife was just a particular fancy he had.

And why not screw Marie? She was an attractive woman, to be sure, but standing next to Scarlett she paled in comparison. Marie’s hair was dyed red and picked up notes of false color in the blazing sun: Scarlett’s wheat-colored blonde was streaked naturally by gold and platinum. Marie was fit but she looked her age, over forty. Scarlett was still in her thirties, and she had been working hard at tennis: her ass was round and pert, her arms toned, and her skin had an earned, natural tan.

There were things that only I knew, too: her pussy was waxed bare, for example, and it felt like silk under my hand when I cupped it from behind, just before I dipped my finger into the soft pink gash between her lips.

I also knew that she had probably waxed it for *another man’s* pleasure.

“Next time I get Scarlett,” Dan said, his eyes on my wife as she bent over languidly and stretched her calves. He added, as languidly as she stretched: “On my team.”

This particular stretch involved crossing one foot over the other and then leaning forward to touch her toes and slowly rotate from the outside of one foot to the other. In a short tennis skirt like the one Scarlett was wearing, this meant that her entire backside, up to the curve of her bottom, was stretched out lean and long for me (and Dan, and anyone else behind us) to see.

I couldn’t tell if Scarlett had chosen to do this stretch deliberately to show Dan her ass, but lately I’d been second-guessing everything she did.

Scarlett took her time stretching like this, and I sensed a few guys in the court behind us pausing to let the image soak into their eyes. I heard a lot of seedy-sounding talk in French, but French always sounds a little

sexual to me, so it could have just as easily been a comment about the weather.

Scarlett stood up, gave a feline stretch of her arms, and then started to stretch them behind her, lifting her shirt a little as she did. The line of her toned abs, with just enough muscle to look fit and not manly, was revealed to all watching.

Dan clapped me on my back, his eyes still on my wife. "I think I'll send Marie back to that guy," he said. "Did she *just* do tennis, or something else?"

My stomach twisted again, even though I knew Dan was referring to the gym or some other kind of training, and not sexual activities, when he said "something else."

I wondered how much Dan knew about Alessandro and his "tennis lessons." I wanted to make a smart remark, that Alessandro was a full-service kind of guy, but I doubted that Dan was the sort of man who, like me, would really enjoy seeing his wife fuck some other guy.

Well, "*enjoy*" might not be the precise term for what I had felt.

Scarlett was twisting now, an action that was showcasing the fact that nothing on her belly rolled or bunched, and her legs were equally fat-minimal without being masculine.

Dan blinked, and tore himself away from my wife. "Fuck, man," he said, leaning over to get into his duffel bag. "Marie is going to chop my dick off if I keep watching."

He looked up at me, I suppose because I didn't say anything. "Hey man," he said. "You know I'm just fucking with you, right? But Scarlett is... she's looking great."

"No offense taken," I said dryly. "Ladies," I called out. "We only have the court for ten more minutes. You want to call it quits?"

Scarlett gave a toss of her ponytail. "I'm game for more," she said, meeting my eyes, her lips curled up in a smile she had developed recently.

"Nooo," Dan wailed, shaking his head. "I'm done, it's *le beer heure* for me."

Marie leaned her head back on the bench she was sitting on, already outside of the court. "No way," she said.

Scarlett gave her racket a twirl and narrowed her eyes devilishly in my direction.

"What about you, William? You game? A quick set?"

I was not “game.” My hamstring was about to snap like a dried-out rubber band and I was feeling the five months of near-inactivity preceding this trip. I hadn’t played tennis once since we’d moved to New Mexico, because of my new job.

But there was no way I was going to let Scarlett stare me down from behind those sexy black lashes and not bite.

“Oh, I’m game,” I said valiantly.

Scarlett leaned over to pick up a ball and bounced it on the clay as though she’d been playing tennis all her life. Then she volleyed it over to me. “Your serve,” she said, and jogged lightly to the side of the court where Dan and Marie had been playing.

“Jesus,” Dan groaned. “Get me out of here. I’ll be in the bar.”

Marie lifted herself up. “I’ll be in the hot tub.”

We waited while they left. I bounced the ball. Scarlett rocked right to left, the racket in her hands, her thighs flexing lightly in rolls of firm flesh. Her eyes were on mine, the corner of her mouth smiling slightly.

“Service,” I said, a bitter edge to my voice.

Scarlett grinned. I took one last look at the triangle of blue between her legs, visible because she was poised with her thighs apart, ready to launch in either direction.

I gave the ball a toss, and reached up into the air to slam it as hard as I could in her direction.

It’s probably wise to mention here that the ten minutes of tennis Scarlett and I played was only as violent as it was – a series of intense serves, violent returns, and smashing volleys that left us both panting and leaning on our knees, with the next team of players glowering at us from behind the fence – because Scarlett and I were in a strange, competitive place in our marriage. And to understand *that* story, you have to know what happened between my wife fucking Alessandro the tennis instructor – at my request, I’ll admit – and our trip to France with Dan and Marie.

CHAPTER 2

Scarlett had taken up tennis as a surprise for me. After talking about it – a lot – since all of these events had happened, I realized that she had done it as a way to surprise me, inject something new into our marriage, and to get us doing something together. We had just moved to New Mexico, and I was working at a law firm that took up huge amounts of my time, while Scarlett was trying to pass the bar and get settled in her own field of practice. The change had been a big one: I was making more money than we had been making put together back in Chicago, and when that was turned into New Mexico prices, we were comparatively very wealthy.

But we both had some trouble adjusting.

Scarlett didn't like tennis, or really any sports, but she had made the effort because Dan (my boss, who had hired me) and his wife, and a lot of senior partners at the firm, played. She had figured it was a way to do things together that wouldn't interfere as much with work.

Marie had recommended Alessandro – a muscled, athletic, young Italian instructor with thick jet-black hair, a square jaw, and a huge dick.

He was a good instructor, don't get me wrong.

Before long, I had nudged Scarlett in the direction of something I was as surprised as the next guy that I enjoyed: watching my wife with another man.

It had started out innocently enough: I liked watching her flirt with him. I liked seeing another guy see that my wife was hot, believe that my wife was hot, and I liked something about the energy between them. Scarlett had liked it, too. She liked knowing that I was watching her flirt with another man, feeling jealous.

It had been like gasoline on what was then no more than the flickering embers of our love life.

And then we had taken it a step further. Scarlett had sucked on his cock in the car. I had never told her that I had followed them in my own car, or that I had seen him cupping her blonde head in his hand as she bobbed up and down on his cock.

She had taken a video, which had been essentially useless, other than the salacious, slurpy audio that she had played for me – while she had

sucked on *my* cock after the whole adventure.

At that time, I'll admit: I had wanted Scarlett to go further. I had wanted to see Alessandro's cock embedded in her pussy, filling her up with his seed over and over again.

It was Scarlett who had decided to call it quits, saying that she didn't want to risk our marriage. Scarlett was the one who had felt like it was enough.

But then Alessandro had played his own hand. When she broke things off with him, it had happened in the bar at the club, and seemingly he took it very well.

Until he had followed her into the ladies' locker room, and fucked her.

She told me what had happened, she gave me every detail I could ask for. We had amazing sex for weeks and weeks based on the single time she had spread her legs for Alessandro and let him stretch her pussy with his huge cock.

Scarlett had been the one to decide to cut things off after *that*.

It just wasn't what ended up happening.

"So, you're back to going to the club?" I asked Scarlett, who was brushing her teeth, leaning against the counter so that her bare bottom peeked out from under a light, zip-up sweatshirt she had put on because the air conditioning in our town home was too cold for her.

She had abandoned the club after the incident with Alessandro, but this day – a fine, sunny Saturday on which I had to work – she had let it slip that she planned to go to the gym. "The gym" could really only mean one thing in this case. The gym at Mountain Vista Country Club, where our expensive membership was a saccharine perk from the law firm I worked for.

Scarlett spit into the sink and turned on the water. I got the sense that she had told me where she was going on accident, and even though I had no proof of that suspicion, I couldn't shake it as I watched her carefully pour water on her toothbrush, looking at deeply. As though it would give her some advice.

After a pause that seemed long, and likely only in my own mind, she spoke. "They have such a good gym there." She lifted her long eyelashes to

catch me staring at her in the reflection of the mirror. “I’d really hate to lose my figure after all this work.”

She lifted a leg and flexed it to demonstrate for me, but I didn’t watch her thigh, just the center of her legs.

She smiled at me in the mirror and then sighed. “He’s not there most of the time. And when he is he’s busy. It’s a big club. I won’t run into him.”

We looked at each other and Scarlett smiled.

“Besides,” she added. “He’s probably happy to have me out of his hair so he can move on to his next piece of ass.”

She was referring to Alessandro; there was no need to explain who the elephant in the room was. The reference to “him,” though, made my stomach drop.

I raised my eyebrows as Scarlett turned around and approached the bed. She was lowering the zipper of the sweatshirt slowly, revealing an inch at a time her creamy, sun-kissed skin. The rise of her breasts pushed the fabric away from the center of her chest, but not far enough to get a glimpse of her pink nipples, which were hard little pebbles poking through the fabric.

She stopped at the edge of the bed, and my cock was already hard. With a click, the zipper came apart, and the shirt fell open to reveal her bare pussy, slightly red from the friction of just an hour before, glistening with our mingled cum and her excitement.

“What makes you think that?” I asked, staring at her body. It was hard for me to picture any man moving on so cavalierly from Scarlett.

She climbed onto the bed and straddled me, pushing the sweatshirt down her arms to reveal the smooth rounds of her shoulders, the pink tips of her firm breasts, the oval of her navel. The scent of her pussy, sweet and tangy, mixed with briny scent of my cum, wafted into my nose. My cock twitched inside my boxers and her eyes dropped to watch it.

She grinned. “Isn’t that what all you guys do? Chase after your prey and then once you’ve devoured it, move on to the next good thing?”

She shook her hands loose from her sweatshirt and the material fell onto my thighs. She curled her fingernails under my boxers and pulled on them as she scooted down my legs. Her wet pussy brushed on my right thigh, and the hot liquids from her center stuck to my skin.

I lifted my head to watch her, and even though an unsettling feeling lingered over the morning, I couldn’t complain – or really resist – the fact

that my wife wanted to give me head less than an hour after we had sex. Sure, there was something about it making me uneasy: sex this morning had been “morning sex” and not especially unusual or exciting. Now, Scarlett seemed really hotted up, and that was great... but it was coming on the heels of the mention of another man.

By the time she was positioned with her lips hovering over my cock, I was completely hard and craving what she would do next. It was something she did with more frequency since her affair with Alessandro. I wasn't sure if it was the memory of seeing her in Alessandro's car, or listening to her slurp at his cock, or picturing her looking up at him, meeting his eyes like she was about to with me, but there was no limit on the number of ways Scarlett could arouse me now.

She met my eyes, and my cock twitched wildly. She caught it at the base in her right hand, and extended her tongue as she lowered her wet mouth closer to the crown, where a pearl of precum had bubbled onto the head. Her grip on the base of my cock was tight. She licked the precum like a cat, and then took me into her mouth, all the while her smokey blue eyes staring deep into mine.

Her lips stretched open and I disappeared inside of her mouth, but she never broke eye contact. Not while she sucked and bobbed over my cock, not even when her hand tired and she switched to propping herself up on her right hand to continue. Inside her mouth, her tongue swirled around my shaft as she went down to where her hand was. I'm a decently-sized guy, so I was already at the back of her throat.

She would do this for a while, I knew, and then she would go all the way to the base with her lips. She managed this well now, perhaps because of all the practice she'd been getting. As I watched her and she brought me to the edge so quickly, I couldn't help but let my thoughts wander to two things: that she was so good because she *had* been practicing, and not just on me. Which lead me to my second thought – an image, really, no more – of my wife with her mouth full of cock, her eyes meeting Alessandro's exactly the way they were meeting my now.

When I came, it was almost a surprise: the cum boiled up from inside of me and burst against the back of her throat. I put my hand on her head and gripped her hair.

The whole time, my beautiful wife kept her eyes on my mine, until she slowly released my cock, swirling her tongue around the shaft all the

way to the tip, soaking up every drop of cum in her mouth.

“Shit,” I said, by way of apology. I had wanted to get her on top of me before I came, and let her ride me until *she* came. I pulled gently on her hips, urging her toward my mouth.

Scarlett hesitated at first, but finally relented, aligning her pussy over my mouth while I held her trembling legs in mine.

Her pussy, since she had waxed it, fascinated me. It was silky-smooth, dangerously suggestive of a forbidden youth, and when she was wet it glistened and swelled open like a ripe fruit. She lowered this glorious flesh onto my mouth, and her excitement spilled all over me. Her tangy juices overpowered even the most remote trace of my own cum from our earlier lovemaking, and I sank into her sweet, wet flesh with abandon.

When I found her clit her whole body shuddered, and she lifted her head and threw it back. Her hips rolled as I moved my tongue rhythmically over her hardened nub, and it did not take long to make her come. When she did, her pussy welled up with more sweet liquid that dribbled down my chin.

She shuddered and squeezed her legs together against my cheeks as her orgasm subsided, but I held her to my mouth and continued to lick at her. I loved to make her body twitch and writhe right after she came; I wasn't sure if it was for pleasure or to test the genuineness of her climax.

She bucked and sat on my chest, pushing me to the pillow with a strong hand on my forehead. “Stop, oh, God, I can't take any more,” she said breathlessly.

I relented, and she collapsed on the bed by rolling off of me. My cock was, unbelievably, coming back to life.

She lay there panting for a moment, and then lifted her hand lazily to stroke my chest with the back of it. Her thoughts seemed somewhere else, but I knew that I was prone to imagining this sort of thing.

Suddenly, she sat up, patted me, and then stood up. “I have to run,” she said. “There's a spin class I want to try.”

I reached for her, to touch her back with a feathery tickle, but it was too late. She was already hustling to the dividing wall of the bathroom, about to disappear behind it.

I closed my eyes as I listened to her shower, and almost drifted back to sleep in spite of all the thoughts that occupied my mind. The shower door opening startled me awake.

Scarlett reappeared. I watched her as she strolled out of the bathroom, a towel wrapped around her body. She let it drop casually to the floor as she opened a dresser drawer and sifted through the clothing. "I'll be so happy when we finally get moved," she said, a tone of exasperation in her voice. "Dammit."

I raised my eyebrows.

"I think I packed it," Scarlett hissed, casting a look at a cardboard box on the floor. We were closing on our new home in a few weeks, and then we had tons of time to slowly move there, because the corporate town home was ours for several additional weeks afterward. Scarlett, however, was still not working yet, and she had the mania of a go-getter forced to stay home. In other words, I could see a lot of organizing projects in our future.

"What are you looking for?" I asked sleepily, adjusting myself on the pillow to better see her naked body as she leaned over to pull open a cardboard box and curse at its contents.

Scarlett didn't answer me. She rifled through the box, muttering.

Then she stood up, put her hands on her hips, and sighed loudly.

"What were you looking for?" I repeated.

Scarlett pushed her hair out of her eyes. She seemed lost in thought, and she still didn't answer me. She jerked the drawer open again and took out some yoga pants and a tight-fitting tank top. I watched her slip them on.

"No underwear?" I asked.

Scarlett was adjusting the top, and looked down at her pants, surprised. "Oh," she said, and for a moment I thought she might have actually simply forgotten them.

Scarlett was not a "no-underwear" type.

"It's... yeah. These pants are designed for no underwear."

"Sexy," I said.

I said this naively, blithely, actually thinking it was sexy.

Scarlett gave me a quick smile and hurried into the bathroom.

It was as she was combing her hair into a ponytail that I first felt the flickers of suspicion. Like a dampened fire that becomes rekindled, suspicion and jealousy began to smolder inside of me. Scarlett turned her head side to side, carefully tucking away loose and too-tight strands, turning again and eyeing the angles of her cheekbones. She had an elastic band between her teeth, and at last she found her ponytail to be acceptable, and removed the band to hold her hair.

Then she gazed at her face steadily, turning slightly, admiring her features.

I blinked, and she produced from nowhere a tube of mascara, and applied it to her light-colored lashes.

“Mascara, huh?” I asked. The nagging feeling that had begun with her hair styling became a little more insistent. “I thought you wouldn’t be running into Alessandro.”

I had been maybe 50% joking when I said this. The not-joking part of me found it impossible to believe that my wife was applying makeup to go work out, and the joking part of me had a sense that I was being ridiculous.

Scarlett paused with the brush in her hand and looked at me in the mirror. Very briefly – but long enough to sear through my chest – she had a look of impatience on her face. It morphed quickly into a smile, and she returned her eyes to looking at her own in the mirror. She leaned forward and applied more mascara. “Alessandro’s not the only man at the club.”

Her tone was teasing.

I frowned.

Wasn’t it?

I rolled onto my back. I felt fairly certain we were just joking around, but Scarlett’s ease with the joke unsettled me. It fueled my jealousy, which was an irrational emotion to begin with.

“That’s it,” I said, trying to be lighthearted. “I’m coming with you.”

Again, this was meant to be a joke. A lighthearted joke, one that I expected her to take on as a joke by saying something like, “Okay, cowboy, let’s go.”

Instead, she inserted the brush back into the mascara bottle with a snap. “You have to work,” she said plainly.

My stomach twisted. Her tone was serious, an insistence to it accompanied by a slight whine.

Scarlett was not joking. She was not joking that she wanted me to go to work instead of to the club.

She twisted the cap on and returned to looking at her mascara.

“I deserve a day off,” I said.

At this point in the story, I feel compelled to tell the reader that I am often guilty of what Scarlett calls “fuckery.” It is my tendency to...well... try and fuck with Scarlett, psychologically. She believes I do it when I feel insecure, and I naturally believe that I never suffer from insecurity.

Scarlett looked at me again in the reflection. She had her mouth open to protest for a moment, and her eyes looked wild and caught in the headlights.

But then her lips came together, and she lowered her eyes to look at her mascara tube. A faint smile wobbled at the corners of her mouth. “Well, that’s true,” she said, unable to stop the smile from spreading. “You should probably come. We’ll make a whole day of it. Drinks, dinner...”

“You’re mocking me.”

“You know you can get a last-minute flight to Vegas for like a hundred bucks?”

I forced a smile and lay my head back on the pillow. “We could drive there,” I suggested.

“Fun,” Scarlett conceded sarcastically. “Let’s go.”

This type of banter was fairly common in our marriage, and I would have been the first person to say it was something I loved: Scarlett was quick-witted and could turn on a dry sense of humor when the need arose.

But there was something about the exchange that day that bothered me. It sat poorly, you might say, right in the center of my chest. Perhaps it was the way she had taken my suggestion seriously at first, and I had seen it in her face. Perhaps it was that we had been so close, and our exchanges together so much sweeter in recent weeks, and this exchange seemed like a return to the hardened versions of ourselves we’d built up in our last few years of marriage.

“Okay,” she said quickly, shutting a drawer and walking briskly to the doorway to the hall. “I gotta run.”

I said nothing, and Scarlett seemed to be on her way without so much as noticing. She stopped at the doorway and turned around.

I was face-up on the bed, and scowling a little. She tapped her fingers on the door frame until I looked down my chest at her.

“You aren’t pouting, are you?” she asked.

I didn’t answer. Scarlett sighed. “You weren’t serious, were you? I thought you had to do a bunch of serious work today. I’m just getting out of your hair.”

“At the club,” I said.

Impatience is a bad quality in a lawyer, and Scarlett’s only weakness. She had tamed it well, but it lurked within her. On her face it reminded me a bit of a scene from *Alien*: it traveled in her blood vessels, dark and almost

lumpy, distorting her features one by one, turning back and crossing under skin again, making her lip twitch and her left eye sort of... frizzle.

"At the club," she said, her voice was made of cheerful ice.

There was a long pause. Scarlett folded her arms across her chest.

I looked back at the ceiling. There were a lot of things I wanted to say. I half-wanted Scarlett to promise me she wouldn't fuck Alessandro, or even talk to him. I somewhat wanted her to promise me that and then break the promise. I also wanted to be a tough guy, unbothered by whether or not my wife saw Alessandro or not. Other darker parts of me wanted to be sarcastic, or suggestive. "*I hope you pick up another hot guy,*" I wanted to say. "*Maybe you can take up a new sport.*"

Scarlett sighed, giving in. "Look... I know it's sort of, uh... I bent the rules. So, if you don't want me to go, then I don't have to." She sounded very sincere.

And now I was trapped: did I trust my wife enough to go work out at the club where Alessandro, the man I had overwhelmingly encouraged her to have sex with, worked? Or was I the kind of miserable man that most men evidently were: one who wanted his wife to be an inventive, playful whore, and then burned with jealousy when she did?

Nice play, Scarlett, I thought.

I sat up on my elbows and used my oldest defense.

"I was just joking, Scar."

Scarlett's fingers rolled along her forearm. Pinky, tap, ring, tap, middle, tap, pointer, tap tap tap. She had me figured out, and she knew I wasn't joking, but she also knew there was no way to prove it. I could see her quick courtroom mind playing out all the possible permutations of this argument, and then the glazed curtain of defeat dimmed her eyes momentarily.

Then she smiled, on to a new tactic. "Okay," she said cheerfully. "So you're cool?"

"Of course."

She gave me a last lingering look, her mouth in that screwball shape that women make when you're doing something moronic, and which you know is moronic, and which you know that she knows that you know it's moronic, and it's some masculine dumbshit thing that only a man would do.

"Okay," she said, in that same tone of voice as the above-described type of expression.

And then she left.

CHAPTER 3

I wasn't "cool," of course.

I loved my wife. I loved that she had slept with Alessandro and rekindled our sex life. I loved that she had done it the way she had done it, and I loved that she had shared it with me.

I also trusted my wife. After all, she had only done any of this at my behest. I had practically pushed her into it.

I just... wasn't sure I wanted her to go to the club and run into Alessandro again. She claimed that the time they had slept together was a one-off, and that she had broken things off with him. It was Scarlett, I reminded myself after she left, who had told me she thought it was for the best that she broke things off with him.

I spilled coffee on myself getting into the car. I yelled because it burned terribly. I stormed back into the house to change clothes – even on a weekend, the firm had a strict dress code, and while I didn't think the coffee would show on the navy suit, I didn't want to stink like coffee or run the risk of getting scolded like a child.

And yet Alessandro was no wilting daisy, I argued to myself as I speed-walked clumsily through the hallway. My anger – from the coffee, laced with the weird frustration of my conversation with Scarlett, and topped with the cherry of her going to the club – was getting the better of me.

I selected a pair of suit pants from a hanger and jerked them off, sending the hanger spinning and finally falling onto the floor with that annoying sound that hangers – even expensive ones – make when they come off a rack.

This incensed me further. I shook the pants out with such vigor that they almost ripped.

"Fuck me," I whispered, when I looked down at my shirt as I tucked it in: a tiny drop of coffee flecked my shirt. Its size was somehow even more insulting than if I'd dumped a whole cup there.

I scanned the shirts remaining in the closet and jerked one off of a hanger at the end near Scarlett's clothing. My exaggerated movement set off

a cascade of clattering hangers and tipped over a precariously positioned cardboard box, the contents of which spilled onto the floor.

I was in a hurry, and so I picked them up hastily and shoved them into the box.

It was only later, when I was already driving, that I would review the contents in my memory:

A black shirt, a white slip, a well-worn bra.

A swimsuit she never wore.

Red lingerie, lacy almost everywhere, the kind of lingerie that was not meant to be worn all day or cover much of anything.

Try as I might, I could not remember ever having seen that lingerie.

I *could* remember, because it caught on another pair of underwear – also fairly old, looking much like something you’d give away – that there was a tag still attached to the bra.

A matching set, never used.

Not one that I had purchased.

It didn’t mean anything, not really. That’s what any lawyer worth half his salt would have said to himself. There were literally thousands of perfectly plausible explanations for that lingerie, including that my own memory was twisting images in my mind.

I spent a great deal of time convincing myself that all of these things were circumstantial, and added up to nothing. What did I even have?

A scrap of lingerie, which I likely mis-remembered.

The fact that Scarlett was still going to the club to work out, on a Saturday, when I had to work at the office. What else was she going to do? Buy a membership at a lesser gym?

The makeup.

It was almost nothing to go on, nothing to set a man to simmering like I was.

I spent the whole day thinking about it, though. Of course there was room in my mind for other thoughts: the file I was working on, legal language, what to have for lunch. But like a hot coal nestled inside of me, thoughts of Scarlett and Alessandro were never far from the forefront of my mind. The feelings that came with them alternated between dread and elation, and a sort of hopeless despair that came with knowing that I was the kind of man who half-wanted my wife to cheat on me. Or at least I enjoyed

thinking about it. Delving into it, in full-color, picturesque glory, imagining the feel of another man's cum on my fingers as I slipped them into Scarlett's pussy.

It was a long day.

A knock on my office door knocked me out of one of many reveries in late afternoon. After digging into the files with determination, I'd gotten caught up in a loose thread and begun to chase it down through the paperwork. I'd lost track of time, and when I glanced at my watch, I saw it was almost five pm.

"Yeah," I said, and my voice was hoarse.

"You napping in here?"

It was Dan, who knew full well I was doing no such thing. No time for it.

"I, uh... I think I caught something interesting here," I said. "There are no corresponding receipts for some of these fees..." I started to leaf through the papers.

"Get a grunt to work on it," Dan said. He sat on my desk. "You've forgotten."

I looked up at him sharply, thinking it was something to do with the case. My heart pounded.

"Dinner?" Dan said, smiling. "Don't worry, I forgot, too, but Marie just texted me. How about we meet at the club around six for cocktails? Our reservations are at seven. It won't be a problem for Scarlett, will it?"

"Uh... no. No. No, it's fine, I hadn't forgotten, I just... lost track of time here."

Dan smiled. I couldn't tell if he bought my story about not forgetting (I had), or not. "See you at six," he said. When he was at the door he turned back. "You can just wear that, if you have a jacket."

I fished my phone out of my pocket and swept through the messages, but there was nothing from Scarlett. I had told her about dinner, and it was *very* unusual for her to forget.

I typed frantically, trying to keep my conspiracy hat from addling my mind.

[Me]: *Babe. I forgot about dinner tonight with Dan and Marie. Meet at the club at 6?*

And then, because I could not resist:

[Me]: *Maybe you're already there?*

When I didn't get a response from Scarlett, after a few minutes of tapping my phone against my lips and staring out at the shades of baking brown, beige, and sage that made up the entirety of the landscape I could see from my window, I typed another message. While I typed it, a feeling I hadn't felt since long before I got married snaked up my spine. As though I were chasing down a girl I had a crush on, not the woman who lived in my house and shared her life with me. It took a moment to recognize it. The itchy, cool fingers of possibility. The possibility of being rejected, of losing control, of not get something I wanted.

[Me]: *Maybe you're wearing that dress you bought?*

Was it hope that made me send that text? "The dress" referred to a slinky, metallic dress with deep cuts, sold at a store for twenty-something club-goers. I am the one who had purchased it, hopefully, back when Scarlett's "thing" with Alessandro had been no more than a fantasy.

She had never worn it.

I didn't know why I sent that text, and I felt silly as soon as I did. But they can't be recalled, or edited, and so I was left with that figment of imagination, daring, hope, whatever it was, floating out there.

Scarlett never responded.

*

The time dragged by, and I didn't hear from her, so I hurried down to my car and drove home. I was hoping to find her there, take a shower, maybe sneak in a quickie, and then head to the club. It was Santa Fe, after all, on a Saturday, and that was just the sort of thing you could do if you didn't need to go through the tourist traps of the city, which I could easily avoid.

A man who suspects his wife of vague, indeterminate things can become a madman quite quickly. Back in my school days at the free clinic

I'd helped out with a number of divorce cases, and I could feel myself getting the "crazy eye" I'd seen on the faces of a number of men.

And yet what was I even getting crazy about? My wife *had* fucked another man, with my blessing. I'd even wanted her to continue. Now she hadn't texted me, and there were a thousand explanations for that. Dead battery, in the shower, lost the phone, asleep.

Just as there were explanations for the lingerie, including that my memory was bad.

I was less crazy when I arrived at our town home, but when I noted that her car wasn't there, the crazy started to come back. I didn't even get out of the car, but instead whipped my phone out and texted again:

[Me]: *Where are you? Drinks at six, at the club. I'm at home.*

And then I sat there, staring at the phone as though it would start talking to me, until the car began to overheat. I had turned it off, and it went wildly hot within moments.

Exasperated, and unnecessarily so, I threw open the car door and stomped into the house, which was silent. I called out for Scarlett anyway, then started to poke around. Had she been home? What had she done while she was there?

But I'm a lawyer, not a cop or a spy, so there was no way of knowing whether Scarlett had been home or not, because I am not observant enough to know if things had been changed around or not. A coffee mug regarded me coolly from the kitchen counter, but I didn't know if it had been there in the morning or not.

I looked at my watch. I was pushing it at 5:30 already. I quickly texted a preemptive apology to Dan for being late, let my thumb hover over the send button, and then hurried to the shower, because by now I needed one.

Scarlett was still not home, and still hadn't answered me, by the time I got out of the shower. I called her phone, thinking perhaps I would hear it ring from the confines of a purse she had switched out or a jacket pocket. But only sound in the home was the low, barely audible hum of the endlessly churning central air.

I hung up when the voicemail picked up, and then called back. "Hey," I said, disliking something in the tone of my voice. "I'm..uh... well, starting

to get worried. Dan and Marie invited us to dinner tonight, maybe you forgot like I did... anyway, they want us to meet at the club at six for cocktails so... I'll see you there." I lowered the phone and prepared to hang it up, which is a stupid expression for the light tap of a thumb that you do now, but then I brought it back to my ear. "Just... call me, either way. Okay? I'm really starting to worry."

I ended the call and stared at my phone again, willing it to vibrate in my hand with an incoming text message.

But none came, so I went outside, got in the car, and waited again. But nothing happened, so I drove to the club, my stomach in the worst kind of knots, and my mind in the worst kind of places.

*

"And where is your lovely better half?"

It was the first thing Dan said when I arrived at the club and was escorted to their table. They were seated at the outdoor, poolside bar where I had first seen Scarlett flirting with Alessandro alone.

The question scalded me, mostly because I had no answer. I could feel my chest getting tighter. I swallowed and sat down. "Oh, I wish I knew," I said. I tried to sound jovial, as if I really did know where Scarlett probably was, as though this were something she did all the time, as though I wasn't burning inside with jealousy and worry. "She should be along shortly," I added. I looked at my phone one more time, and smiled a plastic smile, more like a grimace, for no one in particular and everyone who could see. "She forgets her phone in weird places all the time," I continued.

A lawyer's first advice is always "shut up." I gave myself that same advice, because I sounded, like most people who are trying to hide something, like an idiot who was trying to hide something.

Marie smiled, her lips formed in the same plastic mold as my own.

Dan placed a hand on the table in front of me and patted it, like you would pat a sick child. "You need some wine," he assured me.

The wine was ordered, and the conversation was pivoted to something we could all talk about without thinking much about it: real estate. The prices were rising, we each gave examples of homes we'd seen sell for ridiculous prices, we each furrowed our brows expressively and pretended to concentrate hard when the other person explained which house they

meant in a series of over-winded descriptions of landmarks and cross streets.

Dan really was a stand-up guy.

“...bright, sort of Frida Kahlo blue, with a lot of wild grass in the yard, sort of across from the -”

“Oh! *There* she is.” Dan was standing, his metal chair scraping on the cement. It was twenty minutes after seven by then, I know because I had been looking at my watch every fifteen seconds.

Scarlett was making her way through the scattered tables. Her blonde hair was twisted up into a tidy style she used universally for work and business meetings, and it looked slightly dark, as though it had not completely dried. Her lean body, toned after so many workouts and so much tennis, was encased in a black cocktail dress she used for all things: moderately conservative, somewhat sexy, forgettable on most women but stunning on her. A pinkish glow was burning beneath her skin, on her chest and her cheeks, the sort of overheated coloring one gets from either a sunburn or overworking oneself on a hot day. A very trace sheen of sweat made her skin shiny from her neck to the low neckline of the dress.

Her mouth was cast in the same fake smile Marie had given me, the same one that my own mouth wore as I looked at her approaching. “I’m so sorry I’m late,” Scarlett was singing, her hips moving from side to side as she maneuvered through the chairs.

She was composed, a woman who had simply hurried from somewhere where she had been working out or doing something athletic. She had a backstory, I could see she was setting it up. Everything about her looked calm, reasonable, about to tell me what had happened, and for all of it to be a great and believable excuse.

Except for a few things: Scarlett’s eyes were wild, her pupils too large for the bright day. She exhaled too much and too often. She chirped like a bird as she greeting Marie and Dan, and then turned to me to kiss me on the cheek.

“Twitterpated” came to mind.

She exhaled again. “Honey,” she said. “I’m so sorry. I misplaced my phone all day. I had to go home and get my the number for messages, and when I checked it, I got your message and just changed as quick as I could and...” She exhaled again, and blew at her bangs, and then plopped into a chair. “It’s been *some* day.”

Marie smiled at her and assured her it was just fine, and asked her where she went shopping. Dan looked at me and shook his head, but I suspect he was thinking about shopping. Scarlett smoothed her hair, and the heat on her chest and face started to subside.

I watched her as she chatted with Marie. I scanned her body, looking for some telltale sign that she had done something other than what she said she had done. I ran over her story in my mind, finding every fault, trying to stop myself from grilling her.

“Where did you find the phone?” I said, when there was a break in her conversation with Marie.

Scarlett turned to me, and I could have sworn that was utterly confused. “Huh?” she started to say, but she interrupted herself to say something else, so it came out as:

“Hiiii-yuh... oh, my *phone*.”

Pause.

“I never, didn’t find it.”

Pause.

“Uh, yet.”

Pauses. Musicians say that the music is to be found in them, and lawyers don’t say this but the truth is to be found in them as well. Or the lies, depending on how you look at it.

As Scarlett said this, her hand moved around in a small black handbag she had brought with her.

One could interpret this as yet another search for the phone.

One could also interpret it as an attempt to hide the phone.

I tapped my finger on my wine glass. “How come you didn’t call?” I said, my voice as neutral as I could muster. “I was worried about you.”

What happened next is something only I could see, because Scarlett, as I may have mentioned, is a very skilled actress and a very quick thinker. She is an excellent courtroom lawyer for these reasons: she does not lose her cool, she thinks fast and she makes everything she says or does look like it has happened for a reason. She gives nothing away.

But that night, her lips parted slightly, and moved from side to side in a couple of trembling, half-starts to words. Her eyes fluttered – only once, and very quickly – an indecisive twitch rippled across her features. It was nanoseconds in duration, a blip that no one had seen but me.

“This is terrible of me,” she said, her recovery complete, the cover-up lie snatched from the air with grace and speed that rivaled professional athletes. She smiled, looked to Marie with an expression that told us all Marie would back her up on this, whatever it was.

Scarlett sighed, as though confessing a great sin. “I just don’t know your number.”

She gave the admission a mere second to marinate. It was a perfect excuse, a perfectly plausible reason for not calling.

And then she drove it home. She raised her voice to a pitchy, near-hysterical feminine tone, the sort Scarlett *only* used if she was working someone over. Only to ingratiate herself with other women, or to punctuate some point in court. Her startlingly high voice laughed a little. “And then I *realized*. I don’t know *anyone’s* number anymore. I’ve become a complete idiot, incapable of learning ten digit numbers.”

It was such a nice play, I have to hand it to her. Marie took the bait first, laughing the same, high-pitched, fluttering laugh. “Oh, isn’t it just the *worst*? I used to remember things and now I don’t think I could tell you what Dan’s number is. I can’t. I actually can’t think of it. And sometimes I think to myself, what *will* you do if you lose your phone?”

“You’ve got an iPhone!” Dan told his wife emphatically. “It’s all backed up. You have an iPhone, Scarlett, or what do you have?”

Scarlett’s late arrival, and the mystery that surrounded it, were forgiven. Just like that. Now the only thing Dan and Marie cared about were phones.

“I don’t even know!” Scarlett said, laughing. “Honey. Do you?”

She put her hand on my forearm. I looked over at her. She was tucking a loose strand of hair behind her ear. She looked at me, and met my eye. I smiled back, even though, beneath her calm exterior, I could see something troubling.

Was it? Was it troubling, or troubled? Or was it mischievous?

“Samsung,” I said, but the waiter was already there and determined to get my wife a drink, right after explaining all the drink specials.

The conversation about phones turned into a series of explorations of similar banalities: whose house was for sale, who had a getaway cabin in the mountains, Santa Fe architecture, golf.

We moved to the restaurant when the air took on the typical evening chill. Dan and Marie sat in a booth across from us. Scarlett inched herself close to me after I sat down. We started perusing the enormous hard-backed menus the waiter brought us, and I felt around in my pockets for an antacid as I pondered the price of things (not listed, of course, but easily estimated as in the godzillions like everything else about this place).

Scarlett is not a cheap date. She doesn't do it for any particular reason, like some women seem to do. She just really likes expensive foods. If you gave her a menu with no prices, and she had no idea what was in each dish, she would gravitate to the most expensive stuff. She likes seafood, especially lobster, and steak, especially filet mignon, and God help you if she gets a hold of the wine list because she barely knows her reds from her whites, but she does get attracted to the most egregiously priced of either. I'm not cheap, and I was making a lot of money by then, but... don't judge me until you take this woman out on a date.

"Hmmm," she said, peeking over the menu at me. I was quite suddenly unconcerned about what she decided to order, because she had a mischievous, sexy expression, and in the light of the restaurant her eyes were smokey gray and her dark mascara framed them behind long, hot lashes. My thoughts returned in quick succession to the blowjob from the morning, to her blowing Alessandro with that same dark, smokey-eye makeup on. I was a lucky man, with an incredibly hot wife.

For some reason her lips seemed wet, and her eyes were sparkling as she brought her fingers thoughtfully to her chin. She had her thigh against mine and her leg was crossed over it; she nudged my calf playfully with her foot. "Should I have the special," she murmured sexually, "or stick to what I know?"

The question was loaded with all kinds of innuendo.

My suspicions all sank their teeth into me even deeper. There was little doubt that this flirty, eye-batting, wet-lipped woman who was tickling my calf with her bare foot under the table was not my usual wife. This was the amped-up, sexualized version of Scarlett, and there was only one reason I could think of for her sudden conversion.

And his name started with "A."

The waiter came back, breaking up the heavy cloud of sex between us, and I quickly scanned the words in search of something to order.

Scarlett folded her menu and handed it to the waiter with a wet, hundred-watt smile that very noticeably made Dan and the waiter shiver a little. "I'll go with the special," she said.

Marie scrunched up her nose. "I hate oysters," she said. "But I love the rest of it..."

"I'll eat the oysters," Scarlett offered. She took a huge sip of wine and held the glass near her lips. "Live a little."

The special was a seafood spectacular, all of which sounded vaguely sexual in its slimy, wet, viscosity and fabled qualities of aphrodisiac.

The waiter finished taking the orders from me and Dan after Marie decided on the special, then changed her mind and had a bland-sounding salad. Marie leaned over the table to speak to Scarlett excitedly as soon as Dan and I started discussing business, which was pretty much all Dan ever talked about.

I kept myself nodding and agreeing with Dan, while I eavesdropped on the two women.

"So... are you still doing lessons with Alessandro?" Marie asked Scarlett, as though she knew exactly what was on my mind and wanted to drive a stake through my heart.

I kept my eyes on Dan and my face rigidly cheerful, but my stomach fell through my lap again, and my cock twitched a little with excitement.

Scarlett put her hand on my thigh. Her pinky finger swiped at the center of my pants, delivering a feathery kiss to the length of my shaft. "Oh, I just don't have the time to commit to Alessandro," she said casually. "But he was a really, really good instructor."

"And not bad to look at," Marie cackled.

Scarlett smiled. I could see it only my peripheral vision, but I knew the kind of smile it was, a secretive and wan smile.

"And you've told him about the..." Marie said, in a low voice. It took me a moment to realize she was probably talking about the surprise trip Scarlett had planned for us, to go to the French Open in Paris, with Dan and Marie.

Dan had been speaking this whole time, in great detail about a lot of complicated contracts, so I was greatly surprised when he turned to Marie, breaking himself off, and shook his head. "You are the worst," he said. "At keeping secrets."

"She already told him," Marie complained.

Beneath the table, Scarlett's hand stroked my thickening cock again and she cast a quick look in my direction. Dan and Marie began to bicker, and they had quite a way of doing it after twenty years of marriage, and so Scarlett turned to me and smiled.

She moved her hand from my thigh, but kept it under the table. I dropped my gaze to see what she was doing, and caught a glimpse of her whole thigh exposed where she had hiked up her dress. She looked straight ahead, smiling at Dan and Marie as though she were entertained by their discussion. I could see the smile was for me, though.

She pulled the skirt all the way up, and my hand traveled to the creamy length of skin she had exposed. Unless they were very tiny, she had no underwear on.

I slid my hand beneath the fabric of the dress, moving toward the center of her legs. Dan and Marie were barking at each other now, the bickering converting into the sort of hardened condescension that people who have been happily married for over twenty years seem to fall in, for the fun of it, where they accuse each other loudly and publicly of being forgetful, deaf, and insane.

But neither Scarlett, with her eyes rapt on Marie and Dan, nor I, were paying attention. Every fiber of my attention was directed at my fingertips, which were sliding into the hot space between Scarlett's thighs, right there at the table, right in front of my boss.

Just as my fingertips found the wet center of her pussy, confirming that she was not wearing any underwear, Scarlett leaned a little to her left, still watching Dan and Marie and smiling for them when either one turned to her to get her agreement. "Right?" Marie would say, about the laundry being wrinkled, and Scarlett would smile and nod.

When her head was very close to mine, and my fingers were deep in the hot flesh of her pussy, she turned her head toward me and met my eyes. She said nothing for a moment, just looked at me, smoldering. Then her lips, glistening and red, moved:

"I was late because I was with Alessandro," she whispered. Her voice skated over my ears and my neck, sending goosebumps racing across my flesh and an electric jolt spiking through my body.

My fingers stopped, and my heart seemed to, as well. The cold, gnawing pain in my gut spread, paralyzing me, sucking me into a vortex

where it was only me, and Scarlett. Her lips were close to mine, but she leaned closer.

I rubbed the hardened button of her clit, and my own cock threatened to split open, or at least split open my pants. Her cheeks flushed, and it was unknown to me if it was shame, or just the excitement of what we were doing.

“Scarlett, back me up on this,” Marie yelled, waving her hands in Scarlett’s direction. Marie was drunk, and so was Dan, so they were both louder than usual and not observant at all. My fingers dipped into Scarlett’s hole, and the heat of her body traveled through me. I loosened my necktie with my free hand.

“Mmm,” Scarlett said, opening her eyes and looking at Marie attentively, while my fingers stroked her slowly beneath her dress.

“The only reason that men bring you flowers, is to get you into bed...”

Scarlett’s lips parted slightly, and next to me, I could feel her thigh go rigid. She was doing an excellent job of keeping her face pleasant and reactive as Marie droned on and on. But I could feel her body twitch as she got closer and closer to the edge.

Inside my own mind, I was managing rolling my eyes in camaraderie whenever Dan looked over at me in response to something Marie said, and thinking about Scarlett’s words.

“With” Alessandro? With-him, with-him? With him in a way that meant that the slippery juices on my fingertips were Alessandro’s cum, and that my wife had a pussy-full of another man’s seed leaking onto her dress while I fingered her?

Or just having a coffee with Alessandro?

Scarlett’s lips parted and she let out an exhale.

I slipped my fingers from beneath her dress and placed my hand on the seat, stroking her bare thigh.

Scarlett’s disappointment fluttered over her skin, and her body rippled a little, but she kept her cool. “I agree completely,” she said, when Marie waited for an answer.

This evidently was not the sort of response Marie had been waiting for. She must have recognized that Scarlett was miles away, and she sort of deflated.

Luckily, at that moment, the waiter arrived with our main courses, and the attention was directed at him. I took advantage as he spoke, handing out the plates and describing the meals again, and leaned close to Scarlett. “Did you fuck him?” I asked.

Scarlett looked at me, and for a moment she seemed like another person entirely. I could not have said, for any amount of money in the world, what she was going to say or do.

Scarlett said nothing. She picked up an oyster and brought it to her lips. She ran her tongue along the edge of the shell, and licked at the slimy creature pooled inside of it.

I cocked my head.

Scarlett tipped the shell into her mouth and sucked up the oyster. She kept her eyes on mine, but was speaking to Marie when she said:

“Oh. You just don’t know what you’re missing.... Marie. These oysters are *so* good.”

I watched her eat another one, her cheeks still rosy from the rush I’d given her by taking her almost to the edge. Marie watched her eat the oysters as well.

“Did you get some sun today?” Marie said finally.

Scarlett waved her hand in front of her face and smiled at me. “It’s just the wine,” she said casually. And then, by way of changing the subject, she started in on her lobster.

Dinner was otherwise uneventful.

We took a cab home, because Dan insisted. I had only had a few glasses of wine and was not inebriated, but drunk driving as a lawyer is fairly stupid thing to do and arguing with your boss even more so.

Scarlett leaned against the door with her hand up to her head, facing me. She raised her eyebrows.

“So?” I said. “I thought that was ‘it’ for lessons with Alessandro.”

Scarlett shook her head. Her eyes seemed heavy as she blinked. “I thought so, too,” she said. “But then he... then I saw him, out by the pool, and he came by to chat.”

“So you slept with him,” I said, half-bitterly, half with a rising panic from the excitement I felt.

Scarlett studied me. “No,” she said, mysteriously. “Not then.”

My stomach felt cold again.

“Not then,” I huffed. “But later.”

Scarlett chewed on the end of her finger. I didn’t like the way she was looking at me.

Don’t get me wrong, the way she was looking at me was absolutely the hottest thing I have ever seen in my life. Scarlett had obviously done a very naughty thing and fucked Alessandro, and furthermore, she seemed quite pleased with herself. This had me turned on as much as it had me incensed.

The cabbie had on some Nortena music that drowned almost everything out, and he did not seem interested in what we were doing or saying back there. I slid closer to Scarlett and worked my hand between her legs.

She was so dripping wet that the insides of her thighs were sticky, and I could now smell the scent of her, and what I thought might be Alessandro’s cum. Though I couldn’t be sure. It was mostly her, and I worked my hand up to her pussy and plunged my fingers into her hole.

“And so,” I said, and my voice was trembling with an excitement I couldn’t hide. “Do you have a pussy full of Alessandro’s cum?”

Scarlett grinned, and we made out in the back of the taxi cab in such a way that the driver seemed very angry when he told us we were at home. We barely made it through the front door of our town home before we started pulling our clothes off.

Scarlett pushed me gently backward and bent her arm to take off her dress. The material peeled away from her, hung loosely on her frame for a moment, and then slithered away from her body, revealing every inch of her naked skin. She had not been wearing panties or a bra. I stared at her body, toned and fit, younger than her actual age. Her lean legs, her smooth navel, her pert, upturned breasts and the chewy nipples in the center. The sheen of excitement on her inner thighs, just above her dripping, engorged pink gash.

“Did you fuck him?” I asked her, my eyes taking her body in inch by inch, looking for the evidence of another man. Scarlett’s hand dropped to her pussy, her fingers fluttering over the reddened skin there, leading me to the answer.

My stomach went cold but the rest of me was on fire. “You little slut,” I said quietly, and Scarlett smiled, dipping her fingers into her pussy.

I shrugged out of my clothes and jumped on her at the same time, my mouth insistent on her, claiming her again, exploring her for traces of

Alessandro, as if there would be any. Maybe there would be.

I released her and pushed her onto the tiled floor. It was cold but she didn't react to it: her body was hot and her eyes were on mine. She pulled me by my erect cock to her cunt and guided me in, then arched her back and pushed her hips against me, grinding into me hard and urgently.

"He fucked me," Scarlett said, her lips very close to mine. She had begun to do this thing with her mouth, where she talked very close to my lips, dragging hers over mine and flicking her tongue out to tease me, never really letting me get at her mouth. She did this now as she told me what had happened: "But then, before he came, I went down on him and licked his cock clean. And then I licked his balls. And then he came in my throat, and I swallowed it all."

I was gone by the time Scarlett whispered the word "balls" in my ear, and the image of Scarlett on her knees with the big hairy sack of her tennis instructor dribbling into her mouth, her own pussy juices sticky on her chin, floated through my mind. I was yelling as I fucked my cum inside of her, staring at her dirty, just-fucked mouth that I had my tongue in only moments before, when she started talking about swallowing his seed. It was a miracle I even heard what she said, but I did, and each word was a jagged little spike in the jolts of pleasure that racked me from head to toe.

Scarlett's eyes rolled back in her head and she clutched my ass and ground herself against me to make herself come. I wondered what she was thinking about, there in the privacy of her own mind: was it Alessandro, and the musky scent of his cock, the slippery feel of his wet balls in her mouth, the taste of his cum in the back of her throat? Or was it me? Which one did I want it to be?

I kissed her again and lay on top of her as we both panted heavily, looking into each other's eyes.

I'm not really sure how it happened, because if I tried to imitate the move while I was sober or even a second time, I would be tempting fate and someone would definitely end up with a cracked-open head. As I sat up, a few moments later, I pulled Scarlett with me along the tiled floor, so that I could stay inside of her, enveloped by the heat of her body. She reached a hand up to me and I pulled her up to wrap around me.

And then, I, Will Green, managed to stand up with my wife wrapped around me, and I carried her to the bedroom, my cock coming back to life

in full as I walked. I pushed her onto the bed, and we began again to make love, though more slowly this time.

It was strange, incredibly intimate and some of the hottest sex I've ever had. Missionary style, with no dirty talk, only our shared secret and the images I was creating in my mind of Scarlett, my wife, spreading her legs like a little whore for Alessandro. It was a long, languid lovemaking session, and when I came I rolled to my side and we held each other in the dark like we used to, as though we had only first fallen in love.

"Is this the first time you've seen him since you... slept with him the first time?" I asked her, after a long time.

Scarlett placed a hand above her head and twisted on the mattress to cock her head at me. Her eyes narrowed. "Wait, you think I would fuck Alessandro and not tell you about it?"

I brought her hand to my lips to smooth things over. I kissed her smooth skin. "Of course not," I said. "I just..."

I just, what? What was I about to say, anyway?

Scarlett was beautiful, confident and sexier than ever. Telling me she had fucked Alessandro in the restaurant while I had my fingers in her pussy had been the sort of wild, inventive, whoreish thing I had always believed I wanted Scarlett to do. Fingering her right in front of my boss had been thrilling.

But there was something about Scarlett's newfound confidence that, while I liked, was not sitting well with me. Confidence had never been something she'd lacked, if you were talking about her legal mind or her competence at her job – but her sexual confidence had not only never been anything like this, I could not have even *imagined* her like this.

I wasn't sure I liked it.

I had the distinct feeling that I was losing control of her.

"I thought you felt out of control, you said, before," I said to Scarlett, who seemed to still be waiting for the end of my sentence. Talk about projecting.

Scarlett sighed. "I did *say* that," she answered cryptically.

I waited.

"...but?..." I prompted.

Scarlett's eyes had closed, her lids seemingly heavy. She had a hard time opening them again. "Hmmm...what? No, yeah, I was just feeling a little bit.... Like I couldn't hit them all if I wanted to."

I furrowed my brow, and Scarlett stopped talking. She was halfway to la-la land anyway, so I didn't try to wake her up. It was curious: she was a light sleeper, not one to fall asleep while talking, and I thought she might be faking. I told her a joke. She didn't laugh.

I licked her ear, just to be sure, and she rubbed it sleepily but didn't open her eyes or shriek.

So I stared at her, wondering what was going on in her mind, until I, too, somewhere in the middle of a thought, fell asleep.

*

Scarlett was awake and looking at me, with her head propped up on her hand. I was about to greet her warmly and say good morning, when I remembered the details of what had happened the night before. The whole day turned for me, into a hall of mirrors.

Scarlett frowned back. She leaned forward and kissed me. "I'm sorry I fell asleep," she said.

There was a long pause. In the sober light of day, everything looked much different than it had the night before. The uneasy feeling I'd been having was creeping back into my body.

It seemed from her expression that Scarlett was troubled by something as well.

She sighed. "I want to... uh, talk about last night. Now. Since I, um, got a little drunk. Last night."

I pushed myself up onto my elbows. "I have to take a piss," I said. I deliberately chose the most masculine, vulgar terminology I could think of. I was surprised by my own behavior. Whatever Scarlett was about to say, as much as I wanted her to say it, I wanted to avoid it as well.

I stared into the toilet bowl and tried hard to "piss," which was difficult because, for all the unease that I was feeling, I had a morning erection, and it was in no small part because – again, no matter how uneasy it made me feel – I was turned on by the thought of what Scarlett had done.

I wondered what Scarlett was going to say, and I tried to find the right response to all of the possibilities. But my head was a thick sludge of incoherent thoughts, and I couldn't even begin to guess at what Scarlett was feeling now, or what I hoped she was feeling.

When I returned from the bathroom, she was staring at the ceiling. “Are you mad?” she asked. She turned to me. “You seem... uh, I don’t know.”

I was, “uh, I-don’t-know.”

She turned back onto her back and looked at the ceiling, and I didn’t answer. I crawled back into bed, taking up the position next to her on my elbow.

We didn’t say anything for a while.

“I don’t know how I feel-” I began.

“I thought you’d be happy that-” she began at the same time.

She turned her head to look at me. “I thought this would be... uh, you know. Okay. Like last time.”

I looked at her and had the sense that my face was blank. Scarlett evidently felt the same uneasiness that I did. If not the same kind, at least she felt like something was wrong.

“It isn’t the same,” I said finally. “I don’t know why, but it isn’t.”

Scarlett played with her hands, looking at her fingers. She had arranged the white sheets over herself very neatly while I was in the bathroom, and her feet were out at the bottom, the linens nicely smoothed.

“I know,” she said.

It was an unexpectedly agreeable answer, one that I mistook for agreement on the thing that was bothering us.

Something that I would only understand later is that Scarlett and I were talking about two different things here. I was talking about myself, and my own feelings. Hers were on another page entirely.

“Why not?” she asked, aloud, to the ceiling and not to me. “I only did it because it worked so well last time. You know?” She rolled over to look at me. “We had such great sex. And then we did last night too. I don’t... I don’t really know why it’s different.”

And then Scarlett did a terrible thing, a thing I hope was just a sincere reaction to her overwhelmed feelings. Her eyes got wet and brimmed over, and fat tears rolled down her cheeks silently.

I did what I think any guy would do in that situation: anything to get her to stop crying.

“Scarlett,” I said hastily. “No, hey, listen...” I moved quickly to the side of the bed and took her hand in mine. I knelt on the ground and wiped a tear away with my thumb. “Scar, listen, I didn’t... don’t listen to me, I

don't know what I'm saying. I know I pushed you into it, and then... it was really hot. I *do* like it. I don't... I don't know what came over me. Just surprise."

Scarlett looked unconvinced, and her eyes were still watering up and spilling over, and I was desperate to amend the situation.

In some ways, what I said next was 100% true.

In other ways, it was not.

But in all ways, it was 100% my own fault what happened after that.

"Scarlett," I told her, very sincerely and very seriously, stroking her hair. "I love you, and this is what I wanted. I was just... drunk. Okay? I like what you did, it's what we... both agreed on, right? We both like it. I think it's good for us, in the end. Okay? I'm so sorry if I made you sad, it's just... I didn't expect it. That's all."

Scarlett was silent, and I played with her hair.

"I just didn't expect this to..." my voice trailed off as I thought about what I was even saying. What hadn't I expected? Had I really not seen this coming, after what happened with Alessandro before? He was an alpha male, a pursuer, the kind of guy who didn't really take no for an answer with women. Scarlett was a hot married woman who was down for having a wild fuck in the locker room. Of course this was going to happen; I had known that all along.

And, I realized, I had really wanted it to. The thing that had bothered me about it was not that it had happened, but that Scarlett had done it so... soon. So easily.

So confidently.

"I just didn't see this coming, like, you know. Last night," I said, unconvincingly.

Scarlett sniffed.

I hugged her to me.

"Scarlett, seriously. We're cool. Don't cry. This isn't a bad thing."

She looked up at me.

"Unless..." I said. "You're not having feelings for -"

Scarlett sat up and pushed her hair from her face indignantly. "Oh God. No!" she said sharply. "The guy's a meat-head."

I laughed. "Meat-head" wasn't a word I thought I'd ever heard Scarlett use before.

“So you aren’t falling in love with him and planning to run away together,” I said, taking her hand.

Scarlett rolled her eyes, so I knew her answer was a genuine “no” when she said sarcastically: “I totally am. I want to run off and live in his rental home and have tons of tennis babies who barely know how to read.”

“They’d be very attractive,” I said, lifting her hand and kissing it, feeling mildly aroused for reasons I really preferred not to think about.

Scarlett swatted at me. Then she wiped a stray tear from her eye. “I don’t want any of this to mess up what we have,” she said. “I mean, what we’ve gotten back. Since.... you know. So, I just want to...confirm. What’s okay and what isn’t.”

“A contract,” I said. “You want you me to write it up?”

Scarlett turned to me and her mouth made dozens of interesting shapes in the space of a few seconds. from smile to grimace and everything in-between. “Uh... no, I think a verbal contract will, uh, be okay.”

“I am an excellent contract lawyer,” I said, hamming it up. It’s a thing I do to get out of serious conversations that make me uncomfortable.

“I don’t... think this is the sort of thing you write down,” Scarlett said, far too seriously.

“Verbal contracts are very problematic.”

Scarlett stared at me. She suddenly realized that I was in my joking mode, and reached for a pillow to hit me on the face. “Shut up,” she said.

She stood up and walked toward the bathroom.

“I really am a good contract lawyer.”

“Then it’s a good thing you went into contract law,” she said dryly as she closed the bathroom door.

The smile on my face was both genuine and forced, as I stared at the sheets and pondered what the hell was happening in my marriage.

*

Between the time that Scarlett and I left for the trip she had planned with Dan and Marie to the French Open, and that conversation, Scarlett carried on an affair with Alessandro. We never got around to making a detailed verbal contract, only a loose one in which she promised to tell me everything that happened between them.

As far as I know, she complied with that agreement. She told me when she had slept with him, she gave me details – or at least started to, because they often got me so wound up that she wasn't able to finish.

I wouldn't say I was perfectly happy with the arrangement, because that would be a lie. I was constantly having to check my jealousy, to drown my paranoid thoughts (that Scarlett was falling for Alessandro, that she wasn't telling me everything, that she would soon tire of me because he was so much more inventive in bed and thicker in her pussy). But it was a wild, hot ride every day that she went to the club to work out, or texted me that she would "be home a little late." I both hated and loved waiting for her to return, to tell me where she had been, to feel for myself that she had been with another man.

Before long, it was time for our trip, and I was relieved to have a break from the ups and downs of Alessandro and my wife. But the affair was always in the background, always in my thoughts, and I couldn't help ruminate constantly on how present it was in hers. I toyed with the idea of telling her to make France our clean break from Alessandro, but I wasn't able to do it. Alessandro was as much an addiction for me as it was for Scarlett.

It didn't matter: several days into our trip, something happened to force my hand.

CHAPTER 4

After the final match of the qualifying rounds, we lingered around Roland Garros, exploring the neighborhood and basking in the charged atmosphere of the Open. Athletes were all around us, people were excited, and the weather was complying with a spring-like air that made everything feel hopeful and charged.

“Alessandro wants me to video chat with him,” Scarlett said out of nowhere, her arm linked in mine.

Dan and Marie were slightly ahead of us, and a cool breeze caught a whip of Scarlett’s hair and dragged it over my neck. Two sets of chills traveled through my body.

The idea of Scarlett video chatting with Alessandro, while I watched or listened in, had a definitive appeal. Particularly if it somehow became raunchy. Particularly because I was craving encountering some way to *see* her with him.

On the other hand, this sudden re-injection of Alessandro in our lives, all the way across the ocean where I had been toying with the idea of Scarlett ending things with him, was unexpected and chilling. The idea of the two of them having a potentially sweet and intimate conversation filled me with dread.

“This isn’t, like, a video chat just to say ‘hi,’ is it?” I asked suspiciously.

Scarlett squeezed me closer to her. “I don’t think Alessandro is the ‘say hi’ kind of guy.”

I raised my eyebrows. My mouth desperately wanted to form the words: “So, no?” and get confirmation that it was a different kind of video chat, but I withstood the immense pressure to do so. I was trying to conduct myself with a modicum of decorum.

“When does he want to do this?” I asked.

Scarlett pushed her hair from her face. Her expression was odd: a little glassy-eyed, a little vacant. “I don’t know,” she said. “I guess, any time.”

We kept walking, and I wasn’t sure from the silence whether Scarlett wanted me to give her my approval, or say something, or even object to the

idea.

“So... are you going to?” I asked finally.

“If you -”

“Scarlett!” Marie shrieked suddenly. She was pointing at a muscled, blonde-haired tennis player, a Serbian whose name was unintelligible to me but whom we had seen in the Qualifying Rounds. He was strolling down the opposite street with another player whose name I couldn’t remember.

“You’re shameless!” Scarlett hissed.

“Hiiiiii!” Marie said. His attention had been caught by Marie’s shriek. She had her hand up in the air. “We love you!” she shouted.

Dan looked back at me and rolled his eyes.

Scarlett looked straight ahead.

The player raised his hand and smiled graciously.

He was looking at Scarlett.

The interruption proved fatal to our conversation about whether or not to video chat with Alessandro. It had seemed to me that my wife had something to say, but when she brought the topic up again, she did so as though we had already made the decision for her to “chat” with Alessandro.

She received a text after dinner as we headed back to the hotel. She swiped at her screen while I looked straight ahead, feigning only the most peripheral interest in what she was doing on her phone.

“Okay... so I told him I could do it around ten our time. That way he can make it home from the club.”

I blinked. In all of the arrangements, I’d forgotten about the time change, and the fact that Alessandro would be talking to my wife in the afternoon in his part of the world. For some reason, my excitement started to fade: maybe his wasn’t really a sexually-themed call at all.

And then the peculiar jealousy, the one that made almost no sense to me, given all that had transpired, began to eat away inside of me. It was a corrosive pain that started deep in my chest and spread outward: the jealousy that my wife was having a more emotional relationship with Alessandro. Perhaps he really just wanted to chat with her.

Perhaps she just really wanted to chat with *him*.

“I told him I would find an excuse to leave dinner or the bar or something,” Scarlett said, as we walked up the steps to the lobby of our hotel. She was still typing into her phone, with no more affect than if she

were answering a work email, but still. She was paying more attention to *him*, to her plans with Alessandro, than she was to me. “I think he likes the idea of me having an affair under your nose.”

A new heat flared up inside of me. I really liked the idea that Alessandro enjoyed thinking he was pulling one over on me, fucking my wife without me knowing. I was buoyed by this last piece of information.

We stepped into the elevator. “He does, does he?” I said romantically.

“Shoot,” Scarlett said, shaking her phone in her hand for some reason. “I forgot these don’t work in the elevator.”

I plucked the phone from her hand and began to scan the messages between her and Alessandro.

“Hey,” she complained, but she moved toward me only to get closer to me, to slide her hands around my waist and crane her neck to look at the screen with me. “You aren’t spying on my super-secret messages with my secret lover, are you?”

She kissed me on the mouth. I kissed her back, but I held the phone so I could see it. The elevator was rising, adding a layer of queasiness to my already stormy insides. I pulled away from her as we reached our floor. A faint ding signaled the opening of the doors, and we began to step out. “How come these messages only go back to like a week ago?” I asked.

Scarlett was ahead of me, walking quickly toward our room, taking the key out of her purse. She didn’t look back, and she didn’t miss a beat.

“I delete them, usually,” she said. She inserted the key while I stared at the back of her head. I had been up and down emotionally, and to such extremes, in just the elevator ride, that I was feeling a little nauseous.

The door rejected the card twice before clicking open. Scarlett leaned against it to open it, a habit she had whenever she was denied entry on an electronic card reader the first few times. She seemed to think that even though she’d been given the green light on the final swipe, she needed to break the door down like a cop, and leaned all her weight into it.

As soon as she was in the room she looked back at me as she walked toward the bed. “I don’t want anything compromising on my phone.”

I stopped short of the bed, which Scarlett bounced onto and continued bouncing on as she took off her shoes.

“But I know about it,” I protested.

Scarlett bounced a little more and gave her hair a little toss. It had turned quite bright in the sun; Scarlett had the sort of natural highlights that

I know a lot of women believed were from a bottle, and a few streaks of her hair became almost platinum if she got a lot of sun.

“But do you know *all* about it?” Scarlett asked me. She leaned back on her elbows with her legs crossed, hanging over the edge of the bed. The white blouse she’d thrown on for lunch parted where it was unbuttoned, and her breasts spread the gap in the fabric open for a nice view of her tits. She twisted her ankle seductively and grinned at me.

The expression on her face was playful, and so I knew, intellectually, she meant to be a tease. Intellectually I knew that she was only covering her ass, hiding the messages so that they didn’t somehow come back to haunt her.

But my imagination was running wild with the idea.

“What sort of messages is Alessandro sending you?” I asked, moving toward her and rubbing my knee on the inside of her leg.

Scarlett grinned and lay back fully on the bed.

She didn’t answer. I unzipped my shorts and pulled my shirt over my head.

“Is he sexting you?”

Scarlett laughed when I said “sexting.” The word sounded uncomfortable even in my own mouth. I smiled, but I kept moving in toward her, straddling her on the bed now that I was naked, pulling her light blue skirt up as I made my way to rest, lowering myself lightly to her hips. My cock flopped heavily on her blouse, and I pulled at each button of her blouse, popping the shirt open further.

Scarlett had taken to dressing more sexily, and today was no exception: she had not worn a bra beneath the white blouse, which was made of a thick material but one which would not have hidden it completely from view if her nipples were hard, as they were now.

I was beyond seeing the silhouette of her tits through the fabric now, anyway. I pulled on the buttons and the shirt fell open. I moved my cock over her navel, and her silky skin kissed the underside of my shaft.

Scarlett brought her arms to the side of her head and flitted her pinkie finger around her lips. “Sometimes he does,” she said, answering my question.

My cock twitched, and Scarlett seemed to like my excitement because she smiled even more mischievously.

“Do you ever masturbate while you do that?” I asked her.

Scarlett looked a little embarrassed for just a second. Her eyes shifted and she dropped her hand from her lips. She recovered quickly though, fluttering her eyes. "Maybe," she said sexily.

I ran my hands over the mounds of her breasts. "You do, huh?" I mused. "When did you do that?"

Scarlett's temporary embarrassment seemed to be completely overcome in an instant. She slipped a hand around my cock and ran it over my shaft, taking her time at the ridge of the crown and the head, rubbing me with the flat part of her palm. She dropped her fingers around my shaft like a light rain, and with a feathery touch she drew her hand away, closing her fingertips together at the crown. She repeated this several times, and then she clutched my cock and tugged it gently toward her.

I rocked from side to side as she pulled my dick toward her mouth, to settle my straddle over her chest. I could feel her hard nipples brushing against the back of my thighs.

She guided the tip of my dick to her lips, and brushed it over them. "I did it one night while you were sleeping," she said. "Rather than wake you up."

Her tongue emerged from her mouth and made a swirl around my crown. I shuddered, watching the pink of her tongue and her lips. She flicked the blade of her tongue at the bead of precum that had emerged at the top of my dick.

"In bed?" I asked, pressing for details. "In bed while I slept?"

Scarlett could tell that this is what I wanted, because my cock was pulsing wildly in her hand. She could feel my desire to hear about her escapades in the coiled energy of my veins, and precum dribbled messily into her mouth.

She met my eyes. Her lips tickled my cock as she spoke:

"I did it while you were sleeping. I just spread my legs open and played with myself, looking at a picture of Alessandro's cock."

I leaned over her face, holding myself up against the headboard. "Did you?" I asked. I put my hand behind her head, and she opened for me, having anticipated already that I wanted to get her mouth around my dick.

Holding her head in my hand and my weight up on the headboard, I shoved myself deep into her throat.

Since sleeping with Alessandro, or whatever you wanted to call what she was doing, my wife had become a lot more... pliant, I suppose, was the

only way to say this. I wasn't entirely sure if it was her – that Alessandro had trained her to take his cock all the way into her throat, and massage it with her esophagus like she sometimes did to me. Or perhaps it was that I had become less inhibited in what I tried on her, knowing that Alessandro had fucked her so thoroughly.

I started to fuck her mouth, holding her head to my pelvis as I rammed deep inside of her. I no longer felt the satisfying gag when I reached the back of her throat: I suspected that only Alessandro's huge cock would make her do that. I wondered if this was how he fucked her, and if she did for him what she was doing for me, looking at my eyes, even as hers watered up and her mascara streaked.

I slowly slid my cock from her mouth so I wouldn't come yet. The sound was filthy and sticky, and saliva clung to my cock and dribbled down to her chin. Her face was a mess.

I rubbed my dick on her lips. It was wet with her spit now, and she blinked away the tears that had formed as her eyes watered.

"Does Alessandro fuck your mouth like that?" I asked.

"Of course he does," Scarlett said. "He's teaching me how to throat fuck."

My whole torso went cold. Scarlett leaned forward and started to take my cock into her mouth, but I pushed her back and then very swiftly flipped her over and made my way down her body at the same time. When I was at her knees I lifted her by the hips to a doggie-style position on her hands and knees.

I thrust inside of her, picturing Alessandro slamming his cock into her face, imagining her loving it, and it was not long at all before my seed was exploding inside of her.

Panting, we collapsed on the bed.

It was in these moments that I had the strangest sensation, of being both incredibly close to Scarlett, and yet somehow the anxiety that she was floating away from me was never far from the forefront of my thoughts. I lazily traced my fingers along the shapely curves of her body on its side, from her shoulder to the dip of her waist, along the pretty roundness of her hip, down her thigh as far as I could reach.

I fell asleep, like I had so many times since this wild adventure had begun, clinging to Scarlett as though she would disappear, even if her hot skin was against mine and she was in my arms.

We awoke when our hotel phone blared next to Scarlett's ear. She groaned, and reached for it, knocking a few things off the night stand. I sat up like a bolt. The room had gotten dark, and I was overcome by that disturbing sensation one gets when he's fallen asleep in the afternoon and woken in the early evening. A panic about all the things I'd possibly forgotten set in on me, and the dream I'd been having tainted my perception as it cleared from my mind.

"Hello?" Scarlett said. She reached for her cell and I reached for mine. There were several notices of messages from both Dan and Marie, asking where we were.

"Oh my gosh," Scarlett said. She rolled over with the phone to her ear to look at me incredulously. I could barely make out her face in the blueish light of the evening. "We just... fell asleep. So sorry. Where are you guys?"

She listened and then held the phone to her chest. "Marie wonders if we're coming to dinner," she whispered.

I shook my head. Now that I knew what time it was, and the cobwebs were clearing from my head, I remembered Scarlett's "date" with Alessandro. I had quickly calculated that it was coming soon.

"He's rubbing his stomach," Scarlett said. My eyes went wide. "I think he maybe feels sick. Yeah, he's nodding to that," she said to Marie.

I squinted. Scarlett smiled. "You know, I think maybe we'll just go to bed early and order some room service," Scarlett said.

Marie had a lot to say about that, to which Scarlett said only, "Thank you."

I raised my eyebrows suspiciously again. "What?" I prompted.

Scarlett fell back on the bed. "What, what?" she said.

"What did Marie say about room service?"

Scarlett looked at me. "Oh," she said. Then her eyes went to the ceiling. I couldn't help but imagine that she had shared some secret with Marie and now she was inventing something, as stupid as that theory might sound.

"She said it's ultra, crazy expensive and don't order lobster, it isn't fresh."

I relaxed against the headboard. I punched the crazy square pillow and pushed my head into it. It was about an hour until it was time to call

Alessandro. I reached over and stroked Scarlett's arm. She had turned on her side to face me.

"I'm going to order it anyway," she said excitedly. Then she held up her phone. "We have just enough time for some snacks. I don't know about you but I'm starving. Oh. And they said we could meet them later in the hotel bar if we feel better."

She used air quotes for "feel better." This made me feel like Marie perhaps knew perfectly well that we weren't tired or ill.

"You haven't told Marie about Alessandro, have you?" I asked.

Scarlett let out a huge laugh. Then she turned back toward me and looked me up and down. "God no," she said. She slipped her phone onto the night table. "What would I do that for?"

I shrugged. "I don't know," I said. "To have someone to talk to."

I felt a little dejected as I said this, though I would never have admitted it to Scarlett. It was as if I had actually overheard her telling Marie about her affair, I got so worked up about it.

Scarlett put her hand on my face. "Marie doesn't know anything," she said. "At least I don't think so. I'm still trying to figure out if Marie did it with him or not."

Scarlett did not seem upset by the prospect, which was reassuring.

"Would you care if she did?" I asked.

Scarlett fell onto her elbow and gave me a funny look. "Why would I?" she asked.

Then she leaned forward and kissed me. "Alessandro is just a fling," she said.

We started to kiss, and soon I was inside of her, her legs wrapped around my waist, her heels in the small of my back.

But I couldn't fully shake my unease, even when I filled her full of my come.

We ate our "snacks" (about \$200 worth) sitting on the bed. Scarlett was cross-legged and occasionally checked her phone like a teenage girl waiting on a text from a crush in her class.

Each time she studied the phone, and her face fell when she didn't have a message from Alessandro, my own skin burned from the inside out. And when her eyes lit up at his incoming message, and she dropped her food to type excitedly into her phone, my heart fell through my feet.

“Okay,” she said after typing. “I said we were eating dinner out and I would call him when I could sneak away.”

My insides ignited.

Scarlett hopped up. “I’m going to go get ready,” she said. Then she looked at me. “You should get ready, too.”

“I thought I wasn’t here,” I said.

Scarlett smiled. “But you *are*. And now you get to watch the whole thing.”

I reached for her, trying to grab her bottom, but she was too fast and slipped away before I could.

She dug into her suitcase and then disappeared into the bathroom with a silky-looking red fabric bunched up in her hand. When she came out some minutes later, she was dressed in a purple-red camisole and silky pajama shorts suit. The cut of the shirt was deep and framed the shape of her breasts, including the shape of her nipple, under the shiny, thin fabric. The shorts barely covered her bottom, and the color added a slutty flare to the remarkably simple but sexy outfit. It made her look years younger and the tiniest bit trashy.

“New?” I asked.

She smiled at me. “Alessandro got it for me,” she said.

My cock throbbed. “Oh he did, did he?”

I didn’t like that Alessandro was buying her gifts, telling her what to wear. I did and I didn’t. But the thing that made me most uneasy was that she didn’t say anything about stuff like that until a moment like this.

I decided, though, to save this observation for a later time. In truth, I cared more about my vista into their video chat than the fact that Scarlett had forgotten to mention a silky pajama.

For now.

She climbed onto the bed and opened her laptop.

I settled into the small armchair facing the bed, a little unsure of what to do with myself. Scarlett looked over the top of the computer at me, the blue glow of the screen casting a flattering flash over her skin. Her eyes looked dark, her skin looked pale, and the appearance was alluringly gritty.

The dull tone of the ring blared. She reached forward and adjusted the volume. It rang and rang, and I began to feel disappointed. Scarlett started to say, “Maybe he’s not-”

And then a queer sound emanated from the app – something called Viber I’d never heard of – and I heard the rattling of something far across the ocean.

“Bella,” said Alessandro’s distorted, computerized voice, a slight delay stretching the final vowel.

Scarlett smiled, and I scrutinized her face. She looked honestly, and believably, happy to see the image on the screen. “Hi,” she said throatily.

There was a long pause, and it burned through me, turning my insides to embers.

“You look beautiful, bella, but why are you in the dark?”

Scarlett laughed, and it sounded genuine. “It’s night,” she said.

“Ah, yes. No lights in France.”

Another clatter from his end. I couldn’t see the screen, but it seemed like he might have been in the kitchen. It was a big let-down for a moment.

Scarlett smiled, and dared to lift her eyes up to meet mine. Then she jerked them nervously back to the screen.

“Where’s your husband?” Alessandro asked.

“Uh... well, down at the bar,” Scarlett said uneasily. “So, if I let you go right away, that’s why.”

Alessandro made a sound, from where I was it seemed like he was sucking on his lip. “Playing dangerously,” he said.

Alessandro seemed to be very disinterested in how Scarlett was going to hide her affair from me. He didn’t seem to care that he was potentially breaking up a happy marriage, or about what would happen to Scarlett if she got caught.

Scarlett said nothing.

There was a curious unease to Scarlett now that she was talking to Alessandro, one I couldn’t exactly put my finger on. Her eyes moved nervously, not sure where to look: she seemed to want approval from me at the same time that she didn’t, and she seemed to want to display the confidence she had gained for Alessandro but was unable to do so completely. The sensation of slippage, slippage of my control on the situation, vis a vis Scarlett, came back to me.

“It’s good to see you,” Alessandro said. “I miss my beautiful *gattina*.”

My chest burned with jealousy. Pet names? Italian pet names? Jesus. I was pretty sure, from seventh-grade Spanish, that “gattina” meant some

version of “cat,” and from the way he said it, “pussy-cat” was probably the best English translation.

I waited, watching Scarlett’s lips, desperate for her not to say back to him that she missed him, too.

“Did you?” she said instead. Her voice was an unusual conflation of teasing and slight lack of confidence. I couldn’t tell if that was because she cared if he actually missed her, or because she felt awkward teasing him. Or maybe even something else.

“I did,” Alessandro said cheerfully. “I very much missed tasting your sweet *fica*.”

Scarlett bit her lower lip.

“Maybe you want to give me just a taste?” Alessandro said.

Scarlett looked from side to side, as though she had an audience watching her perform onstage and wanted to convey “sneaky.” She laughed nervously. “Will should be back any minute,” she said.

“So...?” Alessandro said. “Just a little taste. Show me your beautiful titties, give me something to think about all day.”

As much as the word “titties” made me cringe (and I felt sure Scarlett was no fan of it, either), I had a growing erection.

Scarlett chewed her lips once again.

“Come on, *gattina*,” Alessandro said, his voice suddenly huskier and more commanding. He seemed to have leaned in toward the speaker to give her a deep growl. “Show me. I want to see your little strawberry nipples.”

Scarlett looked at me over the computer. Alessandro seemed to take no note of this. He was purring or growling in a low rumble, egging her on. I nodded almost imperceptibly.

Scarlett crossed her arms at the waist and lifted her shirt.

She was wearing a bra beneath it, one I had never seen before. It was a sheer material that did not hide her nipples, hardened into tiny pink pebbles, or do much besides lightly discolor her skin through a gauzy red fabric.

“That’s a very nice brassiere,” Alessandro said. “But still I cannot see them.”

Scarlett unhooked her bra, and the material peeled away from her skin.

Alessandro made another lewd noise and smacked his lips. “I cannot wait to bite into that one, the left one, and make you scream.”

Scarlett blushed, very faintly, and I could see from the faint glistening of her skin that he was making her perspire.

"I'm still not satisfied," Alessandro said. "I want to see more of you. I want to see your bare little *fica, gattina*."

Scarlett laughed nervously, and looked off to the side again. "I don't _"

"Just show me a little peek," he cajoled. "Come on."

Scarlett gave me a fleeting glance, during which I attempted to indicate that she should continue. She rose up to her knees, and her hands slid beneath the waist of her little shorts. They were silk, and clung to her body, so before she even played with the waist, Alessandro was growling in approval. Scarlett kept her eyes on the screen, her fingers running along the waist in a teasing play of stripping.

"*Gattina*," Alessandro growled. "Show me your little pussy, let me see it."

Scarlett hesitated and bit her lip again.

I willed her to look at me again, but she didn't, and there I felt that sensation of slippage even more strongly.

Scarlett slipped the shorts down an inch, and then stopped, tilting her hips one way and posing for the camera.

"You're going to tease me, are you, *gattina*? You know that if you're a bad girl, I will have to discipline you."

My cock jumped. Scarlett's lips parted, and her eyes went wide. I was dying to know what "disciplining" meant, or if it had ever happened and was something that Scarlett had neglected to tell me, and it was all I could do to stop myself from jumping up and asking.

"Come on, little pussy cat," Alessandro said. "Show me your pussy."

She tugged at the shorts again, and a few more inches of her skin appeared. The shorts began to roll down, and Alessandro coaxed her:

"That's it, come on. Be a good *gattina* for Alessandro and let me see your little pussy."

Scarlett rolled the shorts down completely, and her narrow pink slash, embedded in the mounds of her porcelain-white lips, was cast in the white-blue computer light. Another sucking sound emanated from the speakers.

"Now touch it for me," Alessandro said.

Scarlett's eyes darted toward me, and she looked a little scared. She left her eyes on mine, and that's when I saw the faintest smile on her lips.

“But Will,” she said, in almost a whisper. “He might come in any minute.”

“Touch it for me,” Alessandro repeated. “I want you to touch your pussy and make yourself come while I watch you, *gattina*. Don’t disappoint me, little pussy cat.”

Scarlett dropped her eyes to the screen, which I wished desperately I could see. A faint smile appeared on her lips, again one that had an odd gleam to it. She brought a hand to her navel and trailed her fingers along her skin. Where she touched herself, the few very fine blonde hairs on her stomach, illuminated blue in the light of the computer, stood on end as she made her own skin pebble with goosebumps.

Down, down her fingers traveled until they paused, hovering over the split, nectary gash of her pussy. I had ceased to breathe as I waited for her, probably Alessandro waited with the same baited breath. Then, Scarlett slipped her long, well-manicured finger into her pussy. A sticky sound crackled in the air and made my cock flex as I watched her begin to stroke herself, her eyes on the screen, the man on the other end of the video chat watching my wife finger herself.

I could hear Alessandro’s ragged breaths between his words, and I pictured him with his fat cock in his hand, stroking it as he watched Scarlett and talked to her:

“Molto bene, little *gattina*, that’s it, show me how you make yourself come while you think about me. Are you thinking about having my cock inside your hot little pussy?”

Scarlett closed her eyes and nodded, and then opened them again. My groin twitched so violently that my arm jerked on the armrest.

“Maybe you’re thinking about having my cock in your ass,” Alessandro growled.

For a moment I wasn’t sure I heard him right, but he went on:

“I can’t wait to have my cock inside your ass. So silky, so hot, it’s such a nice little ass. I’m thinking about how I put my fingers in there...” he paused, catching his breath, as the idea obviously made him as excited as it did me. “Oh, *gattina*...” Alessandro then broke off into Italian, all of which sounded incredibly filthy but none of which I understood enough to reproduce here.

But as he spoke, my wife stroked her clit, the gushy, sticky sound of her fingers between her own engorged pussy lips getting louder as she moved faster and more violently. The Italian, which she did not speak,

obviously had an effect on her, and her eyes glazed over as she stared at the screen. Imagining, I supposed, the very things he had alluded to, things she had not shared with me: his fingers inside her ass, which I pictured as liberally and filthily as I could.

I pulled my own cock out to stroke it, and after a few moments of Alessandro's dirty Italian talking, Scarlett closed her eyes and I saw her legs tense up and begin to shake as she neared her orgasm.

"Look at me gattina," Alessandro said. "Look at me and tell me how much you want me to fuck your little *culo* full of *seme*."

Scarlett's mouth fell open.

"Tell me."

My own *seme* boiled up from the base of my cock and I squeezed myself to no avail. Ropes of my cum streaked across my thigh and shorts as my wife stroked her clit violently and said: "I want you to fuck me in the ass...oh..."

And then she came, looking right into the screen. I heard Alessandro groan.

There was an awkward silence, while all three of us breathed heavily. Scarlett fell back on her heels and drew her fingers from her pussy to her thigh.

"Such a good girl – no, don't put anything on yet," Alessandro said, as she reached for her camisole. "I want you to suck your cum from your fingers."

Scarlett hesitated again, and cast her eyes over the edge of the screen at me, before she drew her hand up sharply, then back again, then slowly up to her mouth. There, she seemed to overcome her hesitation, and placed her fingers in her mouth up to the knuckles, sucking them loudly.

"Do you have my little present?" Alessandro said, after a murmur of approval.

Scarlett's cheeks went visibly red, even in the glow of the computer.

"I... yes," she said. A new kind of hesitation entered her voice.

"I want you to use it," Alessandro said. "I want you to put it in for me now and keep it in while your husband fucks you, *gattina*."

Scarlett's mouth fell open again, though this time in a much different way. She was scandalized, unsure what to say. Her eyes looked at me, and then back at the screen.

“I want you to do it,” Alessandro purred. His voice had gone silky. “Do it for Alessandro. I want you to think about how I’m going to fuck your little ass raw while your husband is fucking you -”

A plastic slap ended the sound of Alessandro’s voice, as Scarlett slammed the laptop closed.

When she looked at me, her eyes were wide and wild.

My cock, which had never gone completely limp for a moment even after I came, was coming back to full-functioning life already. Scarlett was sitting, naked, on the bed, her hands in her lap, her eyes big and wide.

“What’s the present?” I asked, standing up, sliding the shorts and my underwear down my legs. Images of my imagination, most of them of Scarlett’s pink eyelet being shoved full of Alessandro’s fingers, his cock, his “present,” were filling my head faster than I could make sense of them.

Scarlett said nothing, her mouth moving as though she wanted to say something but no sound leaving her lips.

“Scarlett? I want to know about his present,” I said. I was on the edge of the bed now, and I leaned forward to move the computer to the side.

“What is it?”

Scarlett looked over at her suitcase, propped up neatly on one of those suitcase racks.

I followed her gaze. “Is it in your suitcase?” I asked. I crab-walked to the side of the bed and then walked over to the suitcase and flipped it open.

“What am I looking for?”

I felt like I had gotten my control back, now that Scarlett was dumbfounded and she had hung up on Alessandro. Now it was just me, and my wife, and whatever Alessandro had given her, and I was the one who would get to use it first.

I moved my fingers around in the suitcase. I had some idea of what I was looking for: it didn’t take a genius to figure out that it was something Scarlett would put in her ass. The only question now was how big it was, and what it would look like.

I found it in the netted side pockets: a smooth, enema-shaped bullet, no thicker in the middle than an inch in diameter, with a silky thread attached to the end. I pulled it out and looked at it, turning to Scarlett.

“Is this it?” I asked her.

Her mouth was open, her eyes slightly vacant, She had her hands on her lap still. She nodded.

I moved to the bed and climbed onto it, pulling off my shirt. My cock was erect and solid as rock in front of me; it barely bounced as I climbed on and held up the bullet.

“Did he use this on you already?” I asked.

Scarlett nodded again.

“You didn’t say anything about that, Scarlett,” I said.

Her mouth opened, and then she closed it. She brought her hands to her arms. “I didn’t...” she said. But she didn’t finish her sentence.

“And so?” I said. “Has Alessandro fucked you in the ass?”

“Not yet,” she said quietly.

“But he’s going to.”

My cock pulsed, and Scarlett looked at it.

“If I let him,” she said, becoming more animated. Her tone changed: she seemed less afraid now and more seductive. She sifted on her legs and crawled toward me. “First he has to train me.” She closed her fingers around my cock. “Maybe you want to help me get ready.”

“Tell me what he did with this,” I said.

Scarlett looked up at me. “He put it in,” she purred. “And then we went to dinner.”

Then, very abruptly, she rose up on her knees and scooted to the edge of the bed. She released me and walked over to the suitcase.

I stared at her as she leaned over to fish something out of the suitcase. She turned around when she retrieved it, and I stared idiotically at the small silver item in her hand, trying to make it fit with what we were doing.

“It’s remote-controlled,” she said sensually. She looked at the bullet in my hand. “Turn it on,” she said softly, a smile creeping into her expression.

Transfixed, it took me a moment to look down at the object in my hand.

“It’s at the end, by the rope,” she said.

I pressed the small rubbery button, and nothing happened. I looked back up at her. I felt a little as though I were on Mars, operating NASA equipment, breathing rarefied air, while all the blood in my body filled my cock.

Scarlett teasingly shook the small remote in her hand, and then pressed her thumb against one of two buttons.

The object in my hand began to vibrate.

She turned it off after a moment. She walked to the bed, set the remote on the table, and stretched out on all fours, her backside to me. She arched her back in a very feline stretch, and brought her hand to her bottom. Her long fingers slipped between her legs, into the overflowing juices of her pussy, I stared at her fingers as they drew her juices up to the dull pink ring of her ass.

She played with her ass for a moment, and then she looked at me over her shoulder.

She didn't need to say anything for me to understand the suggestion, her desires. I grasped the object by the end with the rope, and dipped it into her pussy juices to get it slicked up. Then, unable to believe what I was seeing myself do – we had never played this kind of game before – I drew it up to her puckered hole and pressed the vibrator against it.

Scarlett turned and faced away, pushing her bottom back toward me. I applied pressure to the bullet, and at first it seemed to have no give. But then, before my eyes, her eyelet opened, admitting the object, and the whole thing popped in quickly. I was treated to the quick snapshot of her ass opening up, and then it closed around the object as Scarlett gasped in slight pain, and then mewled.

I pushed a finger against the metallic end of the bullet, to move the object around inside of her. I trailed my fingers down the silky rope, and gave it a light tug. Scarlet gasped. “No, don't take it out,” she moaned. She turned back toward me. “I want you to fuck me with it inside,” she said. “And turn it on.”

I stared openly at her for a moment. We never did this sort of thing, so I was momentarily paralyzed by the idea that I was having a very, very lucid dream, and would wake up in my bed splattered in my own cum.

But only for a moment. I reached for the remote, fumbled with it, and finally pressed the right button.

The hum of the dildo was low and almost inaudible. Scarlett gasped, and then I heard it. I pressed a finger to her eyelet and felt the vibration inside of her.

“Fuck me,” Scarlett breathed, pushing her ass back toward me.

I pulled her by the hips toward me and impatiently pushed the silky rope away. I slid into her without hesitation, and the vibrations of the dildo rumbled through the thin membrane between her two channels and lapped at my cock.

“Fuck,” I breathed. I could feel an orgasm like no other I’d ever experienced brewing inside of me. A numbing tingle took over my back, as I began to fuck my wife with her ass filled up by a vibrating bullet given to her by another man.

“Oh!” Scarlett moaned. I plunged deep inside of her and gripped her ass, grinding my balls against her pussy. They stuck to her bare, soaked lips and then swung out as I thrust backward and into her again and again. All the while the vibrations ran over my dick through her skin.

“Oh, I’m going to come, I’m going to come so har-”

Scarlett didn’t finish her sentence because at that moment she did come, very very hard, and the vibrating object started to squeeze out of her ass as she shook all around me and bucked wildly. I pushed my thumb into her to keep it inside and rammed deep into her just in time to explode deep in her pussy.

“Oh God,” Scarlett moaned, her hips thrusting wildly in my hands. She started to squirm, but I kept going, and so did the vibrator. “Oh, no, please no more,” she said, throwing her head back. “Oh!”

I kept fucking her well past when I might have ordinarily, if only to make her squeal. At last, I pressed the off button and thrust up inside of her, pulling her back with me to rest on my heels.

“That was so fucking hot,” I said, holding her to me. She was trying to get off my cock, and I could feel her pussy quivering all around me, over-stimulated, over-fucked.

At last I released her, and she fell forward, then on to her side. “Oh my God,” she said.

She looked at me. “It’s not too much is it?” she asked.

“Is that why you didn’t tell me?”

She brought her thumb to her teeth and chewed on the nail thoughtfully. “I guess I didn’t know how to tell you,” she said at last. And then she looked at me, and we both laughed.

I fell down next to her and put my fingers in her hair.

“I have an idea,” I said.

She grinned, but a bit nervously. “What?”

“You said Alessandro made you wear it to dinner?”

She nodded, understanding creeping into her face. I couldn’t tell if she was nervous or excited about my suggestion, whatever she thought it was going to be.

There was a silence.

“Keep it in,” I told her, kissing her on the forehead. “Let’s go meet Dan and Marie for that drink after all.”

CHAPTER 5

Dan was the only one in the bar, though he had found a few people to talk to. Marie had evidently gotten tired and gone to bed.

Dan was drunk, so there was no hiding his lecherous eyes tracing up and down Scarlett's body as she walked in front of me toward where he was seated on some open-air couches on the roof terrace bar.

Scarlett, at my behest, had finally worn the silver dress in public. Since she had purchased it, she seemed to have lost a little more weight. The metallic material clung to her figure and then released it, hinting at her curves, flashing her skin, and then hiding it away. It was mesmerizing in and of itself.

Dan probably thought he had the best view, as she walked toward him with the deep cut of the dress showing her jiggling breasts, the pebble of her nipples erect against the fabric. The dress didn't cling to her ass, but I still had the better view, because I knew something that no one else knew: beneath the black lace thong that was nestled between her asscheeks, there was a silky red ribbon, attached to a metal vibrator, and in my pocket was the remote that controlled it, which I planned to use whenever the idea occurred to me.

Dan stood up, and the full extent of his inebriation became evident. "Scarlett," he slurred. His eyes were deep between her tits. "You look... you look... you clean up real nice," he bumbled. There was an awkward moment while Dan pulled himself out of his dirty thoughts and turned to the people sitting at the table with him. "This is Steve, he's a bay-area attorney I met at the bar, and James--"

"Jack," a good-looking blonde man said, smoothing his tie, smiling at Scarlett, extending his hand and ignoring me completely, even though I'd stepped up to Scarlett and put my hand possessively on her lower back.

Scarlett shook hands.

"Here," Dan said, moving away from his seat. "Take this one, Scarlett."

Scarlett propped herself up in the only patio chair, and we all arranged ourselves awkwardly on the remaining furniture after introductions.

Scarlett sat with her legs crossed and leaning on each other at an angle, like a fifties film star, one elbow on the armrest, her clutch in her hands as though she were posing for the cover of a magazine.

“Scarlett,” Dan announced loudly, “is quite good at tennis.”

“Is that so?” Jack said. He picked up a drink from the table.

I looked behind me at the busy bar. “Scarlett,” I said, “what can I get you to drink?”

“I’ll have a vodka martini,” Scarlett said, and I managed to keep my eyebrows low. “Dirty.”

I nodded and looked around to see if anyone else had a drink order, but no one could take their eyes off my wife, and no one seemed to realize I was there, so I strolled away with my hand in my pocket, my fingers sliding over the remote control.

At the bar, I ordered her drink and mine, and leaned against a stool, facing the rest of the patio. Scarlett gave me a look as she smiled at whatever Jack was saying to her, and then she tucked a strand of her hair behind her ear and looked back at him attentively.

I fingered the remote. I wondered, would it work from this distance? And what would she do?

I pushed the “on” button.

For a moment I thought I had the wrong one, and I started to take the remote from my pocket to check on it. Scarlett didn’t seem to react: she was mid-sentence and she kept going. But then I saw that her leg twitched and she seemed to flinch. A hot red stain crept over her face from her jawline, uneven and splotchy, like she was out on a very cold day. Her eyes seemed to turn to glass.

I walked back to them and handed Scarlett a drink. Inside her ass, the dildo was humming quietly, and the thought of it made my cock so hard I had to sit down to hide it. Scarlett shifted in her seat, rubbed the back of her neck. Her hand shook a little as she took the drink.

“You okay?” Jack asked her.

“You look a little flushed,” I said, concern in my voice.

Scarlett took a sip of her drink and waved her free hand like a fan. “Just hot,” she said. “I’m not... very tolerant of the... heat.”

I turned the dildo off. Scarlett deflated a little: she had become hard like my cock, her back arched slightly, her muscles tensed, and now she relaxed.

I started to feel drunk on the power of the thing. I wondered how turned on Scarlett was, what I would find if I felt beneath her dress.

We started talking about law, about golf, about tennis. I have no idea. I was only half-there for the conversation, nodding, smiling, while I imagined Alessandro feeding his cock into my wife's ass.

I had never been one for ass-play or anal sex, which Scarlett had never expressed any interest in, either. So it just wasn't part of our sex life. Sure, I enjoyed watching it in porn, to the extent that it seemed to be in all porn, but I had honestly never even entertained the idea that one day I would shove a bullet into my wife's ass, and watch her squirm at a restaurant rooftop bar, in public, while I considered whether to break her ass in later that evening, or let Alessandro do it when we went home.

"Anything else for you?" Jack said, standing up and looking around at the small group gathered together on the couches, which had changed considerably while I had been off in my own thoughts. Scarlett asked for a martini, which was going to be her third, and I gave her a look with my eyebrows raised.

She smiled at me, and when Dan left she leaned back in the chair, uncrossing her legs, and flashed her shiny-wet pussy at me, and then re-crossed them to lean forward toward me. She beckoned me with her hooked finger.

I turned on the bullet and watched her eyes and lips change, trembling, getting wetter. Just like I knew her pussy was. I leaned toward her and she had to catch her breath for a second before she smiled again. I turned the vibrator off.

"How long do you want to stay here?" she asked me. Then she lifted her eyes and looked at the bar. "I think Jack is putting the moves on me, is why I ask."

Of course Jack was putting the moves on her: all men were putting the moves on her. What was different now is that the door was open to the possibility of them getting somewhere. I felt suddenly like I was in free-fall. I looked around the bar, at all of the men, most of whom were stealing glances at Scarlett from time to time, and felt like the whole world might suddenly come crashing down on me.

I watched Scarlett's mouth. Was she suggesting that we go ahead and let the Jack thing play out? Did she want to sleep with him now, too? Did I want her to?

Tendrils of panic started to creep around my heart. IS this what I had wanted? Is this where we were headed? Would Scarlett now turn into a raging slut, aided and abetted by me?

Jack returned before I could say anything, and Scarlett leaned back to take her martini. “Thank you,” she said, her voice flirty and low. She sipped the martini, her eyes boring into me as she did. “Honey, didn’t you have something you wanted to talk to Dan about?”

I gave her a little jolt as I turned the dildo on, then off. “Oh yeah,” I said, not sure where exactly Scarlett was headed with the plan she obviously had. I suppose I had decided to let it play out, see what Scarlett was up to.

I stood up – not super-steadily – and weaved through several people to sit next to Dan. From the chair I chose, I had a good view of Scarlett and Jack, and I could ostensibly say I was talking to Dan, should anyone there care to keep up that ruse, which no one did seem to care.

Scarlett gave her hair a flip and leaned on her elbow to turn toward Jack with her martini. Jack stole a look in my direction, but I managed to have my eyes on my beer.

“So, *Jack*,” Scarlett said. “Where are you from?”

I sat there for how long? Twenty minutes? More? While my wife flipped her hair and moved her ankle in slow, leisurely circles. Her metallic dress seemed to creep up an inch every minute, until it was barely covering her and Jack could not help dropping his eyes almost every other word to take in the length of her legs to the cut-off. Surely he could smell her pussy, if she was as excited as she seemed to get.

I heard her laugh, she leaned her head back to do it. She drank her martini, I offered to get her another. At the bar I activated the bullet and watched her squirm as she reached out and patted Jack’s tie.

I struck up a conversation with the bartender. I realized I wanted to stay where I was: everyone was so drunk by now that no one noticed or cared that I had left the table. Scarlett was doing her best to pretend I wasn’t there, or she had forgotten that I actually was, and Jack seemed to have ingested enough to have forgotten that Scarlett was married, and her husband was right there.

Jack looked up at the bar after a few moments passed and Scarlett ran her shoe along his leg seductively. She was twirling her hair in one hand

and chewing invitingly on her lower lip. It was fresh out of a b-grade movie, but it was working on Jack as much as it was working on me.

Jack.

I turned back to the bar. Alessandro was one thing, but did I really want my wife to start fucking every guy she saw, every attractive man who came into her orbit?

I had forgotten the vibrator, so I turned it off. I looked back at the couches, and was surprised to see Scarlett standing up. She dropped her purse into the chair, said something to Jack, and sauntered toward the restrooms.

I turned back to the bar quickly, so Jack wouldn't see me watching. I wondered if they had worked out some plan.

My phone buzzed. I took it out.

[Scarlett]: *You want me to?*

I stared at the words.

Half of me *did* want her to.

I pondered what to type back to my wife, what to do about the monster I'd evidently created, but then I thought better of the whole thing.

Panic came over me again and I started to type quickly. Halfway through my message I saw her walking down the hall, Her eyes met mine and she shrugged, her hands open on either side of her body. Yes or no?

I looked down at my phone and finished typing my message:

[Me]: *I want you all to myself tonight*

Scarlett did not read the message as soon as I sent it. She strolled over to sit down next to Jack, on the love seat, her body turned toward him and her ankle rolling seductively. I stared openly at my wife, who seemed for a moment like a complete stranger, or someone else's wife, as she flirted openly with Jack.

It was surreal, watching her. The two of them seemed to have forgotten I was there, and so for a moment I had a window into another life, one in which Scarlett was not mine. One in which she would be floating freely like she was now, letting other men touch her and know her secrets.

And as I stumbled onto that thought, I remembered Alessandro, his smug-sounding voice as he talked to Scarlett about the silky hot insides of her ass. He had felt her there, had plunged his fingers inside of her, he planned to fuck her however he wanted.

My cock was so hard it was painful. I was glaring at Jack and Scarlett when she turned her phone over and looked at my message. Her eyes drifted up lazily and she met mine.

Then she leaned over to Jack, who was sitting sideways on the couch. He moved so that his ear was aligned with her mouth. Scarlett was still looking at me until the moment her head disappeared behind his. I saw a smile, tinged with disbelief, creep onto his face, and then he leaned back and ran his finger on his drink as Scarlett stood up, straightened her dress, and said something to him.

I spun around to face the bar.

She walked slowly toward me: I couldn't see it but I could feel her energy as she did.

She set her purse on the bar and slid into a stool next to me.

"What did you say to him?" I asked her, taking a sip of my drink.

"I asked him to slip me his room key before you came back," she said, matter-of-factly.

I looked at her sharply.

Scarlett smiled and dipped her finger into a martini I'd ordered and not taken over to her. She brought it to her mouth and sucked it off. "I'm not going to *go* there," she said. She laughed.

I had no idea what to do or say to this.

It ended up not mattering, because Scarlett slid her hand down my thigh and teased my hard cock with her bewitching fingertips. "Come on," she said. "Let's go try something new."

CHAPTER 6

I couldn't help myself activating the bullet in Scarlett's ass as we walked back to the room. We were like two adolescents, ducking into enclaves and nooks and making out in ways that would have gotten us arrested if anyone had seen us. Scarlett's thong barely covered her ass, so I was free to slide her skirt up, pushing aside the paper-thin material, and play with her soaked pussy or find the embedded tip of the vibrator and apply pressure to it in all sorts of directions, feel it humming inside of her.

We almost had sex about ten feet down the hallway from the door to our room.

I opened the door for her and she let the shoulders of her dress fall down as she walked inside. The silver fabric peeled away from her in tantalizing increments as she slinked into the room, revealing her toned back, the flawless shape of her ass, her slender legs. She stepped out of the dress and her thong, leaving her silver heels on.

I let the door close behind me and then watched Scarlett do her thing. She turned toward the bed and climbed onto it, stretching herself out with her heels kicked up behind her. She looked like a girl in a dirty magazine, she was so perfect at that moment.

She leaned on her forearms and looked at me expectantly. "Do you want to be my first?" she asked.

I was really beyond talking at this point. The woman on the bed was both my wife and a complete stranger to me, so I felt both the awkwardness of our deep familiarity and the awkwardness of fresh acquaintance at the same time. Sure, I felt the comfort of familiarity and the lusty appeal of unfamiliarity, but the whole thing put me terribly out of place.

Still, I managed to unzip my pants and take off my shirt, and, with much less grace or skill than Scarlett possessed, cross to the bed and stand behind her while taking off my clothes.

I stared at Scarlett's bottom, which she was moving in front of me in languid, feline stretches. In the center of her ass was her stuffed eyelet, the silver of the bullet gleaming in the center. I wanted to skip over all the foreplay and pull on the red ribbon, and get inside of her and feel what Alessandro had felt already with his fingers.

I climbed onto the bed behind her instead and guided my dick to her dripping pussy. I had never done this before with my wife, and I had only attempted it once before with another girl in my life. That had been an expedition I could not say for sure had gone well or not at all, because at the time I had been very, very drunk, and so had she, and I couldn't bet more than \$50 that I had been in her ass one way or the other. I know that sounds crazy, but this was college and we were *really* drunk.

I guided the crown of my cock to Scarlett's pussy and shuddered when the tip of it pressed against her sloppy-wet flesh. I could feel the hardened button of her clit darting like an animal in her soaked lips, and Scarlett mewled when I touched her in the right place.

She slid her knees further apart. "Get your cock wet before you try it," she said. My cock reacted by pulsing violently.

"Is that what Alessandro did?" I asked. "Did he get his fingers wet in your pussy before he put them in your ass?"

Scarlett pushed her bottom back toward me. She didn't say anything so I asked her again. "Is that what he did, you little slut?"

"Yes," Scarlett breathed.

I was overcome by a mixture of feelings, one of which included a little bit of anger. I rammed my cock into Scarlett's pussy, my hands on her ass, spreading it apart so I could see the ribbon from the bullet, and the metal crowning beneath her puckered asshole. She was so wet my cock rocketed to her cervix and then I started to bounce against her, losing myself so completely in the moment I almost made myself come.

I slowed down, and then I tugged on the bullet's ribbon, and I moved my thumb backward to slowly pull it from inside of her.

It slipped out of her ass with a rubbery pop, and I dropped it on the bed. Using my right hand, I drew some of her gushing pussy juices up to the engorged rim of her ass. And then I dipped my fingers in, to find that the description Alessandro had given, of heat and silkiness, was exactly right.

I used one finger, which didn't seem to bother her after the bullet, so I switched to a second finger and started to fuck her. "Is that okay?" I asked her.

Scarlett arched her back. "Oh," she said, and I could tell that she was feeling some pain. But she was also ripe for it, and pushed back against me, driving my fingers in further. "Oh, it hurts a little, don't stop, though."

I finger-fucked her for a bit, and she mewled and twisted against me. I slowly withdrew my fingers and pushed her down to her chest with her ass in the air.

I was so close to coming I wasn't sure if I could stop myself. The ripples of her body as I finger-fucked her ass were squeezing me in ways I had never experienced. I slowly pulled my cock from inside of her and Scarlett whimpered in disappointment.

To keep from coming so soon, I lowered my head and lapped at Scarlett's pussy, seeking out the knob of her clit and stroking it quickly with the blade of my tongue. Her pussy tasted extraordinarily sweet that night, and her juices coated my chin and my face.

Her legs began to tremble, and so I drew my tongue through the thick nectar of her cunt, flicking at her hole, and then up to her bare taint and, with only the slightest hesitation, to the rim of the slightly gaping hole of her ass.

Scarlett exhaled sharply and shivered when I started the journey around her ass with my tongue. A slight metallic taste lay under the flavor of her cunt – she had dripped into her ass while sitting there at the bar, or walking back to our room.

I made several circles around, enjoying the reaction of her body – her muscles tensed, she quivered in her abdomen, and the tight eyelet of her ass pulsed open and closed.

I was unable to take it anymore, and I didn't want to make Scarlett come until I was inside of her, because I wanted to feel that “new” part of her body squeeze my cock when she came.

I dipped my cock into her pussy once more, to coat it in her juices, and then I pushed it against the small hole.

I'm an average-sized guy, but even my dick covered the entire hole, and it seemed impossible that I could fit inside of her. But she pushed back against me a mewled again. “Oh, just do it,” she said. “I want you to break me in.”

That's all it took to convince me. I held onto her hip with one hand and fed my cock into her ass with the other. For a moment, as I leaned into her body, my cock bent slightly and her ass refused to give. Her hole sucked at the tip of my dick, and then I felt her body relax, and she seemed to cave in.

Suddenly, every inch of my cock was sinking in to her hot, silky flesh, which was every bit what Alessandro had described it as.

Scarlett yelled, and her feet twisted. She grabbed fistfuls of the sheets. “Oh!” she groaned, as two or three inches of my cock went inside of her.

“Oh, stop! I can’t!”

I stopped, and she panted and twisted her feet. “No, keep going,” she said. “Oh! Oh God!”

I leaned in and pushed myself all the way to the base of my cock, and then I let her squirm around me. “Are you okay?” I panted.

Scarlett threw her head back. “Oh,” she said, and then she twisted again. Her body squeezed my cock. I reached down to steady her.

“Touch yourself,” I said. “Make yourself come.”

I could hear Scarlett’s fingers more than I could feel them, as she brought one hand between her legs to slide along the sensitive face of her clit. Every jerk of her body, every twitch, pressed on my cock and drove me closer to the edge.

Scarlett made herself come, and when she did her ass clamped down on my cock and the full grip of her silky hotness made me shudder and grasp her hips. I rode out her orgasm, but not without bells ringing in my ears from the pressure.

At last, when she seemed to settle down, I took her ass in my hands, and, staring down at my own dick, I began to fuck her.

For a while it was all I could think about that I had my cock in my wife’s ass, and that I was about to fuck her full of cum, but it wasn’t long until Alessandro began to invade my thoughts. I started to imagine Alessandro’s thick cock stretching Scarlett out as she lay moaning on the bed, taking his abuse. Would she even be able to fit him in there?

I started to fuck her harder, and Scarlett wailed and whimpered, in that sexual and partially panicked way that porn stars do.

“Oh!” she screamed. “Oh! There, right there, fuck me and come in my ass!”

I did as Scarlett requested, and my seed filled her ass completely.

We collapsed on the bed and I pulled her to me. My cock slid from inside her and she shifted in mild discomfort, but snuggled up against me.

“I can’t believe you did that,” I said.

Scarlett smiled. I couldn’t see it but I felt the shape of her face change against my arm, which was wrapped protectively around her and leaning

slightly on her lower jaw.

“Me either,” she whispered.

I tried to keep my thoughts collected, to get to the things that were troubling me – because there were many – but I was tired, and like Scarlett, I drifted off to sleep. Like so many nights before, I was filled with a renewed sense of energy to get our “verbal contract” straightened out the very next day, at the very least before we returned. And I needed to think through my own thoughts and needs to do that.

I didn’t get as far as I’d hoped.

CHAPTER 7

The two next days were the Gentlemen's semi-finals. The stadium was disconcertingly half-empty, because of corporate ticket purchases. Dan, ever the status-man, spent a lot of time re-negotiating our own tickets and even managed to get us into a corporate suite for one match, which was fun for Scarlett, who had a lot of champagne, but was terrible for watching the tennis.

Ordinarily, I would have been so deeply involved in watching the matches, in the excitement of being there, and the whole event itself, that I would have never noticed the heat, or the fact that I was hungry or even what Scarlett was wearing.

But I found myself utterly incapable of paying attention to or thinking about tennis. Instead, the yellow ball criss-crossed in the silence punctuated by groans and the popping ping of the racket against the ball, and I stared into the terracotta color of the court, thinking about Scarlett. Scarlett, my wife, and Alessandro, her trainer, and the extremes their relationship took me to.

We were tired after the first day, but it didn't stop us from having wild sex, and Scarlett again insisted, by backing her round peach against me, on trying anal again. I'm not going to say I didn't enjoy it: there was a tighter, hotter, taboo feeling to having anal sex that sucked me toward a climax much faster, and when I came it was hard and encompassing.

I was uneasy about something, though. Maybe the determination with which Scarlett seemed to be doing it. The way she seemed to be tackling it like a problem she wanted to get out of the way, a thing she wanted to prepare for so she could execute it flawlessly. Except that it wasn't for executing flawlessly with *me*; she was perfecting things for Alessandro. This simultaneously turned me on and made me uneasy to the point of discomfort.

And yet I participated, willingly, and Scarlett took me inside of her with greater ease than the night before. I couldn't help but wonder – wonder, and imagine, and illustrate for myself – what it would be like when she returned home and gave Alessandro what he wanted: her *culo* full of his cum. The idea was so tantalizing that I spent most of my time anticipating

it. I tried to enjoy the Open, but the truth was, I could barely wait to return home and put my wife back in play with Alessandro.

It turned out, though, that the wait was not going to be as long as I thought.

*

Scarlett looked up from her phone as she walked behind me toward the street full of cafes and restaurants where we had begun to take our meals out of habit. Dan was out and about wheeling and dealing his tickets (which he did on his phone, and expressly claimed to be legal, but which he enjoyed doing while pacing up and down the street like a scalper). Marie was entering and exiting expensive stores and standing outside of them with her arms crossed, rolling her eyes and sighing. The day before, Dan had spent two hours moving their seats one row forward.

Scarlett and I had decided to skip the circus and just sit in the seats we already had. I figured it didn't matter much given that I wasn't paying attention to the tennis anyway.

Scarlett's face was pale, and for the first time in a long time she had an almost helpless expression on her face.

"What is it?" I said, when I saw her expression.

My first thought, honestly, was that someone had died. She looked that stunned.

Her wrist was limp and the screen was on text messaging, so I took the phone from her as she stared at me vacantly.

I turned the screen toward me and for a few moments I had a difficult time processing what was wrong with the message. I tried to scroll down, even, but there was nothing more. Just a picture of Alessandro, looking like his usual tan, fit, Italian-stud self. A selfie in a sun-drenched location.

I squinted. I looked back at Scarlett to see if she could offer me some more clues, but her face was blank.

I looked back at the phone.

And then, and only then, did it begin to settle in with me. The white walls, the muggy air, the elongated license plate of a car caught in the corner of the frame.

And finally, my eyes rested on the caption, which I hadn't noticed at all.

Surprise.

“He’s here,” Scarlett whispered, when I looked up at her, in case I hadn’t figured it all out for myself.

I squinted at the phone again.

Then back to Scarlett.

“You didn’t know he was coming?” I said doubtfully. My pulse was accelerating, I could almost hear my heart.

Scarlett had sucked her whole lower lip into her mouth and was shaking her head slowly.

I looked around me, into the street and the parked cars, as though Alessandro might suddenly pop out from behind one of them. I had a sneaking sensation of betrayal, as though maybe the story here was that Scarlett had planned this all along.

I looked back at her. Anger was curling up at the corners of my mind. “You didn’t know he was coming,” I said, and even more doubt tinged my voice than before.

Scarlett snatched the phone from my hand, snapping out of her stunned expression at the same time. “No I didn’t know he was coming,” she hissed. “What the hell, Will?”

She sighed and looked out the window, running her fingers through her hair to push her sweaty bangs from her face. Her cheeks were red from the heat, which had begun early in the day, but she looked even hotter now. She, too, seemed to be looking for Alessandro to be popping out of the trees.

She looked back at me. “What do I do?” she asked.

She seemed, to my delight, to be actually freaking out. Not like she was excited to see him, but like she was cornered, her lover surprising her while she was out with her husband.

I folded my arms. “How much does he know about -”

“Oh, hey guys!” Marie’s voice interrupted from behind me.

I turned around. “Marie,” I said, masking my distress with enthusiasm. Marie raised her eyebrows.

“What... are you up to?” she asked, after a weird pause.

Scarlett put her phone into her purse. “Fighting about a breakfast spot,” Scarlett said, her tone flawlessly even. “Will wants American food

and I want authentic French. He can't be persuaded."

Marie looked at me.

Alessandro's selfie flooded my mind, crowding out Marie's expectant look. "I love ketchup," I said lamely.

"You see?" Scarlett said. She was being funny now, getting in the spirit of things. "This is what I deal with."

Marie knew something else was up between us, because her eyes shifted suspiciously from one face to another, her mouth at a slant. "Well," she said. She let this sit for a few seconds, then added: "I'm going to the spa." She turned to me. "You should try new things while you're here. How often will you be in France?"

We all stood there, contemplating this statement, each in our own way. Marie seemed to want an answer to her wisdom. Scarlett put her hand on my arm. "Maybe never," she said sincerely.

"There's an excellent place," Marie said, taking her phone out and swiping at the screen. "There...it's... okay, I can't say it, but it's the one I was telling you about.... it's...there. I sent it to you."

"Thanks," Scarlett said.

"Go there," Marie said.

"I... we'll try it. Right?" Scarlett looked at me.

I wondered what exactly I was agreeing to, of course. It's just that I had that thought *as* I was agreeing. "Right," I said.

Marie was walking away. "When in France..." she said as she retreated.

Scarlett and I looked at each other. It was like we were in some movie, the innuendo was so thick.

Then she broke character and gripped my arm. "Okay, but seriously. What do I do?"

I looked at Scarlett's face. For not the first time, I was seeing that Scarlett seemed overwhelmed by Alessandro. I had seen it on the video chat, I saw it now. She had admitted to it, in so many words.

"Look," I said. "If you don't want to see him, then just don't tell him where you are."

Scarlett looked at the screen of her phone again. She bit into her lower lip. She made a sound sucking the air into her mouth.

"I don't know what to do," she complained.

Though I would never, ever, in my darkest hour tell Scarlett this, I was enjoying myself immensely. There was a quality to her discomfort that I found deeply arousing.

It was likelier than not that Scarlett was uncomfortable because she had to manage her lover and her husband, because Alessandro was so alluring to her sexually and she didn't know how to manage it. I was getting turned on by the idea that she was uncomfortable because now her thick-cocked lover was here, and he was going to push her into even more degrading acts than usual, and as much as I hated to admit it, I loved the idea of it. The idea that I might actually get to see it, finally.

I pulled her to me and gave her a squeeze. "Look," I said. "Let's go eat, at wherever it is that Marie told you, and we'll figure out what to do there."

Scarlett dropped her phone into her purse. Her mind was miles away when she agreed to the plan, and she was miles away as we strolled to lunch.

But let's be honest: so was I.

*

Alessandro texted again during our meal, which was at a cute little cafe with godawful service and food that I cannot even remember eating. Scarlett's buzzing phone drove us both crazy as we tried to ignore it and sip wine, pretending we were merely on vacation like any ordinary couple. Scarlett drank her first glass of wine especially fast, arousing an accusatory look from the very French waiter, who pursed his lips as he asked her if she would like another.

Scarlett was thinking so deeply that the waiter's attitude scarcely moved her. I ordered a bottle, and the waiter – I believe – actually rolled his eyes.

Scarlett fished her phone from her purse and scrolled through the messages nervously.

Her hand was shaking slightly.

I reached across the table and grabbed her free hand. "Scar," I said. "Calm down. What has you so nervous?"

It was only at this point that I started to have a sinking sensation. I entertained the idea, for the first time, that maybe Scarlett was nervous

because she had conflicting feelings, or because she was excited that Alessandro had surprised her here. Maybe she preferred Alessandro, and maybe she had wanted to tell me. My thoughts got very negative very quickly.

Scarlett tapped away at the phone. “What do I do?” she asked, vacantly staring at the screen, oblivious to my darkening thoughts. “Should I text him? He says, ‘I’m staying at the Mercure. Why don’t you go shopping today around 4pm?’”

Scarlett looked up at me from the screen.

“Do you want to go shopping?” I asked her cheerfully, playing the clueless husband.

The phone buzzed in her hand. She dropped her eyes and looked at the message.

She said nothing.

I reached over and took the phone from her. “Wow,” I said. It was another selfie – this time from the waist-up in the hotel bathroom mirror, Alessandro’s muscled torso in full glory. He had not bothered with most of his face, though his stubble-covered jaw, square and manly, made it into the frame. “He looks like an ad for Gillette or something,” I commented.

Scarlett took the phone from me and looked at it again, shaking her head.

“Do you really go for this kind of-”

Scarlett put her hands to her head and smoothed her hair back in frustration. “This is what I’m *talking* about,” she said, aggrieved. “He’s such a.. such a.... meat-head. And then I’m like, running to meet him and stuff. What am I *doing*?”

For some reason, this particular monologue by Scarlett bothered me more than a lot of things she’d said or done.

“Are you falling for him?” I found myself asking. There was an icy tone to my voice that surprised even me. I was replaying Scarlett brushing her hair back and shaking her head to ask herself “what am I doing?” over and over again in my mind.

Scarlett looked up at me. “*What?*”

I shrugged. “Well, it just seems like you’re putting a lot of thought into this.”

Scarlett’s mouth fell open. “What’s that supposed to mean?”

I didn’t know.

“I don’t know,” I said.

Scarlett shook her head and spun the phone around.

We were silent while the waiter brought us our wine and we dismissed him to look at the menu for a little longer, as neither of us had even thought about what we were going to order.

Scarlett’s mood grew sour. “I can’t read any of this,” she said, and flicked the menu with her fingernail.

It was a leather-bound menu and so her nail made a low thud against it, and I saw her eye twitch because it hurt a little.

I set my menu down.

More silence.

“Well,” I said.

Scarlett squinted at me.

“Well,” she repeated in the same tone as me. “What should I *do*?”

I, for one, could sense that however torn I was inside by feelings of jealousy and excitement, the feeling that was winning over was excitement. I *wanted* Scarlett to “go shopping” at 4pm. I wanted to wait for her in exquisite pain, sitting in my room alone, wondering if Alessandro was trying to cram his huge cock into her ass first thing after arriving in France, or if he would attempt to be more romantic. I wanted her to go to him, and then I wanted her to come back to me.

What I *didn’t* know is what Scarlett wanted. I wanted her to want to fuck Alessandro *exactly* as much as I wanted her to want him, no more and no less. But what were the chances of her feelings being precisely the ones I wanted her to have?

I reached across the table, and took her hand. “Scarlett,” I said, “do what you feel like doing. But I just want you to know that... I mean, I think it’s really exciting. I don’t want our great trip to go all... off... just because you think I think something I don’t.”

Scarlett’s lip trembled. “So you think I should go?” she asked.

My stomach plummeted, the way it does when I look down from a very tall height. “If you want to, I’m up for it. After all... we did do all that practicing.”

My cock was thickening. The waiter came back, his eyebrows raised. I waved him off with a gesture that was meant to indicate we needed more time, but he seemed annoyed by it so perhaps it meant something different in France.

Scarlett looked down at her menu. She was looking at it for a while, and during that time I was thinking about what a brave, magnanimous husband I was, about how hard it was to let her go to a guy like Alessandro without knowing what she felt in her heart.

When she looked up, she was cheerful and she shrugged. She turned the menu over and looked for the waiter. "Okay," she said. "I guess... I'll go."

"I'll help you get dressed for it," I said.

She looked down at her phone and played with the screen to bring up his picture. "Should I send something back?" she asked.

But as she was speaking, her phone buzzed and she looked at the screen. Her eyes grew wide. The waiter came toward the table and she clutched the phone to her chest while we ordered. When he left she slid it over to me.

[AS]: *Bring your present. I want it ready to go.*

I stared at the message, and thousands of ideas flooded my head. My cock was pulsing. I slid the phone back toward her. She was drinking her wine in elegant gulps. I was getting the idea to have sex with Scarlett right before she went to see Alessandro, with the plug in, and then ask her to tell him about it. I almost opened my mouth to suggest it.

Scarlett picked up the phone.

The waiter returned, his face bored. He looked ready to retreat and disdainful when Scarlett looked up at him. "I'm just having another wine," she told him.

He looked at me, his expression unchanged. "Monsieur?"

"Uh... same," I said.

Scarlett smiled at me over her wine glass and inclined it to clink it against mine after the waiter left. Her smile was strange, though I couldn't say why, and I chalked it up to the peculiarity of what we were doing, to being in France and her lover turning up unexpectedly, to many things... none of them being the right one, as I would find out later.

We ditched the match. It was an action I would not have seen myself doing *for anything*, especially since we had the tickets, and we were in France, and I loved tennis.

But such is life. Or so they say over there.

CHAPTER 8

There is nothing comparable in this world to the sensation you can have while you help your wife get dressed before she goes to fuck another guy. Some men may do this without knowing it, but knowing what you're doing adds a piquancy to the act that is really impossible to explain.

I helped Scarlett insert Alessandro's "present," which inevitably led to us having sex again. I touched the darkened pink of Scarlett's ass after I pushed it inside of her. "Are you sore?" I asked her.

"A little," she had said, and turned around to face me. That was it: we made love, and I could feel the hard bulb of the bullet vibe inside of her, pressing through the membrane of her body, as I fucked her gently.

Scarlett took a shower. I was sitting on the bed when she came out. She opened her suitcase, then the drawers into which she'd packed her clothing. "What should I wear?" she mused out loud.

She pulled out a few items, then went back to the suitcase, fishing through a few things before pulling out a bundle of white cloth and shaking it out.

It looked like a cheap towel at first. She set it on the table and dug into a drawer for more items. "Okay," she said. "What do you think of this?"

She held up the item, which I now recognized as a pair of shorts and a shirt.

"Uh..." I said. It didn't look extremely sexy in her hands like that. The fabric looked inexpensive and the whole thing was kind of ratty.

She looked deflated. "Maybe you need to see it on," she said.

Suddenly flustered, which was an unusual emotion for Scarlett, she sighed and went in to the bathroom with the things she had taken out.

I remained where I was, looking for the right words to say. I decided to shut up and see what it looked like on, and my eyes fell longingly on the metallic dress she had left draped over a chair after last night's romp.

With my expectations low, I waited.

I was not disappointed when she opened the door. She was adjusting the outfit, not looking at me, and saying: "...I just want it to look like... oh,

I was wearing this by the pool or something. You know? So he doesn't get a big head." She looked up at me. "What do you think?"

The white cloth, which I now recognized as terrycloth, which is why it looked like a towel at first, clung to my wife as a form-fitting pair of short-shorts, underneath which I could see the skimpy white thong, held up over her hips by no more than frail string. The thong barely grew thick enough to cover her gash, and the terrycloth was just see-through enough to show the contrast between the thong and her tanned skin. Enough to see that she had a shaved snatch, but not so transparent that it was obscene.

The top was also terry-cloth, and it was looser, but in a sexy way, in which the material caught on her full breasts and then slid away, only to catch again in a sexy, slouching, carefree way.

"My only criticism," I said hoarsely, "is that I think you should get rid of the bra."

She looked down. "It's so see-through though," she said.

"We're in France. Girls aren't even wearing tops at the beach."

But Scarlett was already reaching behind her with one hand to unhook her bra.

She pulled it out in the expertly amazing way that women handle bras, and her erect nipples pressed out against the cloth. As she moved, the shirt occasionally cupped her breast and gave me a full view of her body as though she were naked. Then the view was snatched away.

"What do you think?" she asked. She slid open the closet next to her and stepped into a cream-colored sandal with a large hemp wedge heel. Her thigh muscle creased along the center and her legs seemed to stretch out forever, dangling like a colt's from the clingy terry-cloth.

"I return your honor," I said, and my throat was dry. "Turn around?"

She gave a turn, and my cock throbbed at the sight of her firm ass, the two spheres perfectly cradled in the cloth, the narrow strip of thong hardly visible tucked between her buttocks. "It's... fucking hot," I said. "But... would you go shopping in that?"

Scarlett looked at herself in the mirror, over her shoulder, to take in her ass. "Probably not. But he gave it to me, so I thought I'd wear it."

The burn of jealousy started in my chest. Of course he had given it to her, of course he planned for her to wear it to go see him at some point. Maybe even when he bought it; he must have been planning this trip for a long time. Maybe since the beginning. And now he was waiting in his hotel

room for my wife to walk around in town with her nipples visible to everyone on the street, with her legs dangling out, with her high heels, with every man in town watching her plugged-up ass as she sauntered to go see him.

Scarlett had turned again, and was looking at me over her shoulder now. “What do you think?” she said. “I want it to look like, I don’t know... I got up from a nap and just threw this on or something.”

Her lips were pink, her skin tanned, her hair a wind-tangled, breezy mess as though she were about to model sunscreen or lip gloss or a hair product of some kind.

“It’s perfect,” I said.

She quickly hopped over to me and took her purse from the night table as she gave me a kiss on the mouth. “You’re sure about this?” she asked.

Was she asking about the clothes, or the whole crazy thing? I’ll never know.

“One hundred percent,” I said.

She hesitated, and then she turned, and then she looked back. But the look was short-lived, and then she blew me a kiss, and my wife walked out the door to go meet Alessandro.

*

Though it might seem impossible that it’s true, and also impossible that I only just thought of it at that moment, Alessandro had never actually seen me as far as I knew. It was certainly possible that he’d *seen* me, but he didn’t know who I was.

And sitting there in the hotel room, with nothing to do but wait for my wife to come back, I realized that Alessandro’s ignorance of who I was afforded me a great advantage.

Even so, I texted Scarlett anyway, just to be sure.

[Me]: *Alexander doesn't know what I look like does he?*

I glared at auto-correct of “Alessandro.” I really hate auto-correct. It’s the pits with legal terms, just in case you’re wondering.

I waited, fantasizing about all of the things I could do if I was right. I could follow them if they left the hotel, I could sit in the lobby (if there was a lobby, the Mercure was a French hotel and so lacked in all likelihood the amenities that our own had).

The notification for my text messages blared loudly. I had somehow turned it on high. I jumped slightly and held up the screen.

[Scarlett]: *How did you find out about Alex?*

My phone screeched again.

[Scarlett]: *Joke, of course. I don't think so*

[Scarlett]: *Why?*

Note here that we would later get our phone bill and regret this particular type of communication a little.

I wrote back:

No reason.

*

I could describe the boring, boring hours that I spent in the lobby of the Mercure, and then in the cafe across the street, which became a boozy tourist trap by night, but the details are all much the same. I sat stewing in my own paranoia.

At first, I was happy that they didn't emerge. After all, I didn't want my wife to go out on a date, or have some cutesie relationship with the hot Italian tennis instructor. It was better this way: they were having a strictly physical affair, fucking wildly upstairs in his room, which is what I'd wanted all along.

But the minutes and then the hours ticked by. My phone filled up with text messages and email alerts, none of which were from Scarlett, and all of which were from work or work-related things. I ignored them and drank some kind of sweet beer that had been the recommendation of the waiter and which I detested, but it was easier to keep them coming than change my order.

I spent the time imagining details, and stewing about the lamentable fact that I would never know all of the details. I would never know, for example, what Alessandro looked like when he opened the door and took in my wife's terry-cloth shorts and shirt combo. I would never know what "meat-head" thing he said, if he said anything at all, before he pushed her into the room and started in on her. Sure, she would tell me the details to the best of her ability, but in the end I would never know all of them, or know them exactly as they were.

I wondered how he would take her, when he did, when he fucked her in the ass. Or perhaps he would play with the bullet, like I had. I wondered if Alessandro asked my wife to give him the details of her sex life with me, while she was on her knees and sucking his cock. I wonder if he made her tell him what a small cock I had, and how she had been waiting to get his big one inside of her again. I wondered if he made her gag on his dick, if he tapped her on the forehead just before he came. Probably not. He probably pushed her head in further, pressing it to his groin, spraying his cum right into her throat, so far down she didn't have to swallow.

The waiter started avoiding me, which I probably would have done, too. I looked a sight, I'm sure. Staring at the door to the hotel, my eyes burning, an erection draining the blood from my face.

I had resolved not to message her for a while, but when eight o'clock rolled around, my curiosity and my anxiety got the better of me. It was a fine line between wanting to see my wife get manhandled and fucked like a rag doll, which I enjoyed thinking about very much, and worrying that the huge brutish Italian was actually harming her.

I wrote several drafts of text messages, some of them meant to be comical, some serious, some angry, and finally I settled on this Shakespearean masterpiece:

You okay?

But there was no response.

So I waited, and then I flagged down the waiter, ordered a shot, got the wrong alcohol but didn't care, slammed it, and walked determinedly across the street.

After paying my bill, of course.

But as I was crossing the street, the door of the hotel opened, and an attractive woman in jeans and a white tank top stepped out.

It took me a few moments to realize that the woman was my wife. She had shopping bags in her hands, and her hair was loose and looked red in the fading sunlight. Alessandro leaned on the door frame, down to where she was a step below him, and kissed her. My heart went cold, then burst into flames. They looked like a happy couple, a well-matched couple. A couple who were comfortable with each other.

Not what I had imagined. Not what I had expected. The scene was too sweet for me.

I was now on the other side of the street, and there was nowhere to go, no shop to step into (they were closed, locked with gates and padlocks), so I made a sharp turn to the left and walked straight toward them. Scarlett opened her eyes and saw me, but she was still kissing Alessandro. As I walked past them, I brushed her shoulder, said “excuse moi” in my best imitation of French.

But there was nothing to indicate that they had heard me, or even cared. As I walked away, I didn’t turn around, but I could sense the scene behind me. They came together again and kissed, and I walked off alone, a man who had let out the lead on his wife and now was not sure I could bring her back in.

I walked back to the hotel. After several blocks, I turned back to see if Scarlett was following me. I didn’t see her, and she wasn’t the kind to get lost in the crowd. Even in Paris, with its abundance of beautiful and stylish women, she stood out. In part because she was so sunny, so blonde, so sporty. But also because she was beautiful, and French women had nothing on her.

I pulled my phone out and texted her as I walked, which is a maneuver I don’t recommend so much in Europe. I almost fell on my face when I twisted my ankle on a cobblestone in the street.

I got no answer to my text, and I turned around, maniacally searching for her in the sparsely occupied streets behind me, all the way to the hotel.

She was standing on the steps in her jeans, twirling a shopping bag.

I skipped up the steps to her.

My eyes came to rest on the shopping bag. ‘What’s that?’ I asked.

I was all over the place emotionally, so I had no idea why that’s the question I decided to ask. My jealousy was churning coldly in my belly and

there were so many other things I was interested in besides the answer to that question. I did not actually give a damn what the shopping bag was, or what it was about, or why she wearing jeans I had never seen before. I only cared about one thing, and that was the details of what had transpired for so many hours in that room with Alessandro.

She held the bag up. “He really thinks of everything,” she said. “He bought me some stuff so it would look like I actually went shopping.”

“The jeans?” I said.

She twirled the bag. “And other stuff,” she said coyly. Then she leaned toward me. “He ripped my shorts so it’s a very good thing.”

My cock was instantaneously hard. I pushed her by the small of her back toward the lobby, through it and to the elevator. The doors closed and we said nothing as we ascended. There was nothing to say, at least not from my perspective, because the energy between us spoke for itself. I had not felt such a desire to fuck her – but really, really fuck her – in a long time, even since this game began. It was all I could do to keep it together down the hallway, waiting until she opened the door.

Then I pounced on her.

I kicked the door shut as I pushed her into the room, my hands on the collar of her terry-cloth tank top, which I ripped apart, freeing her breasts. I turned on the lights as we passed it, and the bright white LED revealed that her nipples were red, sore, and bitten into. A small, hickey-like sore surrounded her right nipple.

I reached for them and played with them. “They’re sore,” she whispered, flinching a little.

I squeezed them, but gently, and she gasped.

Then I slid my hand into her jeans without unbuttoning them. My fingers found her pussy, unobstructed by any panties, and I dipped into her wet, full pussy and clawed at her to push her toward the bed.

She fell backward and I stood over her. “Take off your pants,” I ordered. She unbuttoned them, and I lost patience and pulled them off.

My wife’s body was fully revealed then, stretched out before me with her arms above her head. Her nipples were encircled by reddened flesh where Alessandro had evidently had his way with her. More patches of reddened flesh dotted the length of her torso, and her bare pussy was bright pink around her lips. Her gash was overflowing, like it had burst open. The tender red inner flesh of her cunt was swollen and soaked.

I moved onto the bed and took her by the hip to roll her over. She left her arms above her head to do so.

I ran my hand along her body from her neck to her bottom, where I could see the bright imprint of Alessandro's hand on her right cheek. The skin had even welted a little. All of her ass was varying shades of bright red, because Alessandro had given her quite the spanking.

I ran my fingers over her skin and enjoyed the way she shuddered as I did so. "What happened to your bottom?" I asked her. I rubbed her cheeks a little harder.

As she told me, I pushed her legs apart so I could see between them. I was curious about whether he had put the bullet back inside of her, and found instead that her tiny pink hole had been violated: there was no vibrator, but there was a huge gape, out of which his cum was spilling slowly onto her thighs.

I inserted a finger and traced it around the tight, stretched rim of her ass. "Did he fuck your ass?" I asked.

Scarlett was squirming as I touched her. "Be gentle," she said. "It's so sore."

My cock throbbed and I grasped it with my free hand to keep it from flopping painfully around. I gently swiped her anus again, a slow deliberate circle. I pictured her on all fours, mewling as he pounded his cock into her and slapped her ass like she was a horse he was riding.

Her legs shook as I made another pass around her ass.

"Did you like it?" I asked.

Scarlett pushed her ass back toward me, and some creamy white cum welled up and drained down her leg. I could smell his scent inside of her, and I stared at her cunt, which also seemed to be gushing his seed. I plunged my thumb into her dirty hole and felt the sliminess of Alessandro's seed.

"Did he fuck your pussy too, Scarlett?"

She leaned down to the bed, her chest against the sheets. She turned her face to the left and her eyes flitted as she tried to look back at me without moving her head. "He fucked me in *every* hole," she moaned. She brought her fingers to her mouth and sucked on them to emphasize the point.

Well, it would certainly look that way. I wanted every detail I could get my hands on, but I was having a hard time keeping myself together. If I

didn't get my cock inside of her, I was going to explode all over her back.

Just then, Scarlett brought her hand back to her ass, and dipped two fingers into her hole. I stared as she finger-fucked herself, her manicured nails disappearing into the red eyelet and back out again, making a sticky, gushing sound as they did.

I watched for a moment, the scene surreal. This was *not my wife*. My wife did not finger-fuck her own ass like a dirty whore. She did not come home full of cum in every hole.

I pulled her hips toward me and I held her hand to her ass cheek. Her fingers were still pumping at her asshole. "You like being fucked in the ass?" I asked her.

Scarlett smiled, moving her fingers in and out. "I like it," she said.

"You want me to fuck you in the ass?" I asked, but I was already pushing her fingers away and lining my cock up to her swollen hole.

"Be gentle," she said. "His cock was so big and I'm so sore."

I grabbed her hips and sank into her flesh slowly. Her ass was definitely stretched, there was no hesitation on her part to relax and accommodate me. The hot insides of her ass were slick with Alessandro's cum, so I slid right in. The silky canal grabbed my cock, much looser than the first time, but much hotter as well.

Scarlett mewled and clutched at the sheets. She was sweating, even in the air conditioning. "Ooohhh," she moaned. "That's it. I like it so much in my ass."

For a moment I was overcome by vertigo: who was this woman? *My wife*? Was it my wife bouncing her plum ass back at me, ramming my cock deeper and deeper into her already sore ass? Was it my wife saying she liked it so much in her ass? SO much she had taken Alessandro's giant cock there less than an hour before?

"Does Alessandro's cock stretch you out?" I asked. "Your ass is all stretched out like a whore's."

Scarlett let me pound into her for a few thrusts while she closed her eyes and tossed her head. "Oh!" she gasped. "It's... oh, yeah, fuck me hard like that, I just... I just..."

I could feel her fingers as she plunged them into her pussy.

"Tell me about his cock," I said, grinding up deep inside of her.

She kept playing with herself and her ass squeezed around my cock, so I grasped her hand and held it still while she howled in disappointment.

“Tell me,” I said.

“Oh, oh... his cock is... it’s so, it’s thick. I almost couldn’t do it. I almost...” she was panting now, having trouble controlling herself. “Oh, it almost didn’t... fit...”

“Why did he spank you?”

Scarlett tossed her head. “Please Will,” she begged. “Let me come. Please fuck your come into my ass and I promise I’ll... I’ll tell... I’ll tell you.”

She dropped to the bed so she could get her fingers up to her clit, and I heard the sloshing of her own handiwork in the soaked lips of her pussy as I fucked her cum inside of her, just like she had asked.

Scarlett came just before I did, and her body seized violently, her ass clamping down on my cock and squeezing the cum from inside of me. I could feel every pulse of her body; the violent, powerful shaking inside of her that was so much stronger than any orgasm she’d had before we had begun this adventure.

I pushed gently on her lower back and slid my cock from inside of her. I wanted to stare at her cherry-red hole, fucked to that bright color by two men, broken open to a gaping chasm and gushing white cum with every orgasmic pulse of her body. I stared at the spilling contents that dripped down her thighs, indulging in the filthy slut my wife had become.

We spooned, and she shifted against me. It was only then that I began to move my hands over her body, exploring the places where Alessandro had used her so violently, feeling for the evidence of his cock, of his treatment of her.

I wanted her to tell me every detail, to somehow create a film for me of what had happened for such a long time in that hotel, but she was drifting off. Besides, I could find the story myself with my fingertips and my eyes: he had bitten into her nipples enough to turn them plump and red. He had shoved his cock into her pussy and stretched it out; he had filled her ass with cum. As I explored her body while she dozed, I found a dried, brackish cum stain on her neck, and then a patch of the same in her hair. My cock got hard as I pictured the way in which that cum had come to be where it was: had she been on her knees, sucking his cock until he gave her a facial? Splashing his seed all over her face, into her hair, across her neck? Or had this happened when he fucked her pussy, and he had pulled out to come all over her back?

My cock was throbbing against Scarlett's back and her ass. She stirred and made a soft moaning sound, rolling backward to slide her arm over my head and kiss me. "Mmm," she said. "I'm too sore now, I can't." She turned back on her side, and I thought she would go to sleep. "I'm going to take a shower."

CHAPTER 9

Scarlett's phone buzzed a few times with text messages, and she slept through them. I held out on not invading her privacy, for the record, but only for the seductive buzzing of three text messages.

I slipped the phone off the nightstand and saw that they were coming from Alessandro.

Her phone, despite my warnings about privacy, displays partial messages as they come in. I read the beginning of the most recent text:

[AS]: *watch you squirm while he's there right next to you will be...*

Then, naturally, I tried to unlock her phone to read the messages, certain she would understand and forgive me for it. After all, wasn't everything to do with Alessandro supposed to be an open book, and hadn't she promised to share everything with me?

I knew Scarlett's pattern for opening her phone; we had deliberately put the same code on in the event we needed one or the other to send a message for the other or read something off in the car.

When the phone snappily informed me I had the wrong code, I chalked it up to fat fingers and excitement. I then proceeded to do it again, and again, and again, denied every time, unable to believe the simplest explanation: that my wife had changed the code.

And then I started to get jealous. I started to think the worst as the phone started to warn me it would lock me out after the next four attempts. I tried again anyway, and then wrested the screen from my own hand and set it down loudly on the night table.

I had hoped to wake Scarlett up.

She didn't even stir.

I stared at Scarlett as she slept. My thoughts went dark about as fast as you can imagine: here she was, sleeping soundly like nothing had happened the day before. She had fucked another guy like a fucking whore, and even though she had done it with my permission, you'd really think she'd feel guilty enough about it that she couldn't sleep.

But no.

And why had she changed her phone code?

In that moment the only possible explanation was that she wanted me out of it, to keep her messages with Alessandro private.

“Scarlett,” I said, fuming. “Scarlett, wake up.”

Scarlett groaned and turned her head, rolling onto her stomach and putting her head under a pillow. She smelled like her own shampoo now, like gardenias and lemon or something like that, but the memory of the dried cum in her hair and streaked along the back of her neck was burned into my mind.

“Scarlett,” I whispered.

“It’s so early,” she groaned from under the pillow. “Man. Why are you waking me up? We’re on vacation.”

She was whining slightly. If the circumstances were different I would have found it adorable. I would have kissed her and coaxed her out from under the pillow.

That day, I was in a different mindset. I had the impulse to climb on top of her and shove my cock into her ass, where she seemed to like it so much, without so much as another word.

Just an impulse, it faded quickly, but the heat traveling across my skin did not. “Scarlett. It’s ten. Alessandro is sending you messages. Why did you change your phone?”

I machine-gunned these sentences at her, and she sat up from beneath the pillow, which rolled off the top of her head and into the small of her back in a fat, clumsy way. Her hair was ruffled, her face fresh, her mouth inviting. “What?” she asked sleepily.

Her eyes moved to the phone. She squinted at it and rubbed one eye with her right hand. “What are you talking about?”

“It’s ten,” I repeated idiotically. “So we have to get going.”

Scarlett reached out and took the phone from me. She rolled onto her back, tossing the pillow aside.

She unlocked the phone. I watched the pattern, made a note of it, and then hoped she would forget what I had said about her phone.

The messages from Alessandro popped up on the screen.

I read them quickly, and then watched Scarlett’s face as she re-read them.

Her face was blank: her mouth fell open a little, but she otherwise gave no indication as to what she thought of Alessandro's suggestions.

Then she looked at me.

"Well?" she asked.

Alessandro had suggested, in very silly English which I will not repeat here, that Scarlett wear her bullet to the match today, and he would find her, right after he watched her squirm next to me as he played with her ass right under my nose.

I waited, saying nothing.

It was a mistake because Scarlett then waved the phone. "Were you trying to unlock this phone?" she asked.

I shrugged, trying to play it cool. "I just wanted to see what he had to say," I said. I was now feeling a little sheepish about the phone, and my paranoia. Obviously, Scarlett wasn't *hiding* anything; she had opened the messages right there in front of me and let me read them.

She gave me a slightly incredulous shake of the head, but then her eyes went back to the screen.

And then I saw it, though I didn't give it much thought at the time: a little faltering glitch on her face.

Before I had any time to process what I had seen in her expression, though, I was already trying to cover up my bad deed of attempting to look at her messages, so I was saying:

"Sounds really hot."

The thing is, it *did* sound really hot. But that wasn't what I wanted to say at that moment, or what I would have said if I had had more time to think. Not just about what was going on, but about Scarlett's expression and what it meant.

Scarlett turned her head on the pillow. "Should I do it?" she asked.

We looked at each other for a bit. I'll never know what Scarlett was thinking at that moment, but I do know that much of me wanted to say "No."

"Is he going to the match, then?" I asked. My heart was beating quickly, my palms were getting sweaty. Now, I was starting to think about the possibilities: Scarlett sitting next to me, next to Dan, sweating and turning red as the bullet inside of her vibrated and Alessandro watched it all.

Scarlett stroked the screen of her phone. "I don't... I guess so." Her eyes were sort of vacant, which I took for her obsession with Alessandro. The thought of it burned slowly as though I had taken a swig of moonshine.

She looked back at me. I leaned over her and pushed a strand of hair from her face.

"It's very hot," I repeated.

Scarlett searched my eyes.

Another faltering look flitted across her face.

She lifted head to kiss me on the lips, and then she squirmed away.

"Well... if it's ten, we better get going."

"Hold on just a minute," I said, trying to pull her toward me. I was turned on, and now I wanted to indulge in more of my wife.

Scarlett looked at me helplessly. Then she looked at her phone uncertainly. "I don't... uh... I think I'd better take a pass on this." She sat up and kissed me, the kind of dismissive kiss I was used to getting a long time ago. The kind of kiss she gave me when she was too busy, too tired, too...something... for my advances.

"I'm a little sore," she said. "Besides... Alessandro thinks you don't know about us."

I let this comment go, saying nothing as Scarlett stood up and trotted into the bathroom. I folded my hands behind my head, though, and considered every painful detail of the conversation, however. What did she mean by *that*? That she didn't want to have sex with me because she wanted to be pristine for her lover? I was the one who got the sloppy seconds?

I fumed, and Scarlett took her shower. When she reappeared she took the shopping bag she had brought back from the night before and set it on the bed.

She pulled out an item from inside the bag and shook it out. It was an expensive-looking dress, crocheted, full of holes, very short, very sexy. She held it against her body and looked down at it. "Sort of short," she mused.

I was burning up. Had this fucker bought my wife a dress? Imagining this whole day, and the things he was going to do to her in it? Had he picked out the right size and placed it in the bag thinking about what she would look like in it?

"Try it on," I found myself saying.

Scarlett looked up at me. "It looks a little risqué for the match," she said.

"Why?"

I found myself pressuring her as I talked. What the hell was I doing? Did I *want* her to wear the dress Alessandro bought her? Did I want her to get dressed up in the clothes he wanted to see her in, and put his crazy vibrator in her ass, and have her sit next to me at the stadium while he played with his toy and watched her squirm? Is that what I really wanted?

Scarlett looked down at the dress, which barely made it to mid-thigh. I hadn't seen her in anything that short in... well, maybe all our marriage.

She sighed. "Well..." she said. "Okay. I'll try it."

She let her towel drop to the floor and took the dress to her suitcase, where she fished out a nail clipper to take off the tags. She started to fish out some underwear, and I thought of opening my mouth to tell her not to wear them, but I decided to let it be her choice.

She slipped on a pair of blue panties, which I found a little shocking: it was like they had been bought for the dress. She pulled the lacy undergarment up to her waist, and the thong nestled into her bottom snugly.

She was facing away from me as she sorted out the complicated dress, and slipped it over her head. The crocheted parts were backed by a skin-colored fabric in her most private places, but as the dress settled onto her figure, the effect was to make it look like she was wearing a dress full of holes. The shape of her bottom curved the backside into two bubbly spheres, and when she turned around the dress teased at giving me a glimpse of her nipples through the holes. Only on closer inspection was it clear that some small, beige strip of fabric prevented them from being seen: but only just.

"That's a hot dress," I said, my eyes taking in the short skirt, out of which her legs were dangling, looking longer and leaner than even moments before.

It was, in short, a perfect choice for her. The blue caught her eyes and matched her skin, the shape flattered her every curve, and it was slutty but without being over the top: the expense of it showed through, saving it from looking trashy.

Scarlett looked down at it again. "I guess," she said, almost as if she couldn't believe what she was doing. Then she looked up at me.

I'm not sure what I was expecting at that moment, but she slipped her hands up and under the skirt of the dress, to pull down the panties she had put on. She stepped out of them and walked toward the bed. Changing her mind suddenly, she whipped around and leaned over the bag on the floor.

The dress, which fit against her body snugly, rode up all the way to just below her ass, and I could see a glimpse of her pink pussy in the shadows.

"Don't do *that* at the stadium," I advised.

Scarlett made a sound that seemed like a laugh. She turned around, standing up, and I saw the gleam of the bullet in her fingers. "Help me out with this?" she asked.

I stared at her for a moment. It was absolutely surreal, so much so that I had the sudden feeling that I was in a dream, and I would wake up any moment.

Scarlett put her hand on her hip and twisted the vibrator in her fingers. "Please?" she leaned over me, grasping my hard cock in her hand. "Maybe I can help you out with something, too?"

She moved her hand away, and stretched out on the bed, pulling her dress up with her as she did. I was still frozen by the surprise and the unreality of the scene, so I watched her as she slid her hand beneath her torso with the vibrator in her fingers, and began to stroke it between the lips of her pussy. "I'd hate to have to do it myself," she said.

I turned to the side and reached for the bullet. It was sticky-wet already, so whatever effect all of this was having on me, Scarlett, too, was wild for the idea. I rubbed the egg-like tube against her clit, satisfied when her hips began to move. Then I plunged it into her juicy cunt and got it coated with her juices before I drew it up to her pink asshole, which was still slightly reddened from her adventures yesterday afternoon, and ours later that night..

I pushed it inside of her as slowly as I could, and Scarlett gasped as it spread her open. There was a moment of hardened resistance as she closed tightly around it, but she relaxed and the vibrator was sucked up inside of her, gliding smooth in her juices. I gave the ribbon on the end a little tug, and pushed it back in, enjoying the gasps of pleasure from Scarlett.

I was about to instruct her to play with herself, but Scarlett was already moving, crawling backward and off the edge of the bed onto the floor.

She positioned herself between my legs, looked up at me and smiled. “Thank you,” she murmured seductively, clasping my shaft in her fingers.

With her eyes on mine, which by itself nearly sent me over the edge, she opened her mouth and took me inside of her, all the way to the back of her throat. I felt the satisfying ripple of her abdomen against my shins as she gagged, and then she began to suck on me earnestly, her eyes on mine.

When I came, I pushed her head gently forward, and the squirts of my cum splashed against the back of her throat. She swirled her tongue around my shafts as she peeled her mouth from my cock. I watched her in semi-disbelief as she wiped her mouth.

I reached for her as she stood up, to put my fingers into her wet pussy and find her clit, maybe pull her toward me and get my mouth full of her hot, tangy flesh. She shook her head slightly, bringing her own hand from between her legs, drawing it along the length of her torso, and placing her soaked fingers in her mouth. She sucked her juices from them with a slurpy pop, and smiled.

Scarlett had already taken care of it.

She straightened out her skirt and gave a turn, disappearing moments later into the bathroom to do her makeup and brush her hair.

*

We headed off to the small cafe at the corner for a quick breakfast before taking the Metro to Roland Garros. For the first time in a long time, I felt more detached from Scarlett, who mentioned nothing about Alessandro or the upcoming day, again. Scarlett had a coffee and stared out the window. The morning felt odd, putting a damper on my excitement. I almost reached across the table to tell her we should blow the whole thing off.

But I didn't.

The stadium was hot: all courts were outside by this time and the sun blared, baking the clay until it felt like we were in a desert. We took our seats and Scarlett sat primly. Eyes followed her wherever she went. Behind her sunglasses, I could not see where Scarlett's gaze went. Her mouth was set in a neutral expression, and I had no idea what she was thinking.

Dan and Marie had upgraded their seats and were nowhere near us, but instead down in the corporate sections which were nearly empty.

The match started and a hush came over the seats. Between games, as the onlookers clapped, I leaned over to Scarlett to kiss her ear, to slip my hand into hers, to ask her if she saw him yet.

I would never be able to explain what was wrong with Scarlett's reactions, or why they unsettled me. She took my hand, she smiled when the kiss on her neck traveled along her skin and gave her goosebumps, she squeezed my hand back or shook her head slowly, scanning.

But something felt off, as though Scarlett were on another planet and calling in the motions to her robot self.

And then, magically, just as the heat and the sleepy pace of the match began to lull me into a strange place in my mind, Scarlett's lips opened and she exhaled. There was a call for silence and she broke it with the faintest whisper:

"He's here."

Service began.

"How do you know?" I asked her, my mouth close to her ear.

Scarlett said nothing, just pressed her knees together. She had her phone in her hand, and she slid it so that I could see the screen. But the sun made it impossible to read.

"He told me to turn it on," she said finally.

And that's when I saw the flush of excitement travel from the back of her neck across her cheeks. I put my hand on her knee and I was sure that I could feel the vibrator inside of her through her bones.

Scarlett let out another puff of air.

I stared straight ahead, dedicated to my role of pretending that I didn't know my wife had a vibrator in her ass, that I didn't know she was squirming in her seat while another man, somewhere in the stadium, watched her. I pretended by looking straight ahead. Scarlett put her hand on mine and I felt her tremble from time to time as the torture Alessandro was unleashing on her became unbearable.

She moved her legs, shifting them to the right. Then she shifted them back. Another round of applause erupted, and I took the opportunity to ask her if she was all right.

She wiped her brow and smiled.

My cock was hard, my blood was boiling. I scanned the stadium for Alessandro's dark hair, and found thousands of handsome, dark-haired men looking back at me.

The phone in her hand vibrated and she waited to slide it to her lap and look at it.

Then she slipped it into her purse and placed the bag on her lap. A bead of sweat rolled down her cheek.

“He wants me to meet him, up there in the shops,” she said breathlessly, leaning toward me.

My face felt rigid, mostly because I was trying to contain myself. Scarlett’s squirming next to me while Alessandro watched and enjoyed the thought that I didn’t know about him, or their affair, or his control over her, had twisted my insides into a pretzel.

“Now?” I said, finally deciding on something to say. My cock was throbbing.

Scarlett stood up, not answering my question. “I’ll be right back,” she said faintly.

Her leg was next to mine, the high hemline of the crocheted dress just at my eye. A set had just ended, it was her only chance to go, and perhaps that’s why she moved away quickly – a little too quickly for my taste – to the aisle, and disappeared before my muscles came back under my control.

*

I considered following her. Every fiber of my being was pulling at me, trying to get me to stand up, to begin walking in her direction, to see where she went and what Alessandro had planned for her. Would they leave the stadium? Would he try to tuck away in some corner of the place and fuck her up against a wall? Was he delighted with himself as he saw her do what he asked, even though she had to leave her husband sitting alone in the stands at a tennis match? It was a bold, reckless move for Scarlett, if Alessandro truly believed that I didn’t know about their affair. He must feel like such a big man, fucking my wife right under my nose like this.

Another flare of jealousy burned inside of me, but this time I had a nearly irrepressible urge to show Alessandro a thing or two. On the one hand, I wanted my wife to keep up this charade, which required me to keep the charade up as well; on the other, I wanted to let him know that this was under my control, not his.

I clasped the edge of the chair and stared into the clay court. Time seemed to freeze.

What seemed like an eternity later, Scarlett returned between sets with two cold beers. Condensation had gathered on the glass, they were warming. She handed one to me and smiled, and I took it and smiled back, thinking that Alessandro must be watching.

Scarlett's leg was in front of me, with her inner thigh visible as she smoothed her dress to sit down. I saw a rolling pearl of her own juices snake down to her knee as she sat. The scent of sex drifted from her, vague and light. I couldn't determine if Alessandro's cum was mingled with her pussy juices or not. I had no idea how much time had passed. What had they had time for?

I put my hand on her knee and ran my pinky along her thigh, feeling her excitement. She looked straight ahead.

"Where is he?" I said in a low voice. "Is he still here? In the stands?"

Scarlett said nothing. She took a sip of her beer and looked ahead.

"He's in the section across from us."

I scanned ahead of me, but my mind was swimming and my vision was too blurry to see properly. We watched a game, and while the audience clapped, I asked:

"What did you do with him?"

Scarlett's chest rose and fell. She took a sip of her beer. The stadium went quiet for a serve. I scanned the seats for Alessandro and my heart jumped when I thought I found him. I was looking at him – surely it was him? Hair slicked back, elbows on knees, staring in our direction. A smug smile on his face, one I couldn't see but knew was there.

"He just finger-fucked me," Scarlett said, pushing her hair back from her face. "And I -"

The volley ended dramatically, with the Bosnian player leaping for a backhand and crashing to the ground after managing to hit it in the far corner of the backcourt. The heroic volley just barely caught the net and tipped back into his right service court.

I paid the drama absolutely no mind. The player hugged himself in fetal position in obvious pain. The crowd gasped. Scarlett, Alessandro, and I were the only people who were unmoved by the action.

"I gave him a blowjob," Scarlett said.

As she made this pronouncement, she brushed her hair back from her face again and took a sip of her beer. Then she drew her finger around the outline of her mouth, almost matter-of-factly.

I watched this in the corner of my eye while I stared at the barely discernible blob of a man I had decided was Alessandro. Did that guy have his cock in my wife's mouth just a moment before?

"He wants me to make an excuse," she said quietly. "And go to his hotel."

"Does he," I said blandly.

Scarlett leaned over to me, as though she were commenting on the scene in front of us on the courts. She kept her face turned to the courts while she whispered, as if it were an aside:

"He says he's not quite done with my ass until I can't walk."

My cock jolted to steel-hard.

"And?" I asked.

Scarlett shrugged. "I said I'd do what I can."

I looked over at her briefly. Medics were checking out the downed Bosnian, people were milling up to the exits to go to the shops, even more people were filtering in from the corporate suites to be closer to the action.

People love a scene of excitement.

Scarlett.

I pondered her for a moment. She seemed so cool, so confident. But what did she *want*?

The memory of the way she squirmed as I fucked her in the ass resurfaced in my mind. It seemed that Scarlett wanted Alessandro to fuck her the way that he did. That she got off on the danger, the alpha-male, the taboo-ness of her "affair." The woman, after all, was sitting here with a vibrator in her ass.

I blinked into the red clay. For a second, my heart plummeted.

"What if I make an excuse *for* you?" I found myself saying.

Scarlett's head whipped toward me, and though I couldn't see behind her sunglasses, I thought her eyes expressed disbelief.

It should be noted here that disbelief comes in many forms. Joyful, relieved, upset, discomfiting, very literal, very skeptical... and so you should know the difference. I simply filled in the kind of disbelief I wanted to see.

I patted Scarlett on her knee.

"Um.. okay," she said. Her tone was one of disbelief, again, I did not pay attention to what kind. "If that's what you want."

The player stood up, the crowd cheered him on. The set would resume.

I squeezed Scarlett's hand. "We'll tell him I got called away," I said. "On business or something. And then..." I was thinking. I wanted, desperately, I could feel now, to see my wife with Alessandro. To actually see them together.

"Called away on business?" she asked dumbly. "What? What's your plan?"

The plan, Scarlett, was that I wanted to see you with him, being fucked in the ass by him, defiled by him. That was my only plan.

I squinted behind my sunglasses. "I'll come up with it," I said.

Then I stood up, as the applause died down. "I'll text you," I said.

And then, I left my wife at a tennis match to be preyed upon by another man.

It was an unexpected turn of events.

CHAPTER 10

A plan. I needed a plan that would finally get me to a place where I could see my wife with Alessandro.

It occurred to me, as I was staring into the gray-black blur outside the windows of the Metro, and as I was walking in a fog toward the hotel, that I needed a plan for far more than that. I needed a plan for extracting myself, and my wife, from this tangled mess with Alessandro.

But like so many things that you sense are ultimately bad for you, I gave it the same sort of thought. It was right up there with “I should really quit drinking” and “I should stop eating entire Chipotle burritos for lunch.” True, but not what I really wanted to do.

I walked so quickly to the room that I worked up a sweat. The door closed behind me and I stood in the still air (the cleaning staff inevitably turned off the air conditioning, which I found to be a very European display of values-teaching at such an expensive hotel). I looked around, hearing my own breath, seeing things in the sort of tunnel vision that you get in an emergency.

There was no place to hide in this room. I knew that as I approached. The beds were the kind you could not get under, the furniture was sparse, the shower was made of glass. The curtains were short and wouldn't hide my legs.

I spun around and around, problem-solving in the worst kind of way, repeating the same faulty thinking over and over again. The only hope, and it was not a very good one, was the incredibly cramped closet – an actual closet, which was a rarity in France, or so Marie told me – but it was by the door and creaked when it opened and I would barely fit inside.

I tried it anyway, and was sorely disappointed.

My phone buzzed as I was exiting the closet.

[Scarlett]: *I'm calling you in five play along*

I stared at the screen. For some reason, I felt suddenly lost, as though I couldn't make out what she was implying or even the words used to convey the idea.

I pressed the answer button and brought the phone to my ear as though I had forgotten what a phone was.

“Hello?” I said.

It was awkward to answer the phone like that. When was the last time I had answered a phone and said, “hello?” Who even said that anymore? It was ridiculous, a bungle. I started to reverse it, but Scarlett spoke over me as I started to say “Oh hi hello Scarlett, honey, hi hello-”

“Hey,” she said, in a sing-song voice. It was the kind of voice you used when you were in the presence of someone else, someone who was eavesdropping, someone who had a vested interest in what you were going to say.

The lie you were going to tell.

I could picture Alessandro leaning into her body, running his hand up the inside of her thigh with his mouth close to her neck, listening to my end of the conversation, enjoying cuckolding me.

My heart plummeted for a moment, as though I were actually the stooge here. I was sucked into a visceral reaction, as though I had not been the one to give my wife permission to fuck him, the one to encourage her to do it.

“So... are you almost done? Or do you think you’re going to be a while? Did they call you out to... Bourges?”

“Uh...” I said. My mind was trying to keep up with her plan, trying to stay on that track, and not be distracted by all of my other thoughts and misgivings. “I... I’m not sure.”

I did not know where Bourges was, or even how to spell it, and I certainly didn’t know how Scarlett had come up with the name on the fly like that.

There was no “business” for me in France.

“Because if you’re going to be overnight,” she said, her tone one of wifely admonishment, so believable I almost thought I *was* going to be overnight somewhere, “I’d like to know as soon as possible.”

I thought. As quickly as I could. I reminded myself that Alessandro was listening. I almost said, “Oh, I get it,” when I got it.

I stopped myself and cleared my throat.

“So, listen,” I said. “I’m really sorry about this, but it looks like we’ll have to go out to Bourges.”

There was a pause, an icy one, and I worried for a moment that I had fumbled the ball.

“That’s really nice, Will,” Scarlett said. “So you won’t be back? Tonight? At all?”

She was doing a really nice job of sounding pissed off.

“I’m sorry Scarlett,” I said heavily. “I promise to make it up to you.”

Scarlett sighed theatrically. From my perspective, it was quite funny, because Scarlett is not a theatrical person. Then I realized that perhaps it wasn’t a sigh: Alessandro was almost certainly there, pawing at her, maybe even dipping his fingers into her pussy right now. Getting her wet, getting her juicy cunt to dribble all that excitement down to her abused ass, so she would be ripe and wet when he turned her around and fucked her.

“This was supposed to be our vacation,” Scarlett whined. “What am I supposed to do?”

I was looking into the mirror on the wall across from the closet. A middle-aged man, stuffed in a closet, holding the door and a phone, talking to his wife who just then gave a little gasp, probably as another man stroked her clit.

“Sweetie, do whatever you want. Come back, order room service, get a spa treatment, and I’ll be back before you know it,” I said. I got the game, now: this was all a set-up for Alessandro to feel comfortable coming back here, fucking my wife in our hotel room.

Scarlett’s voice was ragged and breathy. “I’m still mad,” she said. “When are you leaving?”

I gave it only a few seconds of thought, and then I was very proud of myself for thinking ahead and buying myself some time. “I have to catch a five o’clock train,” I told her. So about an hour.

Scarlett sighed again, a sexual gasp. “O...quay. I’ll be... I’ll try to make it there before you...”

There was a pause, a rustle on the phone. I wondered what Alessandro was signaling to her, or if maybe he had worked her up to a near-climax, and now had her dangling breathlessly at the edge, her eyes closed, her body tense, beads of sweat on her brow. “I’ll be there,” she said again, “around... as soon as I can.”

“I love you,” I said. “In case I miss you.”

There was an excruciating pause, that for me seemed to last an eternity, before my wife said, in a cracking and distracted voice:

“Okay. Good, sounds good.”

And then, quickly, breathlessly:

“I love you.”

I hung up the phone, and I pictured Scarlett simply dropping hers on the ground, as Alessandro lifted her up and drove his big fat cock inside of her.

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My plan, the new one, was not very good but it was the best I could think of. I had assumed that Scarlett would text me with any details I needed to know, but also that she would bring Alessandro back here – surely that was the reason for her cryptic, fictional phone call.

There were therefore only two options: to hide in the closet for god knows how long, or to try and sneak into the hotel room when I thought things were really hot and heavy.

The latter was a non-starter: the room was small, very European, and there was no way I could sneak in unnoticed.

So, to the closet.

Maybe you’re the kind of person who is smarter than me, the kind of person who would think ahead on a few counts. You might be the kind of person who would take himself a few shots and a snack, or who would make sure he’d pissed out every single drop of fluid in his kidneys.

Well, I am no such man, and all I can say for myself is: my judgment was impaired. By the lack of circulating blood to the thinking part of my body.

I did pee, and I did try to arrange a place to sit in the closet on the chair for the desk, but it didn’t fit. I took Scarlett’s things out of the closet, and lay them over an armchair, but then I worried that Alessandro might find them, pick them up, and try to put them away.

This was a silly idea, but I thought it nonetheless.

I arranged a blanket on the floor and then paced the room, deciding to stay out until the last minute.

At four-ten, I was sitting on the floor, my hand on the door to pull it closed if I heard a peep in the hallway, and Scarlett texted me.

[Scarlett]: I’m *like ten minutes away*. *Are you still at the hotel?*

I gave it some thought, wondering if this was the *real* Scarlett, or part of our game. I decided on the latter, and I typed.

[Me]: *sorry babe I already left for station*

I waited, my chest cold and heaving with the gulps of air I was taking. My heart felt as though it had been placed in a vice, and was being slowly squeezed tighter and tighter.

Scarlett's message confirmed my imagination: they were huddled on the Metro together, Alessandro smiling and he stroked her inner thigh and reached up further under her skirt, his eyes on the screen of her phone. He would have his cock inside her ass any minute now, and he believed he had her lying to her husband, sharing her mendaciousness with him.

[Scarlett]: *sorry I'll miss you. Have a good trip.*

I typed to her: *I love you*

When I read her reply, I pictured them cuddling, maybe even Alessandro's fingers on her screen as she wrote back:

[Scarlett]: *I love you too*

I set the phone down on the night table and spun around, unsure of what to do with myself. The closet seemed to be the only option. I climbed inside and then climbed out, sat halfway in the door and then panicked and changed my mind completely, then resigned myself to being trapped in there if only I got to finally see my wife with Alessandro.

I realized at the last minute that I had left my phone out there, and it was probably for the best that I had to run out to get it, because then I remembered to also turn the sound off.

I stood by the door, waiting until the last possible minute to stuff myself into the closet.

I heard them in the hallway long before they got to the door. Scarlett was being unusually loud, laughing in a high-pitched, lilting voice that I could assume was deliberate, and for me.

I fell to the floor in an uncomfortable squat that I would only feel later, when I tried to move. I pulled the door shut behind me, and the closet felt instantaneously too hot. The voices stopped outside the door: Alessandro's low growl, Scarlett's too-loud laugh. They must have kissed out there or something, because the door rattled against its frame for a few minutes before they entered.

Things moved quickly after the door clicked open. I couldn't see anything of course; I had to imagine what was happening based on the sounds. The door rattled loudly, sending a wave of terror through me, as they careened into the room. I could hear the wet, slurp sounds of them kissing as they thudded from wall to wall.

I heard things being thrown to the floor, and I pictured the typical Hollywood movie of two lovers knocking paintings off walls and items from desks to fuck in their first ever, passionate encounter.

It was so surreal that it didn't affect me at first: I almost felt as though I were watching a movie. Stimulating, sure. But I didn't feel like it was actually my wife until I heard her gasp.

"Come on *gattina*, get on the bed, I want to lick your pussy."

The small closet seemed to get robbed of oxygen as they moved in the room. My hand was on the door, I wanted to open it more than anything in the world and see if what I was imagining was the same thing that was occurring: my wife was spread out on the bed with her legs open and her pussy there for Alessandro to lick.

I heard Scarlett's voice after a few painful moments during which all I heard was shuffling and some wet stickiness. Alessandro murmured something, and it sounded Italian. Then Scarlett gasped.

"No, no, no, stay just like that. Hold your legs just like that," Alessandro purred. "Good girl. Don't be bad or I'll have to spank you again."

I could hear Scarlett breathing through the door. My balls felt like they were going to rip open.

"Oh!" Scarlett said. "Oh, please don't...stop...oh, oh, oh!" And then she sounded like she was sobbing.

"That's good. There you go, get your ass all wet, you'll like that better when I fuck your little hole."

My mouth fell open. Sure, I had known that Alessandro was a filthy bastard after the video call, but hearing it this close, hearing him actually

talk to her while he fucked her, I couldn't believe it.

My heart was pounding. I tried turning the door handle and it gave me a creak. I stopped, but the occupants of the room clearly had noticed nothing.

"Oh, please," my wife begged. "Just make me come, let me come -"

There was a light slap, which shocked me at first, before I realized he was hitting her on the ass. "You'll come when I let you, *gattina*. I want you to come when I have my cock in your hot, soft ass. This is just to get you nice and wet...oh, that's good."

I could hear the sticky slosh of his fingers or his tongue in her pussy through the door.

"Now get on your knees." A pause. "That's good, you little *puta*, get your hands up there and show me your ass. That's it. Pull it apart and let me see it."

The closet was too hot, too stuffy. I felt like I was gasping for air. I slowed my breathing and felt like I would suffocate. My cock twitched as I pictured what he might be doing... fingering her ass?

My question was answered when I heard him sigh. "Oh, that's good, you little slut. I like how it feels. I've been thinking all night about your ass and how much I like to fuck it. I'm going to fuck you in the ass again and again and you're going to take it like a good little *puta*, aren't you?"

I held my breath, waiting for Scarlett's answer. It was muffled, and ended in a moan. It sounded like she was mewling into a pillow.

"I know it's sore, little pussy-cat, but you're going to give it to me, aren't you? I came all this way just to see you and now I want to fuck you in every hole. Because you like it, don't you? You like my big cock in your ass..."

Alessandro rambled off into some very filthy-sounding Italian while my wife mewled into the pillow, or whatever it was. I leaned my ear against the door, trying to hear every detail through the wood. I turned the handle slowly, but I was held back from opening the door by some strange fear: I didn't want to get caught.

"Oh!" Scarlett cried. "Oh, wait -"

"Just relax, *gattina puta*, that's it...oh, that feels so good on my cock, you're nice and hot, you're so wet. I'm going to get my cock all wet and make you come. And then I'm going to fuck your hot little ass until you

can't walk. That's it, squeeze my cock, take it all the way inside. Is that the biggest cock you've ever had?"

My wife's response was muffled, but it was the biggest cock she'd ever had. I listened as he pummeled her, the sticky sounds of her pussy getting louder, sloshier, while she gasped, and then came with a loud scream.

"Oh, yeah," Alessandro said. "Oh, gattina, stop it, you're going to make me -"

But his final words were cut off as he groaned and spewed his seed, as far as I knew, into my wife's pussy.

There were a few moments as they grunted out the last of their orgasms and then the sound of their bodies collapsing on the bed. My head was spinning in the dark closet, my blood pumping so intensely, that I was seeing stars.

Disappointment gripped me as the sounds died down.

"You can't do that," I heard Scarlett say.

Alessandro grunted, and I was curious about the exchange until I smelled the vaguest scent of cigarette smoke.

"So what does your husband do, he leaves you all alone in France with so many French men?"

Scarlett's response was unintelligible.

They chatted for what seemed like an eternity, but which, thinking about it later, I would come to realize was only about ten minutes. I couldn't hear what they were saying, nor could I see them, but I pictured them there on the bed together, and my heart burned. I had actually never thought about this particular aspect of things, which had to have existed all along: I had only been thinking of Scarlett being fucked, Scarlett sucking cock, Scarlett coming while riding on top of him. I had never pictured her talking to him, his face inches from hers.

I didn't like it.

I think I was about to turn the door handle and put an end to it all, when they began again. I could hear their bodies shift, and then their voices turned from quiet talking to moaning and the sounds of people taking pleasure from each other's bodies.

"Like this," I heard Alessandro say. "Suck on my cock. That's it. Oh, *gattina*, your mouth is so good. Keep going. Be a good girl and suck out my come. Don't stop..."

Then I heard Scarlett's voice. The tone changed when Alessandro spoke again. "No, no, I change my mind," his accent was heavier. "I give you a choice, you can suck my cock off and swallow it all up like a little puta, just like that... oh, good girl....and I use some lube when I fuck your ass. I fuck you for a long time, but smooth. Or you can get a short fuck right now, *gattina*, but it's going to be dry."

My eyes flew open wide, as if I were seeing the scene with them instead of imagining it. Did my wife really go for this sort of thing, this kind of humiliation, this alpha-male dominance?

"Oh good girl, all the way in... that's it. You want my cock in your ass for a long time, I know it you dirty little slut. You like to suck it, too. You're...."

More filthy Italian followed, and then trailed off, until all I could hear was Alessandro's raspy breathing and my wife's mouth plunging his cock deep into her throat.

Alessandro groaned, and then there was a loud noise as they shifted on the bed suddenly and something fell off the nightstand. At first I thought he was abusing her, and I turned the handle and pushed the door open: then I saw that he had pushed her face-up on the bed and straddled her, so his back was toward me.

The long snake of his cock was visible between his legs, and he had her head cradled in his hand, manipulating her face up and down the length of his cock. The light was dim, the picture imperfect, but the willingness of my wife in this grotesque act of face-fucking was self-evident. Her arms were loosely to the side, her elbows supporting her on the way up to his balls.

Alessandro's ass clenched, and he shouted and pushed her head to his pelvis. I watched as he spurted his load deep into her throat, pressing her face to his pelvis tightly as he came.

When he released her, he let her head fall back on the bed and she gasped for breath. His cock was still hard, but it flopped out of her throat and slapped his thigh, wet and sticky.

"Open your mouth," he said to her. "Show me you swallowed all my cum, *puta*."

My wife obeyed, and he took his cock in his hand and guided it to her lips. The thick column was veined and gnarly-looking as a silhouette, thicker than I had imagined. It was, in fact, almost unbelievable. He slipped

it lightly on her mouth. "That's good," he said. "Now clean it off, lick it up like a pussy cat, you like the taste of my milk. Show me."

He rose up on his knees, and my wife rose with him to her elbows. And then she began to lick at his cock like a cat, her tongue flat against his shaft, sticky sounds emanating from them as she lapped up all the cum that had swirled around his cock in her mouth.

I was frozen in place, so I almost sat there staring long after Alessandro began to roll over, hoisting himself off her body and toward the headboard. I remembered what I was doing there, and that I was hiding, at the last minute. I closed the door and tried not to breathe like an animal.

Beneath my skin, as Alessandro lit yet another cigarette in our non-smoking room and my wife let him, and they murmured to each other on the bed, rage, jealousy and lust burned. I was shaking, my balls were screaming, my cock was so hard I was certain a split would form down the middle.

To my surprise, it was a very short time until Alessandro was at it again. It only infuriated me further to hear him ask Scarlett, after a minute of sloppy moaning, during which time I suppose they started to make out again:

"Did you get the lubrication?"

I heard Scarlett's footsteps. The zip of a suitcase.

"That's good," Alessandro said. "Otherwise your ass was going to hurt, *gattina*. Come here."

Another pause, as I imagined my wife going to him, being turned onto her stomach, her ass in the air.

"Here we go," he said, and I heard the squeeze of lube from a tube, the suction of it as it pulled back on the liquid at the end of the squeeze. Then Scarlett moaning, Alessandro mumbling.

"What's that, *gattina*, what did you say?"

Scarlett mumbled something.

"It's going to be so sore when I am done with it, *gattina*, but I can't help it, I'm going to fuck your ass all night and you are going to love it. There we go, now you're all nice and ready. This is going to be a little cold but you'll thank me for it later."

I heard another squeeze, and I could see the image almost as though I was looking at it: Alessandro was squeezing the tube right into her ass, right

into the reddened gape left behind by the bullet vibrator, which I'd forgotten all about.

The sound that Scarlett made as Alessandro slid his dick inside of her was a mix between a curdling scream and an orgasmic yelp. He coaxed her as he guided himself into her, and Scarlett panted so heavily it sounded like she was in the room next to me.

"Oh, good, that's good, you like that don't you? I know when a woman likes her ass fucked raw, I know when I see her, that's the kind of little slut you are, *gattina*. Hold your hands up there and spread your *culo* for me... yeah, I want to see it."

"Ohhhh..." Scarlett moaned. "It's so... it's so big. Oh! Wait, wait...go slow..."

Nothing was said for a few moments, and then I heard Scarlett yelp again: there was nothing else to imagine but that Alessandro had at last sheathed himself fully in her ass, giving her a little jolt as he rammed deep inside of her.

Scarlett moaned for several minutes as Alessandro drew his cock slowly in and out of her ass. Or so I imagined, based on what I was hearing.

The air in the closet was stifling. It had become too hot, seemed devoid of oxygen, and it seemed to buzz all around me. Distorted flowers of color bloomed in front of my eyes in the very-near pitch black darkness. I pressed my ear to the door and listened, surprised that I could hear (or thought I could hear) every detail of Scarlett's ass being fucked.

"You like that, don't you *gattina*?" Alessandro said. "Tell me. Tell me how much you like it."

Scarlett said something, and he told her to say it again.

"I love it when you fuck my ass," Scarlett moaned. "Oh!"

I could not stop myself: my desire to see what they were doing was so intense that I disregarded any instinct for avoiding confrontation and danger inside of me. I turned the handle, which squeaked loudly. I pushed the door open a crack to catch a glimpse of their position.

The angle was no good: I couldn't see much of anything. I leaned out, opening the door further. I could see only their legs, but by the position of Alessandro's foot it was clear that they were facing away from the closet and the outside door, toward the headboard, slightly at an angle toward the window. This would allow me to open the door without Alessandro really seeing.

It was still dangerous; he only had to catch something in the periphery of his eye. But he seemed quite fixated on my wife's ass and his cock snaking in and out of it.

I slowly edged the door open and leaned out of it to take in the full view I had been desiring for so long. It hit me like a brick wall, and I forgot myself entirely as I watched. At the moment I leaned on my hand to take in the view, Alessandro reached toward my wife's head and grabbed her hair, pulling it back toward him. Beneath his bare ass I saw his enormous balls swinging as he picked up the pace and began to pummel my wife. They swung wildly, slapping her soaked pussy and making a splashing sound with each smack.

Scarlett squealed and moaned, and Alessandro pounded into her. He released her hair and she fell onto her chest.

"Play with yourself, *gattina*, I want you to come, I like the way your ass feels when you come."

Scarlett obediently drew her hand to her pussy and started to play with herself. She turned her head to face the wall – and my direction – but her eyes did not meet mine and she did not seem to see me. Her eyes were glassy and stared emptily at the wall, which I took for concentration on making herself come.

This went on for what seemed like a very long time, and I began to feel that I should tuck myself away again before I got noticed. I pulled myself into the closet but could not abandon the view entirely, so I left the door open five inches or so to watch what I could see. Their mingled legs, slipping and sliding against each other as Alessandro continued his assault on her ass.

I could hear better, though, the slapping of their skin together, his thighs against her ass. The slaps were wet with sweat and probably lube and juices.

I heard Scarlett's breath become high-pitched with moans and what sounded like hysteria.

"Oh, that's it, Scarlett, oh, yes, squeeze my cock, get that ass nice and tight for me and milk that cum into your ass, you hot little *puta*, yes, just like that, that's it, come for me *gattina*."

Scarlett howled, and the sounds of Alessandro's balls became stickier, but he did not climax. He continued to fuck her, faster and harder, until Scarlett's orgasmic mewling ceased and she went quiet.

And he kept going.

“Alessandro, oh, I can’t take any more,” she cried. “I’m so sore.”

“It’s gonna take awhile, *gattina*, you can take it.”

Scarlett made a sound.

“Bite the pillow, *gattina*, I told you I was going to fuck you raw so you don’t forget my cock in your ass. You can do it. That’s it. Get your hands up there and show me your ass.”

I leaned out again, and got the full view of my wife staring into the wall, glassy eyed, holding her hands up on her round butt cheeks to spread them open for Alessandro, who was still pounding away at her. She was chewing on her lip, her ass was tilted up in display to him, and with her hands on her ass she was utterly submissive.

I was leaning further and further out the door. My cock was dripping precum into my pants and I no longer cared about getting caught. A strange sort of calm overtook me, even as my excitement mounted, as though behind a separate curtain inside of my mind. I edged out of the closet just as Alessandro threw his head back and started to groan.

He was saying something in Italian as he rammed into my wife, clutching her hips and really driving his cock into the depths of her ass. Scarlett yelled: “Oh!” and her eyes went wide as he dumped his load into her ass.

He jiggled his cock into her a few more times as I rose to standing.

I had no plan, I had no idea what I was doing. I stood up, and Scarlett saw me, because she lifted her head, her eyes going from glassy to confused. Alessandro slapped her bottom. “That was so good, my little *put-*”

His voice caught in his throat as his whole face changed shape.

People’s faces, when they are astonished deeply, as Alessandro must have been at that moment, reveal a great deal about their character. It’s perhaps a good thing that I didn’t think what I was doing through, because Alessandro might easily have been a different sort of person.

As it was, he turned out to be the sort of person whose first instinct was, surprisingly, to be afraid. Who knows what I looked like. I think I must have been quite a sight.

“Will,” Scarlett said, and it was neither a question, nor a statement, not surprised and not expectant. Her mouth fell open.

Alessandro looked as though he were seeing a ghost. His cock flopped out of my wife, at last deflated, and he staggered back toward the drawers. When he crashed into them, he began to shake his head.

I stood there, with no idea what expression was on my face. Scarlett's ass was a pink peach, burned by all the slaps of Alessandro's thighs against her. In the center, her asshole throbbed, dark in the middle where she was stretched out, and globs of Alessandro's white cum oozed from her hole with each pulse.

She stayed as she was, shifting her eyes back and forth to Alessandro and to me, too shocked to say anything.

Alessandro's mouth was hanging open. He was shifting his own eyes back and forth to the window and the door, evidently trying to decide his best route of escape. I felt a surge of primal rage and stepped toward him threateningly, and when he flinched a little I was flooded with testosterone. I leaned over and picked up his pants, then threw them at him. "Get the fuck out of here," I seethed, though I wasn't really angry, just having fun.

He blew past me after a few quick darts around the room. He was naked with his pants balled up in his hands and I am pretty sure he fell down as he stumbled out the door.

The door closed.

Scarlett was still staring at me, though she began to roll onto her side as I walked toward her. I was unzipping my pants.

"Wha-" she began.

"Stay like that," I said firmly. "Just like that."

Scarlett hesitated. She looked a little afraid, as though I were the one who was a completely foreign person, as though she could not recognize *me* any more, when she was the one who had just taken Alessandro's ten-plus inches of cock up the ass for almost half an hour.

My cock was so hard now that I ached everywhere, all the way to my kidneys. I climbed onto the bed and reached for Scarlett's hips to pull her toward me. I traced her ass with my thumb, all around the quivering edge of her asshole, Alessandro's cum leaking from inside of her, still hot.

"Will," she said, turning around to look at me. "What are-"

"Is your ass so sore you can't walk?" I asked her. I dipped my fingers into her hole, and she shivered.

She looked back at me over her shoulder. Her face was streaked lightly with mascara, her lips puffy from the mouth-fucking he had given

her, and from her skin arose the smell of his acrid sweat and cum. “You dirty, filthy, little whore,” I said. I pushed my cock against her ass.

She chewed into her lip and moved her ass enticingly.

“You want another load of cum in your ass?” I asked her.

But I didn’t wait for her answer. It was a rhetorical question anyway. I plunged into her ass, which was so slick and wet with Alessandro’s seed, and so stretched out, that I cut through it like it was a channel of heated butter. Scarlett fell to the bed again and howled, but she didn’t have to take it for very long, because my cum was spurting into her filthy, overflowing ass within a few thrusts.

I collapsed on top of her and we rolled to the side. I was still panting, and every fiber of my body was on fire still, I had never in my life come so hard; it had momentarily turned my vision into a starry, pixelated mess.

Scarlett was facing the wall, and I didn’t attend to her much at first because I was so overwhelmed by my orgasm. When at last I made my way with my hand up her hip, along her shoulder, and to her face to push her hair away, I noticed her expression and the wetness gathered in her eyes.

“Hey,” I said. “Scarlett... hey, are you okay?” I asked her. “Did I hurt you?”

Scarlett closed her eyes. “No,” she said, and there was a hint of impatience in her voice.

“I’m sorry I got carried away,” I said. “I’m sorry I... I wasn’t thinking when I came out, I just did it.”

Scarlett rubbed her nose and then wiped away a leaking tear with impatience again.

“I thought you were into it,” I said. “That’s why...”

I was starting to feel really terrible.

Scarlett turned around and looked at me. I touched her face. “I’m sorry I messed things up with you and Alessandro,” I told her, thinking that was where I had gone wrong. “I’m sure he-”

Scarlett was shaking her head. “I’m not *upset* about that,” she whispered.

I felt an expression of confusion take over my face.

Scarlett turned back toward the wall, and I stroked her arm. “I’m glad you did that,” she said finally.

“Wait,” I said, trying to pull her to face me again. “What? I thought you were -”

Scarlett sighed. “I was looking for a way out, really,” she said.

I was silent for moment. “What?” I said.

Scarlett shrugged. “It was getting to be too much. Too out of control -”

I turned her forcibly toward me. “Scarlett,” I said. “Why didn’t you say something? I wouldn’t have...”

I wasn’t sure how to finish that sentence. What wouldn’t I have done?

Scarlett’s eyes welled up with tears. “I didn’t want to disappoint you,” she said. “I thought you were really into it. And now I... now I...” she started to cry. “Now you think I’m a dirty slut and I...”

She covered her face with her hand.

“Scarlett,” I said sharply, pulling her hand away from her face. “What the hell? I... listen, I really thought you were doing all this because you were into it.”

Scarlett sucked in a gulp of air. A sobriety came over her. “I mean,” she said. “I was. I was and I wasn’t. You know?”

It was in that moment that many memories about Scarlett’s interactions with me regarding Alessandro came flooding back. The mixture of uncertainty in her face, the secret she had seemed to be withholding and which I had wrongly interpreted as her affection for Alessandro.

“Wait,” I said. “What are we talking about here? I thought...I thought you felt like things were out of control because you were, I don’t know... falling for him.”

Scarlett’s face went from sad, to disbelieving, to an abrupt laugh. She wiped a stray tear from her eye. “For Alessandro? Falling for him like... emotionally?”

She was slowly, unconsciously, shaking her head in disbelief by rolling it across the pillow.

I fell back onto my back and slapped my forehead. This, too, was unconscious.

“You mean to say that this whole time...”

Images of Scarlett, of her nervousness before her video chat with Alessandro, of her hesitation with her vibrator, of her request to “practice” anal sex with me, started to bubble up in my mind. She had never been

falling for him. The “out of control” had been the sex, and Alessandro's ever-increasing appetites for humiliation and domination.

“So you did all that...” I said, but I didn’t need to finish the sentence.

For me. She had done it for me.

I rolled over to face her.

“Scarlett, why didn’t you just say something?” I asked her.

“I didn’t know what to say,” she said.

Then she pushed her hair from her forehead. “I’m glad we had this,” she whispered. “But... I’m also glad it’s over.”

We looked each other in the eyes.

“Did you at least like it?” she asked me in a quiet voice. “Or was it... too much?”

I kissed her forehead to give her some reassurance, something I hadn’t even realized she needed. “It was so hot,” I said. My cock was approving, thickening against her thigh. Scarlett’s eyes drifted down her body, and she looked stunned, and maybe even a little nervous.

I kissed her forehead again. “I think you deserve a nice long bath,” I said. Because while I wanted nothing more than to reclaim her, again and again, and make sure that she and I both knew she was back to being mine and only mine, I knew I needed to set aside that need, at least for a little while.

Scarlett laughed lightly. “There’s no bathtub,” she pointed out.

It was true. That was Europe for you, even at a pricey hotel.

“You take a shower, then, and I will order some room service.”

Scarlett turned on her side and stretched. “Okay,” she said. “Just a minute...”

While Scarlett was in the shower, maybe fifteen minutes later, I ordered an exorbitant amount of room service treats. While on the phone, Scarlett’s cell phone buzzed in her purse.

And of course I looked at it.

Alessandro, abbreviated AS, had sent a message, and while I was locked out of Scarlett’s phone, I was able to read most of it. *Call me when you can. I want -*

I stared at the phone.

Scarlett came out of the bathroom, wrapping a towel around her head. She looked at me, and her eyes went to the phone in my hand. Then she

looked to my face, as though for guidance.

It was then that everything became clear to me: Scarlett had finally encountered something she couldn't handle on her own. She wanted to end things with Alessandro, but she wasn't able to do it for herself. It wasn't because she was wildly uncomfortable with him, but because there was something alluring about him, and there were things she wanted from him even though they were bad for her. He was like a cigarette, or an opiate, and she would always be tempted to go back to him for the high.

She was relying on me to end it for her. It all seemed so simple and clear now.

Her lips were parted, her eyes big like a doe in the headlights.

"What's your pattern for your phone?" I asked her, remembering that it had been changed.

Scarlett blinked. For a moment I was in free-fall, thinking I'd sized up the situation all wrong, that she was going to be angry.

"It's like a triangle," she said. "Starting at the bottom left, and back."

I remembered the pattern, from seeing her do it before when I had attempted to read her messages earlier, so I was already unlocking the phone as soon as she started talking.

She watched me while I deleted Alessandro's message, and his phone number. I would figure out how to block it some other time. "You should probably let me delete these for a while," I said.

I looked up at her, and I was relieved and happy to see in her eyes that she agreed with me.

She nodded.

If you can believe it, that might have been the sexiest thing I'd seen all day.

EPILOGUE

A soapy rain of water splattered onto the tiles of our shower at the exact moment that Scarlett's phone chirped, a signal for incoming text messages. This is probably why she didn't hear it, or pretended not to hear it.

"I thought we could get some take-out," she said, in answer to a question I had asked almost two minutes earlier. "But I'm soooo tired of *Cantina*. Mexican food in general..."

Scarlett was rinsing shampoo from her hair, talking about every thought that popped into her head. A faint smile was on her lips. It was another Monday morning that had begun early but pleasantly, with sex and now a rush (for me) to get out the door.

Scarlett, who had decided to work part-time in anticipation of the child we planned to have, did not work on Mondays, and so she was taking the longest, laziest shower ever.

I picked her phone up off the night table.

It had been many months since France, since I had begun deleting Scarlett's messages from Alessandro for her, and since (as far as I knew) Alessandro had been effectively deleted from our lives. All we had now was the memory of him.

It was a memory we hadn't dealt with very much, except to use it as fodder for our imaginative sex life.

I stared at the screen.

[5055116534]: *I thought maybe you prefer this one*

An attachment included a schedule. At the top of the attachment, I could make out the seal of the Mountain Vista Country Club, and my heart formed a ball of molten rock as I waited for the document to open so I could see the text and the club seal clearly.

A schedule for mixed doubles.

At Mountain Vista Country Club.

Like a lot of men, I possess a memory for numbers, particularly important ones. I knew the number displayed was not the same number that

had been Alessandro's, long before he had been deleted and blocked from incoming texts.

I committed the current number to memory.

My insides felt like a block of ice, the numbness spreading to my extremities. The feeling was horrible. Exhilarating. Devastating. Invigorating.

I stared at the message.

It could be from anyone, I reminded myself.

It could be from Marie, I insisted thoughtfully.

Or any of the wives from the firm.

Really.

Any explanation was possible.

And yet, several facts glared at me accusingly. The lack of introduction from the number, as well as the number's total lack of history in the call log. How many people do you contact like that for the first time?

There was the tennis.

The "mixed."

The strange, non-native grammar.

For every frightening possibility there was a possible explanation.

My hand hovered over the screen, unsure of what to do, not that I'd read the message and revealed that I had.

Trust is a delicate thing. After all, Scarlett trusted me to delete messages from Alessandro, or so she had made me believe. So I wasn't breaking any trust by being on her phone, looking at this message.

And I trusted Scarlett to stay away from Alessandro. Away from the club.

And so the thing to do at that moment was to ask her about it.

Just ask her about it.

But there's a funny thing about the cool sensation that snaked through me at that moment: it was awful and it was magnificent. I imagined that I felt a little like an addict, shooting up a hit of heroin, remembering why I kept coming back.

Just ask her, I remember thinking. *Your marriage is not a game.*

"Honey," I even said, in that sing-songy tone that means you're about to ask a question.

But even as I did that, my hands, as though they had a mind of their own, were taking cover off her phone. Taking out the battery. Putting it back in.

The shower door opened. A puff of steam licked the mirror. “Did you say something?” Scarlett asked, flipping her head upside-down to wrap up her hair.

Beats passed, blood rushing in my ears, my chest tight.

“I dropped your phone,” I said. Scarlett tipped her head up and looked into the mirror, unaffected by the news. She wiped the corner of her mouth and studied her fresh, pretty face in the slightly foggy mirror.

“Is it broken?”

“It hit the tile. The battery fell out. But I think it’s okay.”

Scarlett turned and walked toward the closet, not me. The phone didn’t interest her much, so there was that.

I watched her, thinking my terrible thoughts, telling myself to just ask her about the message, just confess that I had read it and then tried to cover up that I had read it. To tell her how I had a moment of weakness, in which I fantasized about her having an affair but then – because of trust – I had changed my mind and was now telling her the truth and wondering what was up with the mixed doubles.

Say it, I thought.

The thing of it is, I could just enjoy the feeling for the day, and tell on myself later, couldn’t I? After all, that was sort of the whole point to her “affair” with Alessandro: to inject this excitement into our lives.

I’d just wait until later. Tonight, probably.

I stood up.

“Gotta run,” I said.

I kissed her on the cheek.

“Whatcha doin’ today?” I asked, when I got to the hallway.

Scarlett was shimmying into a pair of white panties. Her breasts jiggled invitingly. She watched the material as it settled against her skin, adjusting it to rest just-so on her hips. Then she lifted her eyes and met mine.

She smiled.

“Same old,” she said.

And then she added:

“Don’t forget the take-out.”

END

MORE FROM ARNICA BUTLER

APOLOGY!

Due to a glitch in the Amazon system, I've had to remove direct hyperlinks from my backmatter. I apologize for any inconvenience this causes my readers. Any of these titles can be located on [My Author Page](#)

Romantic Hotwife Books By Arnica:

A Taste For Teasing

Oren knows he's a lucky man with a hot wife: Monica is blonde, stunning, and has a killer body. She was even a cheerleader in the NBA in her university days – and there are even more interesting jobs in her resume than that. But Monica is also a practical, down-to-earth, and happily married woman.

Things take a turn one year when they're vacationing with friends. Oren discovers that he has a taste for thinking about his wife with another man. And Monica has a taste for... well, something. Monica is becoming a hotwife before his eyes: but Oren can't be sure of *who* she's teasing. Is his fantasy coming true, or is it turning sour? Was there more to Monica's past than she ever let on? Is a hotwife really what he wants?

Ela's Performance

Peter's sweet-faced and fiery wife is headed back to school for a degree in violin performance. Unexpectedly, Peter finds himself becoming very paranoid about who Ela is spending so much time with, and what she is doing at school so very late. It isn't as if he doesn't have his reasons for suspicion. There's the way his own relationship with Ela started, and their own past experiment with an open relationship before they were married. A few other strange things to fuel his jealous fantasies...

And when he discovers someone from Ela's past has resurfaced, he'll take a chance and confront his own desires and obsessions...but will he get what he really wants?

The Houseguest

Sharing and temptation...and sharing temptation. An old buddy returns to Erik's hometown, down on his luck and getting a divorce. By offering to let Ethan stay with them, Erik sees a way to get closer to making his wife-sharing fantasies a reality. To his delight, Natalie seems to be game for something far more adventurous than ever before. But as things heat up, Erik can't help but wonder: Who's seducing whom?

A Conventional Hotwife

Paul Banks was thrilled when a luggage mix-up five years ago opened a window of opportunity for his long-buried desires. Since that time, he and his wife have been playing a little game at their yearly company conventions, and every year his wife ups the ante, going further into his fantasies. But Kathy Banks might be getting just a bit out of control, and things might be going a little too far...

Or not.

The Hotwife Summer

When Ben and Summer have the chance to spend the summer in Italy, their stale marriage starts to heat up in ways Ben could only have dreamed about. Summer is ready to take his hotwife fantasy all the way, and her choice is a sexy, Italian, Michelin star-studded chef. It's too late to put the brakes on what he's set in motion when Ben discovers the humiliating truth about Summer's choice of man. Summer has a taste for being naughty, and a filthy little plan of her own. Will it be everything he could wish for, or will Ben's cuckold fantasy turn into a nightmare he can't escape?

Body of Research

When ever-suspicious Chris plays private detective on his wife's phone and finds that she uses dozens of dating apps, he worries that his darkest fantasies have come true. And it may not be as delicious as he had imagined.

It turns out that Jen is up to something other than cheating, and the door is open for the two of them to explore the boundaries of their marriage. But in any experiment, the results can be unexpected...

The Hobby Job

Former career professional Laura is going crazy living her stay-at-home-mom life in a small country town. Her husband Conrad has the perfect solution: get a “hobby job.” Laura gets turned on to the idea, and to Conrad's surprise, chooses to wait tables at a run-down restaurant down the street. But she gets a lot more than a hobby job when she meets Nate, a young, hot waiter who has his eyes on her from the start.

Conrad and Laura start on separate journeys, exploring new possibilities in their marriage, and opening up to their hidden desires, fantasies, and needs. Will their journeys merge, or will Laura's “hobby job” make a hobby of their marriage?

The Hotwife Tattoo

When Greg's brother marries his wild, tattooed, ex-girlfriend Renee, he knows things will be a little complicated. But when Renee befriends his wife Sara, she starts to change in almost unbelievable ways. Greg sees that there is something more to Renee's plans than just friendly sister-in-law bonding. Is Renee's influence all bad, or can Greg get something he has always wanted and never admitted to his wife – maybe even himself?

Interracial hotwife books by Arnica:

Interracial Hotwife Bundle

Includes *The Tenant*, *Not Black and White*, and *Grand Slam* for \$5.99

Lisa Plays Her Part

Lisa and Luke married young because of an unexpected pregnancy, and Lisa never had much experience with other men as a result. But when a dark, handsome, wealthy man she almost slept with (and always wondered about) resurfaces in her life, Lisa is confronted with agonizing desires... and choices. Now that their nest is empty and they don't have the same reasons to stay together, will Lisa and Luke reconnect, or will Lisa choose to make this the final act of their marriage?

Megyn For The Win

In Megyn's view, nothing could be sillier than entering a charity contest to win a "date" with the sexy black celebrity Max Riley, not even to raise money for underprivileged youth. (Un)fortunately for her, her friend entered her in the contest anyway.

When she wins, her husband Peter sees a chance to dip into a fantasy of his. But when this brush with fate turns into a very real, permanent job offer for Megyn – one that puts her in close and frequent contact with the famed black actor - the couple has a lot more to think about than just a winning a "date."

A romantic, interracial hotwife story with a win at the end!

Claudia Changes Tack

Mike is on his friends' luxury sailboat with his stunning blond wife Claudia, hoping for nothing more than to convince Claudia that sailing is enjoyable. It turns out that his friends are swingers, in the Caribbean for more than just the sailing. And it turns out that Claudia has a streak of voyeurism in her. The couple embark on a mild adventure of exploration and sexual

reawakening on the warm, beautiful beaches of the Caribbean, and it seems like the ideal vacation.

Grand Slam: An Interracial Hotwife Adventure

Charles keeps a secret desire about his wife Zoe. Her sizzling beauty is typically hidden under scrubs and a hair bun, so his fantasy may never happen. But a wrong turn on a weekend getaway turns out to be the opening pitch of a very naughty game, and Zoe seems determined to knock it out of the park.

The Tenant: A Very Naughty Hotwife Novel

Once upon a time, his exotic and incredibly sexy wife Anna loved to indulge Brian's fantasies...to a point. She teased strangers, and took them to cruel, tantalizing places. But she never went all the way. The game ended when Brian and Anna got married, and that was that.

Or was it?

When the gorgeous, charming, and very black John moves into their basement rental, Brian finds that his sleeping desires have been building up all these years. He doesn't just want Anna to tease. He isn't just toying with the idea. He is obsessed with driving his wife to do things with another man. Lewd things. Obscene things.

When he confesses his desires, is Anna just a little bit too willing to make things just like old times? Is she too easy to push over each new line? Brian can't help but wonder if his own obsessions have gone too far...or if Anna's have.

Not Black And White

When a photographer turns Rick on to the idea of watching his wife with another man, Rick feels an obsessive desire inside of himself catch fire. He can't help arrange for his shy, girl-next-door wife Danielle and the rugged, black photographer to cross paths. He knows that Drake Reyes' erotic

photographs are not as abstract as they appear, and that Reyes sleeps with his married models. He knows his wife is not immune to Reyes' charms – no one is. He just can't help but imagine what it would be like to stand in his gallery, looking at Reyes' lurid photos, knowing his own wife is the model, knowing how the photos were taken.

But was it really his idea, or have Drake and Danielle been as manipulative as he has?

Please note, this is the novelized version of the short story Black and White, with significant changes to all scenes depicted in the short story, as well as the point of view. There is, however, some repetition: scenarios which occurred in the short occur in the novel. There are plenty of fresh new adult scenes, however. Please enjoy.

Unlocking Noel: A Reluctant Hotwife Novel

Pretty, bookish Noel is not exactly an adventurer in or out of the bedroom, and Spencer has come to accept that. But things take an unexpected turn one year at an annual ski vacation. When they return the following year, Spencer gets to work on unlocking Noel and her (literally) dark desires.

A romantic hotwife novel with a deliciously corruptible and reluctant heroine.

Hotwife Suspense By Arnica Butler

Nila's Long Con

It began with a chance encounter with a man from his wife's past. Rich knew Tennile had some skeletons – of a sexual nature – in her closet, but he never dreamed they were going to come back to haunt them both. Before he can blink, the two of them are embroiled in high-stakes intrigue, with Tennile's reputation and career, their marriage, and a lot of money on the line. There seems to be no way out but to play the game, and Tennile's past might be game-winning asset. In the style of A Well-Laid Trap, this is a thrilling hotwife ride that will keep you hooked until the end.

A Well-Laid Trap

It all begins when Patrick is convinced he saw his wife with another man at a downtown bar.

He begins to investigate. But the more Patrick uncovers about Jordan's activities, the less he understands.

The biggest problem is, Patrick can't decide how he really feels. On the one hand, his wife seems to be betraying him, and on the other, his sex life has reached a scorching pinnacle he never thought possible.

But he had better hold on to his hat, because when he finds out the truth, things will get much, much hotter than he might have ever imagined...

Fun Summer Swinger Titles:

Clothing Optional

Sy Price and his wife find themselves in an unexpected situation when their Belize vacation resort turns out to be “Clothing Optional.” They’re even more surprised to find out that “Clothing Optional” is code for quite a bit more. They decide to make the best of things and enjoy their vacation. But there are a lot more surprises in store for Sy when Jackie decides to fully embrace the hotel amenities...

A Summer Vacation

Poor Keith. He's been condemned to a campy cruise with his family and friends. Worse yet, he suspects something is going on between his wife and bad-boy Hank, the husband of a family friend his wife has invited along. Keith's in for a very big surprise – and much more naughty, adult fun than he expected on this cruise – when he finds out what's really going on.

Try To Have Some Fun

Helena and Steve's wealthy, sexy, swinger friends have returned to town. Helena has a child- and work-free stretch of summer ahead of her. There's

nothing stopping her from spending her days relaxing by their spectacular pool. No reason not to borrow a tiny bikini, or to maybe sunbathe topless. Or skinny-dip at one of their wild parties.

One thing, though, will probably lead to another...

Explore darker themes by Arnica Butler:

Well-Constructed Affairs

As a hot female construction engineer, John's wife Adria draws a lot of attention at the job site. Which isn't all bad. But when Adria opens the door for him to tell her about his sexual fantasies, he doesn't realize she has opened the door on her own – very dark – fantasy as well. A fantasy she hasn't shared with anyone until now. The couple are off on an exploration of their desires...but is their marriage well-constructed enough to withstand the forces of their fantasies?

Nikita Gets In Too Deep

When Cole and his wife Nik arrive at their usual vacation spot in dull Cape Breton, they're taken by surprise by the most unlikely of next-door neighbors: ultra-sexy Paige and wealthy, commanding Mitch. And these new neighbors are full of surprises. Cole and Nik embark on new adventures in their marriage, trying new things and pushing boundaries they'd never even discussed. It's invigorating, but Cole can't help but wonder if his transformed wife hasn't gotten herself in too deep...

A Gamble: The Making of A Hotwife

Ryan is just an average guy, coaxing his sweet, beautiful wife Victoria into playing into his hotwife fantasy – even if they're just pretending. But a trip to Vegas with his co-worker Brad and his sexy wife Irena turns Ryan's life upside-down. To help Ryan, Brad makes a proposal that could change everything...but it all centers on Victoria's innocence. How far will Victoria go to save what she holds most dear, now that her virtues, her love for Ryan, their marriage, Ryan's desires, and even their finances all hang in the

balance? This is a 52,000-word novel about risk and romance, filled to the brim with the hard, steamy scenes you love. Please enjoy!

A Dark Place: Cuckolded In Lagos

Three people are carving out their fortunes in Africa's largest city, but each of them holds a deeper, darker desire. What is the secret desire of the angelic Charlotte, who finds all men's eyes on her after dark in Lagos? What about Andrew, who keeps a secret hunger so buried perhaps he doesn't admit it even to himself? And what could be darker than Clement Ambode's already shadowy “*reliability*” as an all-purpose contractor in the underbelly of Lagos?

Charlotte, Andrew, and Clement will find themselves in a very dark place when their worlds collide in this ultra-sexy, novella-length cuckold story.